

WOODCRAFT
BOYS & AT
SUNSET
ISLAND

Roy & Hoisington

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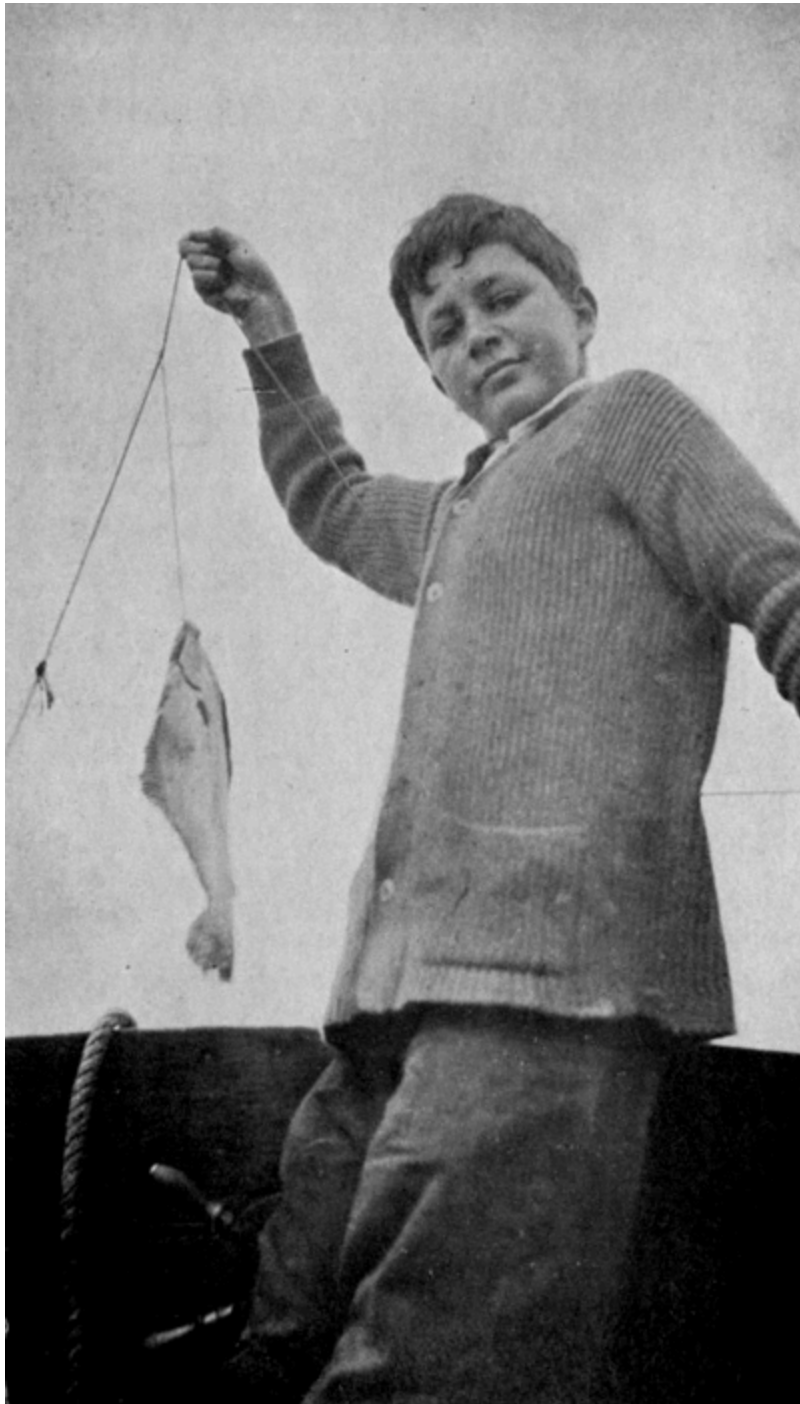
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BOYS AT SUNSET ISLAND ***

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island



BILLY'S PRIZE FISH.
Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island.
Frontispiece.

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island

BY
LILLIAN ELIZABETH ROY
AND
M. F. HOISINGTON

ILLUSTRATED



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WOODCRAFT BOYS
AT SUNSET ISLAND

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CHAPTER ONE

THE SPORTS OF SUNSET ISLAND

“**S**AY! What’s that over there—there near the Cove? Look! There it is again—sticking its fin out of the water,” cried Billy Remington excitedly, as, toggle-iron in hand, he stood in the bow of the large rowboat manned by three other boys.

“Gee! S’pose it’s a shark?” exclaimed Paul Alvord, who, with Dudley West, was visiting Sunset Island, the Maine resort of the Remingtons’.

“Oo-oh! What if it is? Let’s row over and maybe we can have a try to harpoon it!” added Dudley, eagerly.

The “white-ash breeze” soon brought them near the spot where the fin had last been seen and Fred Remington, the oldest of the four boys, rested upon his oars while scanning the face of the water.

“Look—quick! There it is again!” shouted Billy.

“Let’s try and drive it in nearer shore if we can,” came from Fred, who was as eager as the other three lads to become better acquainted with the strange object.

Then began a breathless chase. Four highly excited young fishermen yelling at each other, or pulling madly at the oars when Fred so ordered, and cracking muscles to back water when the need demanded—as was the case whenever the queer hulk of a fish threatened to swim too near the boys’ boat.

However, the creature was already in too shallow water for its bulk to swim and it struggled valiantly, if futilely, to make its escape from the Nemesis in the boat.

“What a whopper!” cried Dudley, while Billy carefully rose from his seat with the harpoon held in his hands.

“Now! Now, give it to him!” called Fred.

Thus importuned, Billy tried his luck. The small harpoon which had been prepared for a chance fling at a porpoise, was let fly at the floundering mass. The aim was true but the iron rebounded as from an oaken plank.

With gasps of wonderment from the boys, the harpoon was hauled back and Billy anxiously tried again. But with the same result.

The huge fish was now seen with its back fin clear out of water in its maddened efforts to swim in the insufficient depth.

“What can it be?” asked Paul, curiously.

“I’m sure I don’t know—certainly not a shark,” replied Fred. Then turning to Billy, he added, “Here—let me have a try at it.”

Billy passed over the harpoon and the boys rowed the boat quite close to the greyish mass so that Fred distinctly saw a great eye.

“Steady boys—quiet now!” warned Fred, raising the weapon above his head.

The big fish lay temporarily resting when Fred launched the iron with all his strength. An accurate aim at the eye which he rightly judged might be vulnerable and the harpoon sunk in the target.

The consuming anxiety of the next few moments seemed like eternity to the boys as they wondered whether they could win out in the mad battle that began the very moment the harpoon struck in. The water was churned as if by a great paddle-wheel; the spray flew over everything while the fish whopped forward, then suddenly backed, then flung itself from side to side in an agonised and frenzied plunge for safety. The harpoon held good however, and Fred paid out about thirty fathoms of line before the victim became exhausted.

It succeeded in gaining deeper water in the frantic battle for life, and had not the iron held securely, the unwieldy fish would surely have broken away to its freedom in the sea.

“It really looks like a young whale, don’t you think so, Fred?” ventured Paul, after the fish had quieted somewhat.

“Nonsense! But it certainly is a queer bunch of hide and bones,” returned Fred.

It was impossible for the boys to handle their prize as it was so heavy, but they managed to drag the monster close to the stern of their boat and then tow it triumphantly in to Saturday Cove where lay a large schooner. The mate yelled at the boys and Fred looked up to find a group of men eagerly watching.

“Come alongside and we’ll haul him out fer you!” shouted the mate.

The boys obeyed and the mate ordered his crew to help. “Pass a bo’line ’round his tail and hoist ’im up!”

“Hit don’t seem to have no tail,” complained a sailor.

“Ner head, nuther—it’s all bulk!” laughed another. Fred passed the harpoon line aboard and the crew tailed on to it. But the combined efforts of the four husky sailors were insufficient to raise the still struggling creature clear of the water.

After a time, however, they managed to get a good view, so that the mate recognised it for a deep-sea sunfish, or mola. He then sent the sailors forward for the large hook used in catting the anchor. They hooked the throat-halliards into this and passed it down to Fred who tried to fasten the anchor-hook in the fish’s mouth. But the beak-like jaws were too small. Finally he managed to hook it into the mola’s eye alongside the harpoon. With this powerful tackle the sailors hoisted the fish out of water.

Visitors and fishermen in every imaginable sort of craft clustered about the yacht, all intent upon seeing the curiosity and securing a good snapshot

of it. With the others, came the Captain of the power launch belonging to Sunset Island.

“Hey, boys! What a monster catch!” called Captain Ed.

“It sure is! How much do you reckon he weighs?” asked a man who overheard the Captain’s remark.

“Looks like half a ton to me—but there’s no tellin’ without scales handy,” returned the Captain.

“Hoh! We weighed him all right, Cap—by the scales on his back!” haw-hawed the mate of the schooner.

The joke was an old one with Maine fishermen and the mate resorted to it without thinking, so the Captain caught him up instantly.

“Naw, yuh didn’t nuther! Cuz he hain’t got no scales—see!”

The laugh that broke simultaneously from the crew was thoroughly enjoyed by every one, including the mate, for the mola had a very tough hide but was scaleless. Its apology for a tail was a frill of scallops opposite the beak-end, while the most prominent features were the dorsal and ventral fins, each one about a foot and a half in length.

“Whad’ye say ye th’ot he weighed, Cap?” asked the mate of Captain Ed as soon as the laugh died down.

“Nigh on half a ton, thinks I,” responded the Captain.

That started a new argument among the local fishermen “lying” in those parts about the weight of the fish. During the discussion, Fred managed to shove his boat close to the launch from Sunset Island. Then he hailed Captain Ed.

“Let’s tow the sunfish over home and give father and mother a chance to look at the queer thing.”

So, acting upon Fred's suggestion, the Captain helped the sailors lower the mola into the water again and remove the yacht's tackle. The procession started: first, Captain Ed, Billy and Dudley in the power boat, towing the rowboat with Fred and Paul in it. They in turn towed the sunfish, the latter at the end of the rope churning up the water as it careened after the boat.

While the four boys excitedly retailed the capture of their prize, the launch was making good speed across West Penobscot Bay to a group of three small islands lying near the fourteen-mile-long shore of Islesboro, which divides the bay into east and west. The boys' summer camp was on the most northerly isle which contained about eight acres of land, high, rocky, and closely wooded with fir and spruce.

The middle island, called Isola Bella, was some twenty-four acres in extent and was also high and well wooded. It belonged to Mrs. Remington's brother, William Farwell, always known as "Uncle Bill."

The southerly one of the island trio was very appropriately named Flat Island because of its nature: Not a tree upon it and shaped like a skate with a sand-spit for a tail.

The three islands were about a quarter of a mile from each other and about two miles from the mainland where the boys had just caught the mola.

Great was the excitement at Sunset Island when the convoy was discerned through the spyglass. As soon as voices could be heard, and in fact before that time, the eager watchers sitting upon the rocks of Treasure Cove were eagerly shouting and waving hands to the approaching craft.

"What did you catch?"

"Is it a porpoise?"

"Where did you get it?"

Mr. Remington was the first to reach the boats and help the boys. "Well, I declare—a sunfish! Haven't seen one in a long time. What are you going to

do with it, now that you've got it?"

"To tell the truth, we never thought of that," retorted Fred.

"All we wanted to do was to catch it, and get it over here to exhibit to you folks," added Billy.

"I've hearn say that th' hide makes mighty good insides for baseballs, 'count of the rubbery quality," casually remarked the Captain, with a twinkle in his eyes.

"Isn't it a good fish to eat?" questioned Paul.

"Nah! yuh might as well try to eat a meal off of auto tires and chopped kindlin' wood served with fish-oil dressin'," chuckled the Captain.

"Then let's get Mose down here and fool him into believing he has to skin and cook the fish for chowder," proposed Dudley, mischievously.

"So we will!" agreed the other boys, and Dudley ran up the bank to call Mose.

The brown chef soon appeared on the rocks in front of the bungalow to see what all the commotion was about and Billy called up to him:

"Bring down your tools to clean this fish, Mose!"

"We're going to have it for to-night's dinner 'cause Captain Ed says it won't keep," added Paul.

"You'll have to slice off the big steaks first, Mose, and chop up the rest for the chowder," concluded Fred.

Never doubting the sincerity of the orders given, Mose went back to find a huge pan and the butcher-knife. With his sleeves rolled up and a heavy burlap apron tied about his waist, he came prepared to clean the monster fish.

While every one stood about grinning, Mose started in to cut off the end where the beak grew; but saw as powerfully as he would, the knife made no impression on the tough hide.

“Ah d’clar’ t’ goodness, Mis Remin’ton, how you-all eber goin’ t’ chaw dis elerphant fish?” worried Mose, as he stood up to mop the moisture from his perspiring brow.

A shout of laughter from the circle of hoaxing islanders made Mose glance quizzically at them.

“Ha! that was one on you, Mose,” exclaimed Billy gleefully.

“Nem-mine, you Indians! Mose got all summer, yuh know, an’ Ah’m gwine git eben wid yuh yit!” prophesied the jolly cook, brandishing the fearful knife as he trudged away toward the bungalow, leaving the laughing crowd standing by the fish.

“We’ve got to keep it some way until Uncle Bill comes,” suggested Fred, looking about the cove for a possible place to anchor the mola.

“Why, when is Uncle Bill expected?” asked Elizabeth Remington, Fred’s fifteen-year-old sister.

“Not for ten days yet, and really, boys, it will be impossible for you to keep this curiosity near Sunset as long as that! You will have to tow it out for the tide to carry far, far away for more reasons than one, before your uncle arrives,” advised Mrs. Remington.

“Can’t we keep it here for a day or two, mother?” begged Billy.

“Not if the flies assemble for a picnic,” retorted she.

“It’s too bad Uncle Tom and Aunt Edith are not at Rosemary yet—he would just love to see this natural history thing. He’s always so enthusiastic about curiosities and all such sort of stuff,” added Elizabeth, gazing at the mola regretfully.

“Well that’s what they miss for not coming to Maine before the first of July,” declared Billy.

“I nearly missed it too, didn’t I?” said Paul, deeply grateful that he hadn’t. “If I’d waited as Hilda wanted me to, just to spend the Fourth with her, I wouldn’t have been here yet, would I?”

The others laughed at such evidence, and Paul added: “Well, I sure am glad I’m here!”

“So’m I,” declared Dudley. “And I’m goin’ to stay, too!”

Again every one laughed at the positiveness of the two young visitors who were Billy’s chums at school, and Paul turned to inquire of his hostess:

“How long do you s’pose we can stay here with you?”

“Just as long as you behave and are not much care or trouble. But it also depends somewhat on what your parents say,” replied the lady of the island.

“Oh, they won’t mind us stayin’ and we’ll do just everything you say, Miss Remington!” quickly promised Dudley.

“You just bet we will, an’ my mother and sister are real glad I can visit Billy all summer on such a dandy island,” assured Paul.

“Well then, the Sagamore of Sunset Isle has his work all cut out for him this summer,” laughed Mrs. Remington, nodding at Fred, who was seventeen and the oldest of all the children.

“Looks like some programme, too!” commented Fred.

“By the time the season is over, Fred will have had such fine training that he will have to go to Plattsburg for a rest. He will be able to pass high in the physical requirements, all right,” added Mr. Remington, who had joined the group in time to hear the latter part of the conversation.

As Mr. Remington finished speaking the bell rang for luncheon and a crowd of hungry islanders trooped in to eat every crumb of Mose’s

delicious meal. Then, feeling like a new man once more, Fred announced his intention of sailing over to Isola Bella to bring his aunt and little cousins, Miriam and Betty, to Sunset Island to see the deep-sea curiosity.

In an hour's time, therefore, Fred landed his passengers at the float stage, and hurried them over to the place where lay the giant sunfish.

"Oh, I wish Papa could see it!" cried Miriam Farwell, the eldest child of Aunt Miriam and Uncle Bill.

The energetic islanders finally wearied of admiring the mola and turned their attention to other things.

"I wish Uncle Bill would offer a prize for the biggest fish caught this summer—you know he did that last year," said Billy, the financier of the family.

"That makes an incentive to catch something larger than your neighbour's, it is true, but I wouldn't scorn to land a big fish even if there were no prize given me," said Fred.

"No one would be so foolish as that," scoffed Paul.

"Captain, how about the trawl this summer?" asked Mr. Remington.

"Oh, yes—and the lobster pots, Captain Ed?" added Billy.

"Well, now, we kin overhaul the trawl and set the pots whenever you say," replied the Captain.

"Then the sooner we start the better!" declared Dudley.

"Ef you ketch any lobsters I'll be s'prised, all right. T'other fishermen ain't ketchin' nawthin' this year," said the Captain.

"It's queer where all the lobsters have gone! They used to be so plentiful that we could easily catch a mess anywhere. Supplying the canneries doesn't explain everything about the scarcity," commented Mrs. Remington.

“I’ve noticed another thing that has changed too, since we first began coming to Maine years ago,” added Mr. Remington. “Do you remember how rarely kelp was found in this bay then? Now, all the ledges in the back bay are covered with it—the ledges that used to be covered with mussels and sea anemones.”

“That’s so, but I never thought of it before,” said Mrs. Remington thoughtfully, then adding, “The cod and other big fish are now being caught here in the *bay* whereas the fishermen used to go way down below Rockland for them.”

The others had been listening intently to these interesting remarks and Billy ventured a theory.

“Do you s’pose the kelp has anything to do with the big fish coming to our bay?”

“I’ve heard some of the natives wonder over the same thing. And the larger fish being in these waters might explain the disappearance of the lobsters as it is said that lobster-spawn floats in masses near the surface of the water at a certain period of its development that it may be benefited by the sun rays. Of course, the big fish eat millions of the eggs at one meal, thus eliminating just so many future lobsters,” explained Mr. Remington.

“It sure sounds reasonable, father,” added Fred.

“Still, that does not compensate us for the loss of our delicious broiled lobster,” argued Mrs. Remington.

“The sooner we fix up the traps, then, the sooner you can have a treat of lobster,” laughed her husband.

“Let’s begin right now and put them into working shape,” cried Billy.

“And I’ll act for Uncle Bill this time—I’ll offer a prize for the largest lobster caught this season,” announced his father.

“Oh good! there are just four traps and each one of us boys can bait and take charge of one,” decided Billy.

“And remember, boys, besides the prize, there is some form of Honour in Woodcraft for knowing fish,” reminded their mother.

“Sure enough—twenty-five kinds of fish for a *coup*!” responded Fred.

“And fifty for a Grand *Coup*,” added Elizabeth.

“Hoh, we can never win fifty!” declared Dudley.

“Why not—if a trawl rakes up a hundred different kinds, it’ll be easy,” bragged Paul.

Then Mrs. Remington said, “You know, boys, we will soon begin our weekly Councils and you ought to be able to get the low Honour for twenty-five fish without any difficulty. Dudley, how many do you know now?”

“Are lobsters fish?” countered Dudley.

“Why, of course they are a sort of fish,” quickly retorted Paul.

“It seems to me that the Woodcraft Manual says ‘vertebrates’ and that means ‘back-bones’; so lobsters should not be included,” explained Mrs. Remington.

“Anyway, I know a cunner, a sculpin, and a mackerel—that’s three. And a salmon, makes four, and a cod and a flounder, that’s six. Now, let me see—oh yes! a harbour-pollock, and, and—I know lots more too, but I can’t just remember,” admitted Dudley.

“Ha, ha! Dud, you ought to be named ‘Dub’! What about the very fish we caught to-day?” teased Fred.

“Gee, that’s so! I clean forgot the mola; guess it was too tiny to remember,” grinned Dudley.

“And the dogfish, and the skate, too, Dud,” reminded Billy.

“But I haven’t seen them yet—I’ve only known them by their names and the pictures.”

“Say, father, will you help us set the trawl so we can try for the *coup*? Just think of all the different kinds of fish we always get that way,” suggested Fred.

“All right, boys, any time you say,” agreed Mr. Remington, who was never so happy as when there was something doing.

Captain Ed, too, was most enthusiastic about the idea of a trawl, so the Sunset Islanders went to their tents that night to dream of hooks and fins and monsters of the deep, deep sea.

They all met at the breakfast table the next morning, and the talk waxed so interesting that the usual object of sole attention—the star-dish of the island, creamed beef and hashed fried potatoes with soft-boiled eggs on the side—was partaken of in an absent-minded manner.

Fred and Billy and their boy guests Paul and Dudley, were full of plans for baiting up the trawl by that afternoon. The girls, Elizabeth and Edith Remington were anxious to help also.

On the way from the bungalow after breakfast, Elizabeth explained to the boys. “We can fish all morning and catch enough bait for the lobster-traps and set the herring-net to get the bait for the trawl overnight.”

“How many hooks are on that trawl?” asked Paul.

“About five hundred,” replied Fred. “Each one is on a short line called a ‘gangin’ which is about a foot and a half long. These gangins hang down every five or so feet along the whole length of the trawl. They have the hooks at the ends and these we have to bait.”

“Gee! How long is the trawl if there are five hundred hooks?” wondered Dudley.

“About half a mile long,” returned Fred.

Captain Ed was tinkering with the traps, putting in new heads and mending broken slats. By the time the boys and girls returned from their bait fishing, with a lot of sculpins and flounders, the four traps were ready. In a short time thereafter the traps were baited and loaded on the largest rowboat.

“I want mine located off Treasure Cove,” announced Billy.

“The Captain says he has picked out some dandy places for Dud’s and mine,” said Paul, not to be outdone.

“Huh! for Dud and you or for your traps?” joked Billy.

“I guess the boys would make good lobster-bait, Bill, and if we run short of sculpins we will use them—the lobsters will never know the difference,” laughed Fred.

This pleasantry caused a rough and tumble scrap on the float-stage but the Captain interrupted them by calling out the welcome order, “All aboard!”

What hopes filled the breasts of Paul and Dudley as the boat neared the spot chosen for the setting of the traps! Mr. Remington had declared the crustaceans to be scarce, still the boys believed that Fate would favour their particular traps and attract the lobsters into them.

Luncheon that day was eaten to the accompaniment of various conjectures as to whether there were enough different kinds of fish in the bay to count twenty-five for a *coup*; to say nothing of fifty kinds for a *Grand Coup* in Woodcraft.

“Fred, you won the fish *coup*, didn’t you?” asked Paul.

“Yes, I had it awarded last year,” replied Fred. “But all the fish I have been introduced to in this bay were not enough to complete the required number. I had to draw on some fresh water kinds to help me out.”

“O pshaw! Then I don’t see how Dud and I can get the *coup* this summer,” grumbled Paul.

“You’re one ahead of the number I started with, anyway. You have that mola and no one ever knows what a trawl may bring forth,” comforted Fred.

The following morning the baiting of the trawl took a long time and the boys thought a good day’s work was done when they had finished helping the Captain and Mr. Remington. Each herring was cut into pieces and furnished enough bait for three or four hooks.

They set the trawl out in the bay starting off at Flat Island. The Captain’s dexterous flipping of the trawl-line was the despairing admiration of the four boys and he did not catch or tangle the long line once!

“Say, but that’s swell work!” exclaimed Paul.

“I should say so—some class to Captain Ed!” added Dudley.

Mr. Remington and the Captain laughed but, indeed, the performance was a wonderful feat. The half-mile trawl with its five hundred dependent hooks had been coiled in a tub with all the baited hooks in the inside of the coil.

Having attached the end of the trawl-line to the anchored buoy Mr. Remington and the boys rowed the boat slowly along with the tide, while the Captain, reaching down with practised hands into the coil in the tub threw over the baited line with the aid of a stick.

As the tide was on the flood the Sunset Islanders had started at what would eventually be the southern end of the trawl and they worked up the bay. The northern buoy was anchored as they finished in the sunset glow.

Rowing homeward, somewhat wet but happy and ready as usual to replenish the inner man, they reached the float where Mrs. Remington stood watching for them.

“Oo-oh! What a mess the boys are in! And it will be worse too when you ‘under-run’ the trawl. Worse still when you clean the fish. Now, boys there won’t be a stitch of clothing fit to wear about here, let alone to travel home in, unless you put away these suits and wear some old fishing togs. I only wish I had remembered to make you change this morning. Come, and I will fit you out as you should be.”

CHAPTER TWO

WHAT THE TRAWL BROUGHT FORTH

SUPERBLY equipped in various misfits of cast-off fishing clothes abandoned by former visitors to the island, and some of Fred's outgrown trousers, the four boys, shod in rubber boots, could hardly wait for Mose to finish serving the breakfast the morning after the setting of the trawl.

Captain Ed and Mr. Remington were found at the float-stage employed in seeing that the boat was all ready for the trip. The boys soon joined them and all piled into the big rowboat and pulled away from shore.

The tide was running down so they began at the north end of the trawl and soon found the floating buoy. Fred began hauling in the line while the three younger boys craned their necks far over the side of the boat to see the first hook appear.

"Gee! There's somethin' on it!" screamed Dudley, excitedly.

In his mad endeavour to crowd Dudley from his vantage point, Paul caught the toe of his boot in the thwart of the boat and stumbled, receiving a flabby skate plumb in his face, as the fish was swung inboard at the end of the short line.

But no one had time to console the sputtering Paul, nor indeed, did he complain of the mishap, as the next hook was about to appear above the surface of the water.

"What's on that one?" shrilled Paul, not able to see for himself.

"Ugh! only a dog-fish," grunted the Captain. "Stab him and chuck him overboard, Fred."

“No, no—wait a minute, I want to see him first,” cried Paul.

His curiosity for a closer acquaintance with dog-fish was gratified ten times over in the next few minutes and Captain Ed remarked with disgust, “Humph! Guess their ain’t nuthin’ else in the bay.”

But even as he spoke, a fine cod rewarded the haul.

“Now, that’s something like!” commended Mr. Remington.

“How much do you s’pose she weighs?” cried Billy.

“Oh, about six pounds, but we’ll do better’n that,” said the Captain.

Then followed hake, haddock, more dog-fish, another skate, and then three more fine cod—one of them weighing at least ten pounds. By this time both the boat and the boys were wet and slimy so that Paul consented to have the dog-fish killed and sent to feed and fatten the future prey of the trawl. While the younger boys made way with the skates and other useless fish, Fred and the Captain continued to overhaul the trawl and rebait the hooks when necessary.

Suddenly, a rebellious thrashing and struggling attended the hauling in of one of the hooks and the boys saw a wriggling mass of coils being brought up from the blue-green depths.

“Jiminy crickets! It’s a sea-serpent!” yelled Dudley, his eyes as big as saucers.

“Is it, Captain?” shivered Paul, deliciously.

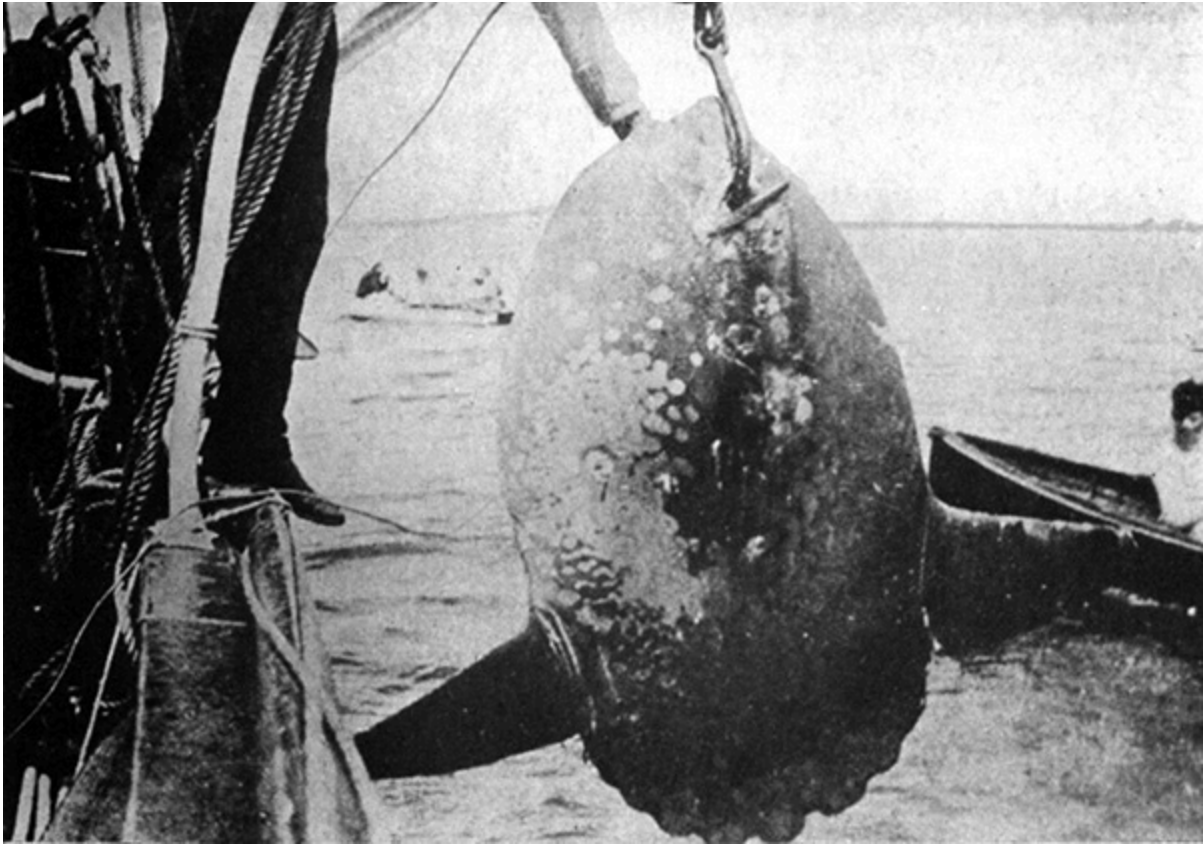
“We-ll, I shouldn’t wonder if it was,” answered the Captain, preparing to help Fred disengage the hook from an immense conger eel.

They tried to perform this operation outside of the boat but the resistance of the strong wrestler was so powerful that half of its length slid over the side into the boat even while the Captain and Fred worked to free it.

The new passenger had things his own way for a time after he shipped so that Mr. Remington had to join in the fray to assist in dispossessing the unwelcome stranger.

By the time the conger eel was disentangled from Bill's legs, Paul and Dudley had laughed themselves so weak that they sat down upon the slippery mess of cod and haddock. They had laughed all too soon, however!

The eel, cut free from the hook, redoubled upon itself and lovingly entwined the two helpless boys in a close embrace. Well indeed was it that Mrs. Remington had insisted upon their wearing the rag-tag and bobtail attire that day!



THE MOLA, OR DEEP SEA SUNFISH.



THE LOBSTER TRAPS.

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island.

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The Captain finally succeeded in heaving the eel overboard, admitting as he did so, “I hate to ketch one of them critters on my hooks—they are so all-fired ugly!”

When order reigned once more and the boys had washed some of the bloody slime from hands and faces, Mr. Remington complimented them upon the stoic manner in which they “took their medicine.”

But when the boatload of some fifty fine fish was landed at Sunset Island, the surprise of the girls and Mrs. Remington repaid them for all of their vicissitudes.

“How long do you expect to keep up this trawling, and what do you intend to do with all of these eatable fish,” asked Mrs. Remington, overwhelmed when she heard the trawl had been rebaited for another catch.

“Well, the boys and I thought of a little plan to dry and salt a lot of fish for winter’s use. Especially as the high cost of meat in the city has turned our thoughts to a fuller appreciation of the bounties of the sea,” said her husband.

“Oh, mercy me! Have you stopped to think of the plague of flies—to say nothing of the horrid smell caused by old fish?” remonstrated Mrs. Remington.

“And that reminds me,” added she, hurriedly, “that mola *must* not remain on the island any longer.”

“Oh, that’s so, we’ll tow it out this afternoon,” promised Fred.

“As for the fish-curing, that won’t annoy you, my dear,” reassured Mr. Remington. “We intend doing all of that on Flat Island.”

“We’d have taken these fish right down there, mother, but we wanted the girls to see the haul—we were right near Flat Island, too, when we finished up the trawl,” said Fred.

“Well, we’re much obliged, Freddy,” said Elizabeth.

“And we’ll take one of the cod up to Mose for supper,” added Mrs. Remington.

That afternoon, Mr. Remington and the boys took the fish to Flat Island while the Captain followed in his launch with a load of scantlings and tools for making fish-flats. The mola was towed behind the launch and out in deep water it was left to float away.

A tired lot of boys lounged about the bungalow that evening and Billy was heard to say to Paul, “Say, but it takes a heap of scrubbing to get clean of fish-smell, don’t it?”

“Yep! I had to scrub with hot water and gold-dust twins before lunch and then I had to scrub with hot water and kitchen soap before supper—’cause Edith sniffed at me; an’ now your mother says I’m still fishy an’ I’d better

scrub with more hot water and cashmere bouquet soap before goin' to bed so's the sheets won't turn sick!" giggled Paul.

"Ah, I say! It's too much to expect from a feller in camp," complained Dudley.

"Never mind," consoled Fred. "It'll soon be warm enough to strip and take a plunge in the Cove instead of all this penance of hot water and soap."

That night as the tide crept stealthily in it bore upon its bosom a treasure indeed! At last Treasure Cove had won its title. In the silvery rays of the beautiful moonlight a *mola* lay glorified upon the little white beach.

Immediately after breakfast in the morning, the eager boys wanted to investigate their lobster traps.

"I'll tell you what, boys! You can attend to that while I take the Captain and get some salt for our fish. Who wants to go to Saturday Cove with me?" called Mr. Remington.

"I do! I do!" came the chorus of girls' voices.

"No sooner said than done—here we go!" laughed their father.

As usual, Mose took this opportunity to hand Mr. Remington a list of items for the larder. Odds and ends were obtainable at the General Store and "P. O." at Saturday Cove although the weekly marketing was done at Belfast, a goodly-sized town nine miles up the bay.

The boys were a bit discouraged when they found nothing but crabs in the lobster traps. However, they baited them afresh and brought home the crabs.

"There's awful poor pickin' in these crabs," admitted Fred. "That's one thing Maine falls down on."

"But aren't they *some* good?" asked Dudley.

"Oh, yes, about one mouthful to a crab," returned Billy.

“Not like the ones down at Old Point Comfort and the Chesapeake!—some crabs, those!” said Fred, smacking his lips.

The boys came into Treasure Cove but it was noticed that Fred frowningly sniffed the pungent air with nose held high. And great was their disgust when the bow of the boat ran into an odoriferous mola. The hot sun beating down upon it that day had not improved its condition.

“Gee! another dirty job!” exclaimed Billy, scowling at the prow of the unconscious boat.

“That came back on the flood last night! Now we’ve got to tow it out and see what the ebb will do for it,” said Fred.

“Say, d’ye need us to help?” asked Paul. “If not, Dud and me’ll take these crabs to Mose to have him start boiling them.”

“All right, go along; and if you’re real nice in asking Anna, she’ll help you pick out the crab meat. She’s a wiz. at that work,” advised Billy.

So the two boys engagingly won the governess’ promise to pick crab meat, while Fred and Billy attended to a less attractive duty.

Once more the mola was consigned to the tide, which in this latitude rises and falls about fifteen feet at the full of the moon. Comparatively few miles to the eastward of this longitude lies the Bay of Fundy known all over the world for its hundred-foot tides.

“Say, Fred, wouldn’t it be queer if the tides rose and fell here as they do up in New Brunswick?” asked Billy.

“Why, the Captain was tellin’ me the other day,” continued the boy, “that the tide at St. John turns the Falls of the river backward, making them as high the reverse way as they are in the usual direction.

“Besides, the Captain said the tide runs off of miles of sand-flats where the pigs go to feed on shell-fish and seaweed. Now listen, Fred! Do you believe this fairy-tale of the Captain’s? *He said:* ‘When the tide turns to

come in it starts with a booming roar and the pigs know it by instinct as the death signal. At the first boom they turn tail and run squealing to high ground and safety.’”

“It may be as the Captain says, but I don’t see how the pigs can inherit that instinct of danger—the ones that learn of the penalty for lingering perish in the learning,” remarked the elder brother.

“I’d just like to go there some day and see for myself,” said Billy. “Now, old mola, even if this isn’t a Bay of Fundy tide, I hope you’ll be carried high and away for all time.”

“Yes, and good riddance to it!” added Fred, as the tow-line was thrown inboard and the boat was turned for home.

The next morning Paul and Dudley each had a small lobster in their traps and Fred consolingly remarked, “Well, that’s proof there’s some lobsters about, anyway.”

As the boat neared shore Paul jumped up and waved his cap. “Elizabeth! E-ed-ith! Look—I got a lobster!”

The girls ran quickly to the float and called back, “Oh, hold it up—let’s see how big it is?”

Paul had watched Billy grasp a lobster in a most simple but effective way so he attempted to do likewise. Unfortunately, he didn’t take up the lobster in quite the same place and the air resounded with his shrieks.

He shook his imprisoned hand so violently that the claw snapped and the lobster dropped leaving its nipper still fastened in the boy’s middle finger. However, he was soon released and had to listen to Edith’s teasing laugh.

“I thought you said you’d caught a lobster! Looks more as if the lobster caught *you*!”

“All the same, I’ll dare you to pick up one all by yourself!” indignantly rejoined Paul.

Edith then quickly changed the subject by admiring the star-fish Dudley had brought back.

“Oh,” cried she, “some of them have ten fingers and some only have six. I thought they always had five fingers.”

“That six-fingered one must have had ten originally, as you can see the remaining stumps of the others. Most star-fish do have five points but there are exceptions. This one must have got in a fight with a sea-enemy and had its other fingers bitten off,” explained Fred.

“I wish I could send some of them home,” ventured Dudley.

“They’ll keep all right, if you dry them,” said Billy.

“How?”

“Just spread them out smoothly on a board and leave it in the hot sun—then *go way off* while they dry. When the smell is dried out you can ship them home in a box.”

“But be sure you find a sunny spot far, far away from the bungalow,” laughed Fred.

“Dudley can dry them in the shade, too, if he likes,” said Elizabeth. “It will take longer but the colours won’t fade out.”

“I guess I’ll make a collection of them and some sea-urchins, too. And some coral and some—some rocks with the funny little barnacles growing on them, and—and a whole lot of things,” said Dudley, enthusiastically.

“I’ll help you, Dud, and you can keep them in the Agassiz room of your school,” added Edith.

“When will we under-run the trawl again, Cap?” called Billy, just then, as Captain Ed moored the launch at the float.

“Your father said that the girls wanted to go along this afternoon and watch the fun; so, unless it blows too fresh, I reckon that’s the programme.”

Then the boys proudly called his attention to the lobsters and the Captain laughed.

“Why, I guess I’ll have to get the lobster-car ready to hold your catch. But that feller lost a claw—what happened?”

“Here’s the claw,” admitted Paul.

“S’pose some one takes these two lobsters up to Mose and ask him to make a nice little salad for mother; she is so fond of it, you know, and then this claw can be used, too,” suggested Fred.

As they all walked toward the bungalow, Captain Ed said: “We went down into Dark Harbour this morning to bring up another bag of the coal I landed there last week, and what do you imagine Mose and I saw?”

By this time every pair of bright eyes was glued on the Captain’s expressive countenance. A dim glimmer of the truth then suddenly dawned upon Fred.

“Oh—not that mola!” gasped he.

“*The* same—and yet, not the same! Kinder ripenin’ up, it were,” laughed the Captain.

“What *did* you do with it?” shouted every one.

“Well, as long as I wuz goin’ over to Sat’aday Cove, I tells Mose I’ll snake this dainty along and lose him in the middle of the bay. So, I don’t think you’ll ever see him agin.”

Directly after lunch, Edith, who had finished first and hurried out, ran back to the dining-room in a greatly excited frame of mind.

“Oh, mamma! Some real live Indians are down on our beach.”

In less than a minute every Islander was out of the bungalow. It was ascertained that the Indians had come to the Island on a venture to sell some

of their sweet-grass baskets. They had been on the mainland where quite a colony of city folk lived, but did not dispose of all their wares.

While the girls admired the fragrant baskets, Billy took advantage of the unusual visit to ply the Indians with all sorts of questions. Where did they find sweet-grass; how they sewed birch-bark so that it wouldn't split; where did they hail from, and did they make their own canoe, as other Indians did.

One of the Indians being very agreeable answered all of the boy's questions, and then turned to invite the Islanders to visit his little camp on the east-side of Isleboro, near Sabbath-Day Harbour.

"Can't we go this afternoon?" cried Billy, eagerly.

"We can under-run the trawl to-morrow," added Elizabeth.

"How about it, Captain?" asked Mr. Remington.

"Just as you say, Mr. Remington. I can set the girls and boys over to Adams' Beach an' its only two-mile walk from there to Sabbath-Day Harbour. If these men want a tow we kin tote 'em along an' save time."

After Mrs. Remington became the possessor of a number of sweet-grass baskets for souvenirs, the Captain loaded his launch with the young folks and, lastly, added the two Indians who wisely preferred to tow an empty canoe.

The walk over Isleboro was an interesting experience. On the way, Mitchell Webster, one of the Old-Town Indians, showed the Islanders the sweet-grass pond but warned them that the sweet-grass grew alongside the ordinary grass and was difficult to recognise.

"Why," said he, "ruther 'en waste my time pickin' out th' spears of that grass I ups an' buys a pound from a feller down Old Orchard beach-way. Paid a dollar fer it, too. Kinder dear fer hay, hain't it?"

Reaching Webster's tent, the children found a squaw busily engaged in dying the thin strips of split ash that they wove into the larger baskets. Alas!

how fallen are the mighty! No more the natural vegetable dyes used by the denizens of the forest. Instead, the children found printed labels scattered about with directions for using the aniline colours.

The host told the children that he and his squaw came down from Oldtown, up the Penobscot River, and camped on Isleboro every summer, making and selling baskets. The birch-bark baskets, however, were made in Oldtown during the winter and early spring because that is the time when birch-bark is more pliable and is easier to peel off of the trees.

The young people did not remain very long, and having purchased a few baskets from the squaw, they started back for the launch.

On the return walk to Adams' Beach, having no strangers for companions, they gave closer attention to the woodland path and its mossy beauties. On a slight rise of ground, where the trees had been cut away, and the afternoon sun shone bright and hot, Elizabeth found a patch of curious russet plants. She stopped to examine them and then called to her brother.

"Look, Fred, what do you suppose these queer little flowers can be?"

Fred came back but could not identify the hairy round leaves with their sticky drops shining in the sun like dew.

"Let's dig one up and you can carry it home in the little birch-bark basket. To-night we will look up its name in the wild-flower book," he proposed, suiting the action to his words.

"Look, there's a little fly caught in the sticky hairs of one leaf," remarked Elizabeth.

Quite a breeze from the south had sprung up during their sojourn on the land, and now the children had a lively trip home in the launch. A drenched sextette reached Sunset Island, and had to scramble into dry clothes in double quick time so as not to be late for supper.

The main dish that evening was flounder, rolled in cornmeal and fried a golden brown in boiling fat. Mr. Remington served his wife and daughters

first as usual, then the younger boys, and lastly, Fred and himself.

“These flounders are as good as sole,” said he, approvingly, as he tasted a bit.

“Don’t jab at your food in that fashion, Billy!” reproved Mrs. Remington.

“But, mother, I can’t seem to cut the old fish!”

“Mine’s as tough as all get-out!” grunted Dudley.

“Say, what is this slice, anyway?” asked Fred, frowning.

Mose appeared with a plate of hot biscuits and the puzzled boys appealed to him in injured tones; Dudley especially emphatic in his demonstration of the toughness of his portion.

“Why, look, Mose, it’s like a brick-bat!”

“Don’ you-all knows yu’ own spechul brand o’ fish-steak? Ah b’lieve yuh boys caint rekernise dat mola when you’s see him!” And the chef’s tones sounded plaintive.

“Mose!” came a horrified chorus as plates were pushed away.

“There now, I knew it had a bad smell!” cried Paul.

“But hain’t he nice an’ tendered up now,” continued the wicked cook, innocently. “Cap’n an’ me didn’ have no trouble a-tall cuttin’ them slabs dis *mawnin’*. No suh! dat fish, he hed some sof’nin’ influence a-wohkin on him, come all dis time he’d ben voyagin’ up an’ down dat bay—ebb an’ flood!”

But Fred noticed that neither his father or mother seemed disturbed at these truly awful disclosures by Mose, so he began to investigate his slab of so-called mola.

“Boys,” cried he exultantly, as he exhibited a flat piece of wood, now scraped clear of fried cornmeal, “the Yanks who make nutmegs of wood

aren't in it with our Mose!"

"Well! we wouldn't have thought it of you, Mose," grieved Paul, who feared he would have to go without fish.

"You are slick, all right, Mose, 'cause you fooled every one of us boys," laughed Billy.

"And what's more, father and mother must have been in the secret, or how could father have served the phony fish to the right ones," commented Elizabeth, who enjoyed a harmless, practical joke.

Mose now brought in several nice hot flounders for the hungry boys, who ate with unabated appetites. Indeed, they had so appreciated the trick that the chef really rose several points in their estimation.

The fake mola had caused such a disturbance that Elizabeth almost forgot the queer little plant in the birchen case. But supper once over, she remembered it.

"Look, mother, what do you suppose this is?" asked she.

"Get out your flower-book and see what it says about the sun-dew; this is the rotundifolia variety."

"Why, the book says that the sun-dew is carnivorous! So that is what it was doing to the poor little fly?" said the girl, half shocked and half amazed.

The boys crowded about at this, to see the little reddish plant which suddenly became endowed with immense interest.

"Mother, do you remember that story in some magazine—about the giant carnivorous plants?" asked Fred.

"Yes, and if I remember correctly, the story said they were of the sun-dew family."

"But they ate *people*!" added Elizabeth, who had also read the story.

“It said they fairly *reached* out and grabbed people that came near to them,” laughed Mr. Remington; “but that was fiction.”

“Anyway, you dreadful catch-’em-alive little sun-dew, you make one more plant for my flower-list,” said Elizabeth.

Mr. Remington then announced: “Boys, we’ll under-run the trawl tomorrow, taking all hands along in the extra boats to see the fun. I wish I had a longer time to stay here with you—there’s nothing I’d enjoy more, but I must get back to the city ready for business on Monday.”

“Oh, papa! That’s only two days more!” wailed Elizabeth, echoed by all of the other children.

“Papa, why do you have to go—can’t you stay here for one summer?” wondered Edith.

“I certainly wish I could, but ‘where duty calls I must obey,’” quoted Mr. Remington, patting his little girl on the hair.

“Come, come, children! time for all to be in bed! Now, let me see how quickly every one can tell me they are fast asleep, so I can turn out the candles,” said Mrs. Remington, while the youngsters laughed at her ridiculous speech.

CHAPTER THREE

FOGGY DAYS AND WOODCRAFT WAYS

“LET’S get at that trawl as soon as we can,” announced Fred, as he entered the bungalow at breakfast time in the morning. “Captain says we may have a spell of foggy weather.”

“Why, it’s clear enough now,” said Dudley, in surprise.

“But look down the bay, that is not a cloud bank that you see off Rockland, that’s fog,” said Mr. Remington. “And if that southerly breeze continues we’ll get it thick.”

“But it is calm up here, so how do you know there’s a breeze down there and how do you know it’s a southerly?” questioned Dudley, who really was anxious to learn the “salt-water” wrinkles he perceived were of the utmost value in Island life.

“Don’t you see that schooner way down there? Look, how she is getting the wind,” was the enlightening reply from Fred.

“See, Dudley, the northerly wind that was blowing when we got up this morning, has all died out,” said Mrs. Remington. “And don’t you feel a curious chill in the air although the sun is still bright?”



A STRING OF CUNNERS CAUGHT BY SHELBY.



So, the breakfast was hurried through and the Captain's launch towed the big rowboat out to the trawl. On the way, they met Captain Benton from Isola Bella with three of the maids and the two little girls. Soon, that rowboat was added to the tow.

“We came over to see if you were going to look at the trawl,” announced Miriam. “Katy and Tillie want to see the fun so we made Jenny come too, though she hates a boat and told us she just knew she'd get seasick.”

“Where's Bridget?” called Billy, who was very friendly with the fat Irish cook.

“Bridget said that a sight of all those queer fish would turn her stomach—she said to me, ‘Ye see, me dear, I hev a rale wakeness in me stomach whin I see sich ungodly craythers.’” Miriam giggled as she mimicked Bridget.

But it was just as well that Bridget had not joined the party that day for the trawl outdid itself in the revelations of the vasty deep.

An immense barndoor skate was followed by a sea-toad, or puffer, which continued to swell like a balloon the longer it was out of water. Then came some haddocks and dog-fish; suddenly, Fred exclaimed at the weight of the line and there arose to view a large ungainly monk-fish, or angler.

“Oh, Captain! don't throw him overboard until I get a photo of him,” cried Paul.

So intense was the interest and the fun that only the Captain and Mr. Remington noticed the fog that had crept stealthily up until the whole bay south of Flat Island was a blank wall of impenetrable mist.

“Come, come—we must get back now!” And Mr. Remington soon had his convoy arranged and the launch chugged away for Isola Bella wharf

where it left Benton and his party the richer by several fine haddocks.

The Sunset Islanders reached the float-stage just before the fog shut them in.

“Make up a good fire in the bungalow,” said Mrs. Remington to Billy and Dudley. “And every one see that the tent-flaps are close shut to keep out as much of this dampness as possible.”

The novelty of the fog was at first delightful to the younger boys but when they realised that they were forbidden to even get into a boat while the treacherous white veil covered the island, they revised their judgment.

Elizabeth was a little aggrieved, too. “Just think, Uncle Tom and Aunt Edith will arrive in the morning and I wanted to go over to Rosemary to meet them. Now, this old fog will probably last two or three days.”

And so it proved. On account of this white barrier the Captain alone took Mr. Remington to Rosemary, Uncle Tom’s summer home on the mainland below Saturday Cove. From there, the Charlton’s motor conveyed the now transformed Islander to the New York express train at Rockland.

The only blight on the camper’s joy in Maine was the necessity for “business fathers” to leave their families there and return to the hot city. But often, an extra week-end was tucked in by both Mr. Remington and Mr. Farwell. Fate seemed to so arrange it however, that both men were rarely on their respective islands simultaneously. Uncle Tom Charlton was more fortunate as his business allowed him a long continuous vacation which he always enjoyed to the utmost.

“Captain,” said he to the returning launch-man, “as soon as this fog clears, we’ll be over to see you all. Tell Fred that two young college boys are going to be my guests for the week-end and I want them to get a taste of salt-water. They are from Georgia and while they are out-of-doors fellows they have always lived inland.”

This message was received with interest by Fred and the other campers and the fog was again appropriately consigned to “Halifax.”

“Never mind,” consoled Mrs. Remington; “use this enforced curtailment of your liberty by doing some listing up of your Woodcraft work.”

“That’s so! After we have filled the wood-boxes and helped Captain clean and salt those fish we’ll just look up the Nature *Coups* and see how much this Pentagoet Tribe knows about the denizens of the briny,” said Fred.

“Am I in your Pentagoet Tribe, now?” asked Paul.

“We will formally take you in at our first Council,” replied Fred.

“Me too!” cried Dudley. “That’ll be great! I was wondering how we’d fix it ’cause I want to be in a Woodcraft Tribe and not by my lonesome all summer.”

Nature books, pencils and paper, to say nothing of the “thinking caps” were all called upon that evening to do active service, so the fog was forgotten. Paul and Dudley triumphantly passed the examination of the twenty-five different fish they had listed up and identified. The lists were the same, as the two boys had been together in the pursuit of this Nature *coup*.

With genuine pride they copied the list on the backs of their official Honour claims for the fish *coup*.

Fish *Coup*.

1. Mola—or deep-sea Sunfish
2. Cunner
3. Hake
4. Haddock
5. Mackerel
6. Pollock
7. Harbour Pollock

8. Tom Cod
9. Cod
10. Skate
11. Shark
12. Dog-fish
13. Monk-fish—or Angler
14. Toad-fish—or Puffer
15. Sculpin
16. Salmon
17. Flounder
18. Sword-fish
19. Halibut
20. Herring
21. Shad (Fresh water fish)
22. Brook Trout (Fresh water fish)
23. Catfish (Fresh water fish)
24. Brook Sunfish (Fresh water fish)
25. Suckers (Fresh water fish)

Elizabeth helped Edith print the names of her list which varied a trifle because she had gold-fish on her fresh-water list and a lump-fish on her salt-water list of fish.

“Oh,” cried Edith, “I wish you all could have seen my little green lump-fish—he was so cute! Just like a little mould of jelly.”

“Like a jelly-fish?” asked Paul.

“Mercy no! It was shaped like a real fish only it was lumpy. Captain brought it to me in a bucket of water but I let it go again ’cause he was so

little and funny.”

“Say, isn’t it lucky for our lists that we were all down in New London last summer and saw the fish there before they were cut up for the market,” said Dudley.

“You just bet! That gave us a good start—that sword-fish and halibut they showed us there,” affirmed Paul.

“Oh, look, boys! The fog is lifting!” cried Elizabeth.

“Perhaps it will be clear to-morrow,” added Fred.

So, cheered by this hope they all retired to their tents which only the use of oil-stoves had rendered dry in the dripping moisture of the fog.

The morning was lovely and the brisk nor’wester blew away all memory of the fog. In spite of the hard pull in the breeze, the boys insisted upon visiting their lobster pots.

“Oh joy! a lobster to-day for every one of us excepting Paul. But there are two in Fred’s trap,” counted Billy.

“Yes, and one of them’s big enough to enter for the prise contest. I’m going to weigh and measure it,” said Fred, steering the boat into Treasure Cove.

A launch whistle sounded “toot-toot!” while the scales and tape were being used for the lobster, and there was the Orion bringing Uncle Tom and the two big boys eager for the sights of the island camp.

Friendships are quickly made under such conditions and when the Orion returned Shelby Jordan and Henry Pou were left for an over-night visit with Fred.

“I’ll lend them anything they need and besides, we do not dress up for fishing you know,” Fred assured his uncle and aunt, as they were saying good-bye to the boys.

The whole island was explored and one of the things that keenly interested the visitors was the Woodcraft Council Ring. So many questions were asked that Fred suggested a Council for that afternoon, that the boys might see for themselves just how one was conducted.

“Captain says we’re not going to under-run the trawl to-day, as he wants to put the fish we already have on the flats to dry. He’ll take us down to Flat Island in the launch and then drop us off at Isola Bella so we can invite the folks there. Then we’ll come back and hold a Council here at four o’clock,” planned Fred.

“Take along oil-skins and rubber caps,” warned his mother, “or you’ll all get wet on the way back.”

The visitors were intensely interested in the fish-drying operations and asked numerous questions of Captain Ed. The latter had to admit that the fog had been mighty bad for the “sweet” process of drying. “But they always smell a *leetle* anyway, and a few days of good hot sun will soon cure them now.”

It is doubtful however, if Shelby and Henry manifested the same appetite for salt-fish after being present at the scene on the flats where the “perfume factory” was all-sufficient.

The first Common Council was a merry and impromptu affair although conducted with due form and in parliamentary fashion. Fred was in the chair as “Island Chief” which was indeed the meaning of his Woodcraft title of Wita-tonkan.

For the benefit of the visitors he gave a little talk on Woodcraft and explained why they called the various groups Tribes, and chose Indian names in recognition of service or prowess.

“You see, we belong to the Woodcraft League which is composed of groups of young folks and older people, too, who like outdoor life and believe it helps make better citizens.

“We Woodcrafters prove that sensible exercise in the outdoors, preferably with some desirable aim in view, prepares us for the business of life.

“The pioneers of this country learned genuine Woodcraft from the Indians, and that is one reason why, here in America, we use Indian ceremonies in our Councils—sort of ”America First“ don’t you know.

“Why should we go back to Greece for examples of runners when the fleetest-footed Marathoners could have been given points by the village heralds of an Indian Tribe?

“When we hold a Grand Council we usually try to give it the semblance of a genuine American Indian affair. Indian costumes and customs are not necessary at all to Woodcraft but it adds a romantic touch. Looking up all of these things really teaches one a lot of American history, too.

“The same training and observation, and what I’ve heard a professor call ‘Co-ordination of mind and muscle’ with which the sturdy pioneers conquered the wilderness enables us to get along better in more civilised times—but maybe we’re not more civilised after all, with this war in Europe and our share in the savage condition of things.

“Well, to conclude, we boys are the Pentagoet Tribe of Woodcrafters and the girls, during our life on this Island, belong to us, too. At home, though, we have separate tribes that we boys and girls belong to.

“Now, brothers, we will begin by singing the Omaha Tribal Prayer which means, ‘Father, a needy one stands before Thee—I that sing am he.’”

With this, the Chief concluded and Elizabeth read the Tally of the last summer’s last Council and the Chair appointed her Tally-Chief again for the current meeting.

The roll-call showed fourteen present, counting visitors, and the reports of the scouts were confined to the mola and the trawling. But Billy—or to give him his ceremonial name of Shingebis—was interested in the prospect of swimming, so he reported on the temperature of the water in Treasure

Cove. In spite of the recent fog it was growing warmer every day although it never was really comfortably warm.

The first business transacted was the welcoming of Paul and Dudley into the Pentagoet Tribe, as they were being transferred from the Grey Fox Band started by Mrs. Remington the previous winter for the Baker boys and their friends. The two boys did not have to take an initiation again as that had been attended to at the founding of the Grey Foxes.

Then came the awarding of Honours. The two Georgia boys were quite surprised by the businesslike way in which the *coups* were claimed and joined in the chorus of "Hows" as Wita-Tonkan presented the coveted *coup* feathers, symbolic of attainment.

When Edith was called upon she replied: "Oh Chief! I want to claim my *coups* when papa is present."

"So do I, Oh Chief!" asserted Elizabeth, so the entertainment continued with various challenges—the visitors taking part in hand-wrestling, tub-tilting, and racing, to their great satisfaction. Shelby Jordan introduced a new stunt called "Japanese Cane-crawling" and it proved to be a popular game.

It was nearly supper time when the Council closed and the boys heard Mose ring the bell. The Isola Bella contingent said good-bye and were soon on the homeward sail while the Islanders hastened to avail themselves of the call to supper.

Having two Southern boys present to appreciate his culinary skill, Mose outdid himself. The spoon-bread and molasses and cocoanut pie vanished that night like dew before a morning sun.

Two extra cots were placed in Fred's sibley-teepee and the visitors had the unusual experience of undressing and going to bed before a little fire in the centre of the tent: a comfort not to be despised on a cool Maine night.

On the morrow a little southwest breeze was blowing and the boys all hurried off to the trawl, Shelby and Henry disguised in old trousers and

sweaters found in the “slop-chest,” as the closet back of the living-room was termed.

When the boat reached the mooring buoy Shelby asked, “What do you call that craft?” indicating an old patched-sail lumberman that was tacking across the water toward Sunset Island.

“That’s a two-masted schooner,” replied Billy. “Isn’t she a beauty? Guess she’s old enough to vote.”

“Maine hasn’t got equal suffrage yet, or I guess she would have been voting these many years,” chuckled Fred.

“Say, Cap! Look at her now—she’s trying to run down our Island,” cried Billy.

For some moments past the Captain had been watching the old schooner and now he exclaimed: “By Heck! They must all be asleep or dead on board her. If she clears the south-end she’ll drift down on our Medric!”

Fear made the Captain turn his launch and make for the little sloop Medric which was anchored off the float-stage of Sunset Island.

With a booming crash, however, and a terrifying slatting of sails, the old schooner piled up on the rocks of the little peninsula-point on the extreme south of the island, named Cape Horn by the Islanders.

Two lank youths were seen scrambling out of the companionway of the vessel’s cabin and a third was observed aft of the wheel. The breeze was increasing every minute and the situation of the stranded schooner was such that it was dangerous to board her from the water. But, it was nearly high tide and her bowsprit almost touched the grass on the high bank, or spur of ledge that Billy called Pulpit Rock. Consequently, it didn’t take long for the trawlers to land and swing themselves aboard the wreck by means of her jib-sheets and bobstay.

Mrs. Remington and the girls had heard the crash and the shouts from the schooner and they all ran from the bungalow to see what had happened;

soon, they too joined the others in the unusual excitement of trying to save a wreck.

The young skipper and mate of the schooner were crestfallen for it appeared they had been fast asleep after a night of dancing and revelry in their hometown of Rockport. The third youth was even more disgusted with himself for he had been steering and had actually stretched himself out and dozed while he left the wheel in a cleat.

“You’ve only got half an hour of tide to help yuh git floated off,” called Captain Ed.

“Don’t we know it,” surlily replied the older boy, most likely thinking of the reckoning with his stern father who owned the Edward Everett.

“Well, I kin set you over to Sat’aday Cove so’s you kin git some one to tackle this job,” offered the kindly Captain.

“And they ought to do it right away, too, or she’ll break up,” added Fred.

Without loss of time, therefore, the Rockport crew accepted the Captain’s offer. Luckily for them, the wind died down toward sunset. In the meantime, the boys had under-run the trawl and added to their abundant stock of fish on Flat Island.

The next day the irate father of the luckless mariner arrived with two small fishing schooners and a load of empty blue barrels which had once contained “Pennsylvania Fluid.” The men worked hard all morning, securing the barrels beneath the Edward Everett, then when high tide came the now leaky old craft was kedged back out of her rocky berth.

“Good-bye, Ned!” cried the irrepressible Dudley, waving his cap at the departing schooner.

“Boy, you shouldn’t speak disrespectfully of an old grand-daddy like that, er call him by his first name,” admonished the Captain, jocularly.

The Orion had appeared in time to watch the old antique craft retire after her hardy bout with Sunset Island rocks and when the excitement was all over Uncle Tom called to Shelby and Henry to get their things together as he was going to tote them back to Rosemary.

The two boys were really sorry to go but they realised that it was Mr. and Mrs. Charlton they were visiting and at least a single day of the week-end was due their hosts.

Farewells were said and Elizabeth, who had been wildly scribbling while the boys were preparing to embark on the Orion, now presented them with a memento of their visit in the form of a parody on "The Last Buccaneer" which she entitled "The First Wreck on Here."

The winds were yelling, the waves were swelling
All sunny and fair in the morn,
When the crew who were adoze, brought the Edward Everett's nose
On the ledges of Old Cape Horn.

Up the ledges ran her keel, and to leeward did she heel,
Till her jib-sheets flapped on Pulpit Rock;
And the sleeping Rockport boys awakened by the noise,
Laid sprawled around by the shock.

“Oh, from Rockport's clammy shore, where southerlies oft roar
With our wheel in a cleat did we steer.
Above I was asleep and below in slumber deep,
My comrades were wrapped without fear.”

Oh, to-morrow shall be borne from the rocks of stern Cape Horn
A loud cheer and a louder cry,
As along the old jib-boom, for as many as there's room,
Shall the pirates of Sunset Island hie.

Oh, the Medric, our pride, securely now may ride,
In the breath of the balsam around,
“Oh, Captain, there's no use, to go and cut her loose,
For the Edward Everett's aground.”

The next few days passed swiftly by in doing the usual camp-work varied by Billy's efforts to run the launch—he was hoping to own one himself some day; and the other boys' indifferent success at wood-chopping to keep the boxes filled, showed the youthful engineer that they wished they could be with him.

Then came the day set aside by Mrs. Remington for a “laundry party.” She said she hadn't the courage to send such awful clothes to the Islesboro Steam Laundry.

However, the sting of this occasion was removed by the unexpected promise of the first swim that season when the wash was finished.

While the boys were soaking their trawling duds in hot soapy water, good-natured Mose brought them a large bottle of household ammonia. As he drew near the tub he pretended to believe they were preparing a new kind of fish chowder.

“Yo’ don’ tell me dem are cloe’s yo’ got fermentin’ in dat tub,” cried he aghast. “Why, dey’s got scales like a fish, an’ dey smells like a fish, an’ Ah b’lieve yo-all tryin’ t’fix up a new-fangle kin’ ov fish-soup! It looks lak some ov dat tin-soup broth! Ah spec’s hit’ll tas’ mos’ de same, too,” and Mose sniffed at the aroma with a true chef’s expressive disdain.

The boys laughed and Mose hoaxed them until every one was in a good humour, then the wise old cook went back to his work chuckling to himself. “Hit all depen’s on how yo’ han’le boys when dey gotta nasty job on ’er han’s to do!”

Then, how the boys enjoyed their plunge in the sea, even though Paul and Dudley confided to each other that they were quite sure the temperature was below zero that day.

Mrs. Remington herded them out in a few minutes and the balance of the day was spent in trying various athletic exercises to restore the quick circulation of the blood of youth.



THE WAR BONNET OF THE SAGAMORE.
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CHAPTER FOUR

COUNCIL THIS AFTERNOON

“UNCLE BILL! Uncle Bill! Council this afternoon!” came a chorus of voices over the stretch of water between the sailing dory and the Farwell’s launch which had just made a landing at her pier.

“You just got here in time: three o’clock this afternoon,” added Fred, as he steered the dory closer to the launch.

“Hey! Don’t run me down,” laughingly joked Mr. Farwell. “There, that’s better! Now, Miriam, come over here and kiss your old father.”

As the dory gently glided alongside the launch, Miriam sprang aboard and hugged her jolly father.

“Oh, papa! I’m going to win a *coup* to-day! I’m so glad you’re here to see me get it. And Paul’s going to have one of the green tassels cut off his badge, too. Cousin Fred has been training us all.”

“Well, well! Fred has so many *coups* now, I suppose he can spare you some, eh?”

“Oh, papa! you *know* I couldn’t take any one else’s *coups*! I have to win them myself!” declared Miriam.

“Never mind him, you know he is only teasing you,” said Fred, soothingly. “But Uncle Bill, Miriam is going back with *us* as she has to make out her *coup* claim properly and she is going to help us prepare for the Council. Please, everybody come! We just count on you, Uncle Bill, to liven everything up, you know.”

“Depend upon your Uncle Bill! Now, young ’uns—lively about it, if you’re going! I’m about starved and nothing will keep me here a minute longer. If I don’t show up at the house pretty soon, Bridget will think I’ve had luncheon, and what a calamity that would be! See you all later—three o’clock sharp!” And Uncle Bill caught up his suitcase, jumped out on the wharf, and called to his wife: “I’m starved! I’m starved! Fee fo fi fum!”

Meantime Mrs. Farwell had been talking confidentially to Elizabeth and Miriam. Then, as she laughed and promised them to keep the secret, they left her. She watched them climb safely down to the dory again before she turned to give some orders to the Captain of the Zeus, finally turning to follow her shouting and singing lord and master up the path to the house.

The two girls pushed off from the launch, Fred let the sheet run out and before a light southerly breeze, the little dory soon showed her heels to the wharf at one island and in about ten minutes was lying at the float-stage of the other.

While Fred furled the sails of the dory, Billy ran down the cliffs to meet the sailors. “Say there! You’d just better hurry up! Lunch is most ready!”

Quiet reigned during the first part of the luncheon as every one was hungry. But as appetites abated, Billy started a discussion as to some of the entertainment for the Council in the afternoon. It appeared that he and Dudley and Paul had a motion picture play of a jitney which they were anxious to give.

“Have you rehearsed it—do you know if it is any good?” asked Fred, sceptically.

“You know we don’t want anything below par,” added Elizabeth.

“Well, if you doubt us, we’ll do it right here to let you judge!” offered Paul, eagerly.

“Guess you’d better,” replied Fred.

So, the three boys left the table and placed three chairs—two side by side and one directly in front of the other two. Bill played the part of chauffeur and went through all of the motions of starting a jitney. No sooner was it running than a passenger (Paul) hailed him to stop. The chauffeur made the motions of applying brakes, getting out to open the door and assist the passenger inside, then tried to crank up again.

No sooner had he succeeded in starting the engine again, than a second passenger (Dudley) hailed the jitney to stop. Billy repeated the same actions as before but the first “fare” refused to move over in the seat and the second one tripped over his outstretched feet.

Again the chauffeur cranked and at last they were off! ’Twas the “rocky road to Dublin” all right, for the luckless passengers swayed and bumped in their seats, until suddenly the car stopped on a hill. Try as he would, the poor chauffeur could not start it again.

He came to the door and implored the two passengers to help him push the machine up the hill. They were indignant but finally consented. The brow of the hill reached they all jumped in again and down the jitney coasted. Just as the engine was nicely started again, the car struck a rut and overturned.

When Billy signalled the overturn, Paul, Dudley and he, tipped over the chairs and all lay sprawling on the floor.

A chorus of “Hows” greeted the performance and the juvenile contingent judged it worthy of the Council audience.

“Well, maybe we can improve on this, too, when we once feel the spirit of the Council move us,” ventured Billy.

“Oh sure thing!” bragged Paul, chestily.

And the others laughed heartily at his manner, but nothing daunted, Paul added, “Practice makes perfect, you know.”

A quiet half hour was spent in signing up *coup* claims and looking over the Tally of the last Council. Then, every one retired to the tents to dress in ceremonial Woodcraft costumes.

As the last Brave left his tent the chugging of engines was heard and the launch Orion rounded the south end of Sunset Island, while at the same time the Zeus arrived from Isola Bella.

The Orion brought Aunt Edith and Uncle Tom from the mainland. With them were some visitors and Miss Travis, known to the boys and girls as Aunt Flo-flo. Aunt Edith introduced one of the visitors to the members of the Pentagoet Tribe.

“This is my little friend Trixie Ashe—she has come to spend several weeks at Rosemary.”

Trixie was about thirteen but looked older. Being the only child and always in the society of elders she felt out of her element in the camp of the young Woodcrafters. Then, too, she was expensively dressed in apparel more adapted for a house-party than for a rough outing.

Trixie looked around with keen interest at the animated faces of the boys and girls she had heard so much about during the past few days. Her opinions, already formed of how such athletic young folks would look, underwent a sudden change. Before she had quite finished her survey, Trixie admitted to herself that she had never met a group of such fine-looking happy young people.

She turned to Aunt Edith and remarked, “You didn’t exaggerate a bit, Mrs. Charlton, when you told me how picturesque the costumes were and how very interesting the Island is.”

“I am glad you like it, but really you know, these costumes are for ceremonial occasions only. No one could run or feel free in them for actual camp-life. We have a suitable uniform for every-day use,” returned Aunt Edith.

During this interview, Mrs. Remington and Mrs. Farwell were giving Bridget with “the secret” (an immense layer cake) into Mose’s charge, for there were to be refreshments served at the end of the Council.

“Come along now, Woodcrafters—it’s nearly three o’clock,” reminded Billy, leading the way to the Council place.

The others followed and soon Fred, in full costume, took the Council Chair and opened the meeting by proclaiming: “Meetah Kola, nayhoonpo omnicheeyey nee-chopi”—meaning, “Hear me my friends, we are about to hold a council.”

“Shingebis will now light the Council Fire after the manner of the Forest Children,” ordered Wita-tonkan, the Island Chief, turning to Billy as he spoke.

Then Shingebis, “The Northern Diver,” brought his fire-sticks to the centre of the Council Ring and proceeded to make fire by rubbing the sticks briskly until an almost imperceptible wisp of smoke curled up from the tiny heap of black wood-dust that fell into the fire-pan under the sticks. More and denser smoke followed.

The moment a spark glowed in this powder, the group of Woodcrafters greeted it with a “How!” and a louder chorus of “Hows” sounded as a flame burst forth from the handful of tinder which Shingebis applied.

“Now know we that Wakonda hath been pleased to smile upon us,” said Wita-tonkan, solemnly.

A few moments after the fire was burning well, the Chief took up the peace-pipe and explained that he was about to perform the peace-pipe ceremony.

“First I light the cedar bark and kinnikinick, or dried red ozier dogwood bark, in the bowl of the pipe. Now I offer the peace-pipe to Wakonda, the Great Spirit and Maka Ina, Mother Earth, imploring their presence at the Council. The whole Council must answer ‘Noon-way’ or amen to these prayers.

“Then I proceed to beg each of the Four Winds in turn to do us no harm from cyclone, cold, rain or heat. All present will please respond ‘Noon-way’ as before.”

The visitors were quite impressed and when the first prayer came, “Hay-oon-kee-ya” (Be with us) the response was fervent. Then, as the pipe was presented to the West Wind, and Wita-tonkan cried, “Hay-oon-kee-oon-ee-ya-snee” (Come not upon us) the chorus of “noon-ways” was so loud that Mose and Bridget who were now busy in the bungalow making lemonade, fairly jumped.

“When Ah git done wid dis lemyonade Ah’s e goin’ out behin’ dose rocks an’ watch d’ show,” declared Mose.

“Shure, an’ Oi’ll be wid’ye,” promised Bridget, emphatically.

The peace-pipe ceremony being concluded and the Tally read, Wita-tonkan suggested that, there being so many visitors present, they make short work of preliminary business matters and proceed directly to the claiming of the *Coups*.

“Are there any Honours to be claimed?” called Wita-tonkan.

“Oh Chief!” said Miriam, standing up instantly to show her father her knowledge of Woodcraft, “I claim an Honour for standing broad-jump—five and a half feet.”

“Have you the claim properly attested by three witnesses?” asked the Chief.

“Here it is,” replied Miriam, holding out a paper. “And moreover, my witnesses are present in Council.”

“Come forward, Miriam,” announced Wita-tonkan, taking the claim from her hand. He read it aloud to the assembled Council and asked, “You have all heard this claim, properly made out and witnessed, and now what is the pleasure of the Council regarding this matter?”

Shingebis stood, saluted and said, “Oh Chief! I move that this Honour be awarded.”

Paul now stood, saluted and said, “Oh Chief! I second this motion.”

Wita-tonkan then said to the assembly, “This claim has been duly moved and seconded and now, it is ready for the vote, there being no question of its validity. The Council will please make its wishes known by saying ‘How’ for approval, and ‘Wah’ for dissent.”

Then the loud chorus of “hows” brought Mose and Bridget running from the kitchen to the vantage point back of the boulder.

The Chief, taking Miriam by the hand, congratulated her and presented her with the *coup* feather symbolising her attainment. She smilingly took her seat amid the pleased murmurs of the Pentagoet Tribe.

“Any more Honours to be claimed?” asked the Chief.

“Oh Chief! I have at last completed the requirements for the last rank in the Little Lodge,” cried Paul, springing to his feet. “I was eleven years old last month, so I am anxious to do this before I pass into the Big Lodge.”

Paul had various sheets of paper signed by his witnesses at different times throughout the past year which he now presented to the Chief. Wita-tonkan read them aloud to the Council.

“Know one wild bird for each year of your age.”

“Oh Chief! I really know a lot more than eleven birds—I am trying for the Bird *coup*,” explained Paul, proudly.

Wita-tonkan continued: “Know one wild four-footed animal for each year of your age.”

“I knew twelve animals my first year in Woodcraft,” said Paul.

“Know one forest tree for each year of your age.”

“I know more than enough for that too; we found so many kinds of trees at Wickeecheokee Farm last summer when the Little Woodcrafters spent a week in camp there,” explained Paul.

“Know one wild flower for each year of your age.”

“Oh, I know nearly enough to win the flower *coup*,” boasted Paul, looking around at the others.

“Know one garden-flower or shrub for each year of your age.”

Paul nodded that he had done this also.

So Wita-tonkan read on to the last of the requirements now accomplished by Paul, until he read the last one which was: “Know one constellation for each year of age.”

“Oh, I got that one easy! I only had to know three, but I was so near twelve years, that I just learned another one to make four for good measure,” ventured Paul.

“Which is the good measure?” laughed Wita-tonkan.

“I found Orion and know all about him,” declared Paul, then he proceeded to describe the Hunter with his Club.

Bridget, listening intently to this part of the Council procedure, gasped at the information vouched for by Paul.

“Mose, shure an’ that hunter must hev been me ancistor—O’ryan! He war a king ov Oireland, God bliss the old Sod! An’ Oi’m tould that O’ryan alwiss carried a cloob too: a black t’horn cloob it war!”

Moses looked sceptically at the rotund figure of the Farwell’s cook and doubted the truth of her imperial descent. But the name suddenly struck him as being familiar and he remembered where he had heard it so often.

“Agh, shucks! It isn’t yo’ ancestor, Bridget, at all! They be talkin’ ’bout th’ Charlton’s motor launch—dat’s called ’Ryan after a bunch ov stars!”

declared Moses, complacently.

“Shure, an’ don’ ye’se tink Oi don’ know me own fam’ly histry ov all th’ great men what come from th’ ole sod!” scorned Bridget, turning her broad back disdainfully upon Mose. “An’ don’t Oi know it war afther me great-grand-fayther that Misther Cha’ton named his boat ‘O’ryan’!”

While the controversy lasted between the native of the Sunny South and the descendant of Kings from the Emerald Isle, Paul had the last tassel of inexperience cut from his Woodcrafter’s Badge and took his seat with a sense of having accomplished something worth while.

The Chief then found no other Honours to be claimed so he proceeded to the entertainment of the guests present.

“Are there any Braves eager to challenge each other?” asked he.

“Oh Chief! I challenge Shingebis to a hand-wrestling match!” called Dudley, known in Council as Wahdago.

“I accept, Oh Chief!” replied Billy, quickly.

Then followed a mortal combat (?) between the two equally experienced Braves, until both were red in the face and puffing for wind. In the end, Wahdago lost an opportunity and Shingebis was quick to avail himself of the mistake. Thus the contest ended by awarding Billy the victory.

“Any more challenges?” came from the Chief.

“Oh Chief! I challenge Paul to a canoe tilting contest,” called Billy.

“I propose that we defer that contest for the present and watch any game or match that needs to take place in the circle. We will go down to Treasure Cove later for the water sports,” advised Fred.

Then Uncle Bill jumped up and raised his hand in salute. “Oh Chief! I challenge any one present to recite original poetry written for this or a similar occasion which has not yet been heard by others.”

“I accept that challenge, Oh Chief,” laughed Elizabeth, sending a knowing glance at her Aunt Miriam.

Thereupon, Uncle Bill drew forth a paper and cleared his throat. Having made obeisance to the Chief and then to the guests, he read:

Mpret.

On Albania's throne
When the war clouds met
Shivering alone
Sat little Mpret.
Said he to himself
“As Wilyum of Wied
There was far less pelf
But much less need
Of a quiet nest
Where a prince might dream
And sure of his rest
Let his medals gleam.
Now this ‘safety first’
Is good dope, I wot:
This war is accursed
I'll go on my yacht.”
The throne is empty:
“It's the one best bet,
It will stay that way!”
Said little Mpret.

Applause greeted the conclusion of this little skit and Uncle Bill resumed his seat, bowing with a conqueror's air, as if to say he knew the laurels were his. But he also knew that he had no mean competitor in Elizabeth, who now stood up and prefaced her verse.

“Every one here knows that the first sail of the season is not all joy—particularly if it is choppy, or if there is a heavy sea on and the wind falls

and the craft bobs around helplessly. If you are not accustomed to the motion and you lose interest in the sights and sounds, you may also begin to lose other things as well.”

Several of those present began to laugh for they sensed the trend of Elizabeth’s prologue as referring to a sickly time Uncle Bill experienced during his first sail on troubled waters.

“My poem is called ‘Sea-sick,’” explained Elizabeth.

“The mate was sick, the Captain too,
The passengers and ‘hand’;
The breeze was strong enough to slew
The boat around the strand.

The waves were some unpleasant heights;
They bumped the trusty boat
We lay beneath the seats and sights,
And wished we weren’t afloat.

A land-loom came into our view,
A hull-down took from sight,
The hulls of tugs and steamers blue—
But we wished it was night.

A herd of porpoises then came
And bobbed about our ship:
We had no wish to see a fish—
The sky-line seemed to dip.

We tacked our boat and went ashore
And had a solid meal.
We did not want to feel much more
The way we just did feel!”

When Elizabeth finished, every one cried “How” and Aunt Edith declared she was deeply affected by the vivid description—it almost made her seasick!

“Who was mate on that trip?” asked Uncle Tom.

“Fred was mate and I was the ‘hand’ but I won’t tell tales on the Captain—let him speak for himself,” laughed Elizabeth.

“Well, I was the passenger and I can swear to *my* feelings,” exclaimed Billy, looking at his Uncle Bill.

But Uncle Bill returned the look boldly and murmured: “From what you say, that sure must have been some sail!”

“Wah! Wah!” cried a number of voices and everyone laughed.

The poetry had to be judged for other virtues than mere fidelity of description, so the “palm” was awarded to the composer of “Mpret.”

Following this verse contest, Billy announced that he and two friends would produce a moving picture play depicting a jitney in distress. So many impromptu additions were shown that the rough and tumble “movie” was highly applauded by the other children.

This over, the Chief stood up. “For a change in the programme, I think we will call upon Pah-hlee-oh, The Moon Maid, to entertain us by dancing the Storm Cloud.”

Fred had signalled Elizabeth while the Jitney act was being done, and she slipped away from the circle unseen by the others. At the beating of the tom-toms she now appeared from behind a group of trees, holding a long white veil behind her head. The veil was of chiffon and the light breeze wafted it gracefully about as the dancer entered the Council Ring.

The Storm Cloud dance is one of the most graceful of the Indian Dances and Elizabeth was well-trained so a genuine treat was given the visitors that day.

Then to the surprise of every one present, Uncle Tom stood and said, “I challenge Uncle Bill to a tub-tilting match.”

This also proved a great success, for Uncle Bill, always ready to provoke fun and laughter, did his part with great gusto. The result was that the exact rules were not followed but far greater sport was furnished by the two heavy performers in unexpected actions and twists and ferocious grimaces.

After a Folk Song contest and Character Dances were given, every one walked down to the Cove to watch the canoe tilting between the two boys with Captain Ed and Benton as seconds. This was interesting as the boys were well matched, but Billy came off victorious at last, having upset his opponent by thrusting the soft-padded pole suddenly in the pit of his stomach.

Billy and Dudley dressed and then a Talk Fest was started by the Chief against Dudley; as they finished the victory was accorded Dudley with the remark, “He’s the fastest talker on the hemisphere!”

The appearance of Mose, carrying a huge tray of refreshments, now put to flight any other ideas of sport, and when the ever-hungry Woodcrafters were satisfied, the obliging waiter flopped down in a kitchen chair and looked wearily up at Bridget for consolation.

“Ah d’clare t’ goodness, d’ way dem fo’kses ack in dat Woodcraf’ bisnis, an’ den go an’ git such empty stomachs, is amusin’ t’ me! Jus’ look at dem vacant plates—would yo’ b’lieve dey had ben piled up high wid san’witches an’ fixin’s t’ say nuffin of th’ cake an’ lemyonade!”

Bridget had been taxed to the limit by the great demand for lemonade, and she sniffed disdainfully: “’Twar mesilf ez beat twelve aigs in th’ layer cake! No wonder it melted away like snow in July! Not a crumb fer the cook, ayther!”

Mose looked compassionately at the defrauded cook and remarked: “Ah’ve hearn say dat a *good* chef neveh gits lef’ fo’ a bite! Now Ah’m a *fust*-class cook so Ah had a good big snack o’ dat twelve aig cake befoh it passed outen my control!”

Bridget sent Mose a resentful look and flounced angrily from the kitchen, while Mose shook with silent amusement at his competitor in culinary arts.

The guests departed in the sunset glow and the Pentagoet Tribe felt that they had acquitted themselves unusually well, thereby earning a good night's sleep.

CHAPTER FIVE

WINNING THE DEGREE OF SHINGEBIS

FOR the next few days the Island Tribe was busy getting up Swimming *Coups*. Shingebis made sure he had passed the necessary tests for the Swimming Degree. He had won the *coup* for swimming one hundred yards a long time before but had now to swim with all clothes on. This promised to be great sport and every one looked forward to the exhibition with delight.

The morning dawned bright and warm. By eleven A. M. the sun shone hot upon the calm bay, and the high tide before luncheon was just what was wanted for the exhibitors.

Miriam and her little sister Betty arrived about ten o'clock and shortly after, the Rosemary Aunt and Uncle with Trixie came scrambling up the steps from the floating-stage. Soon the procession of "Annette Kellermans" in rubber bathing caps of every colour, and the boys brown-legged and brown-armed, ran down the well-worn path leading to Treasure Cove, a genuine Island sight.

Suddenly Fred stopped and turned to Billy who unexpectedly collided with him.

"Say! We forgot the sand bag!" exclaimed Fred.

"Gee! So we have—I'll run back and hunt one," offered Billy, starting for the bungalow to find a bag that would hold the necessary five pounds of sand.

"I'll go, too!" called Paul, following Billy.

At the kitchen door, Billy hailed the cook.

“Say, Mose, got a bag that’ll hold five pounds?” asked Billy, looking about quickly.

“Wha’fo’, Chile?” wondered Mose, suspiciously.

“Oh, I have to do a stunt for a *coup*—a strong white salt bag will do.”

“Ah reckon Ah kin len’ yo’ th’ cook-salt bag but don’ yo’ go an’ waste enny salt outen the bag. Ah jes’ got this lot o’ salt an’ its gotta las’ me a fo’tnight!” As he spoke Mose took the full salt-bag from the shelf to hand to Billy.

“Pooh! We can’t use your old salt—all I want is the *bag*!” laughed Billy, rummaging about in the kitchen cupboard.

“See heah, Bo! don yo’ go t’ dislodgin’ m’ pots an’ pans now! Jes’ give Mose time t’ dig out a bag, will yo’?” So saying, the southern cook yanked a crate out from a corner and lifted a heavy burlap bag therefrom.

“How’s dis? It’ll onny take a shake t’ dump out th’ rock salt—er kin yo’ use the hull thing jus’ as it is?”

Billy laughed and Paul declared, “Mose, you’re a numm-skull, sure as shootin’.”

“You see, Mose,” explained Billy, “before that bag of salt was in the water very long it would be melted and a cinch for any diver to bring up from the bottom. I am going to try out the test for diving and we must have a white bag holding just five pounds of sand. White, so I can see it under water, you know. The sand will wash out of a loose-meshed bag like burlap, and it wouldn’t weigh more than two or three pounds by the time I had it on shore, and that wouldn’t be fair.”

“Sho, nuff! A flour bag is jus what yo’ want—an’ Ah emptied one dis mawnin’, too. Yo’ kin weigh five poun’s on dis scale, Ah reckon,” agreed Mose, handing Billy the scale and going for the bag.

“By the way, Mose, aren’t you coming down to watch the fun?” asked Paul, as they took the bag and started away.

“Ah shore am, Honey! Jes’ waitin’ t’ remove dis pan o’ biskits from d’ oven!”

“Let’s run across to the float and get another boat,” suggested Paul.

“Good idea—we’ll need an extra boat anyway,” approved Billy.

When the two boys arrived in Treasure Cove with the bag and scales, Fred carefully weighed out five pounds of sand while Billy prepared himself for the dive.

Paul stood watching Billy heft the bag of sand and became imbued with the spirit of achievement.

“Ever try it before, Billy?” asked he.

“Lots of times, but never before three witnesses who will attest the dive.”

“When you finish, guess I’ll do it, too!” said Paul.

“Maybe you think it’s easy, eh?” queried Billy, laughing.

“I’m a good diver now, and grabbing a bag of sand isn’t anything to do,” said Paul, boastfully.

“Well, just try it!”

Fred had marked off a pole into foot lengths and this he placed in the canoe. After paddling out to the middle of the Cove he used the pole to measure the depths and when he had found the depth of eight or nine feet he called to Elizabeth, who was following the canoe in a boat with Billy and the bag of sand, for passenger and freight.

“Now lift that bag out and drop it carefully just here where the pole stands—don’t fall over with it, though,” ordered Fred, watching as his sister followed his directions.

“Bill, wait a few seconds for the ripples to settle and when you dive look for the white object right under this spot.”

Billy did as he was told and in a few seconds he was in and almost immediately after appeared again bringing the bag of sand up with him. A loud chorus of “Hows” greeted him as he swam in to shore.

“Now I’m going to do it!” cried Paul.

“Why you never tried before,” said Miriam.

“No, but it’s so easy! I might as well pass the test now as later,” bragged Paul, swimming out to the boat.

Fred had paddled in and now carried the bag out to the same place and dropped it in but Paul, try as he would, could not find it.

“I know what’s the trouble—Paul doesn’t keep his eyes open. He closes them tight the moment he strikes the water,” cried Elizabeth to Fred.

So Fred called to Paul, “How do you expect to find an object under water if your eyes are shut?”

“I’m afraid to open them, it feels awful,” said Paul.

“Well, the sooner you learn to do that the better. No swimmer can become expert if he dives or swims under water with closed eyes,” remarked Fred, starting to paddle back to land.

“Oh Fred, while we are here let us try for a test for swimming the breast, overhand, and crawl, in to shore,” cried Paul, and this was done very well although Dudley did it better, having had much more practice at home.

Meantime, Billy had dressed in a complete suit of old clothes—with shoes, cap and coat—as he proposed to try the test of swimming with all clothes on.

Wita-tonkan took the measuring tape and fastened it on one end of the rock that jutted out over the Cove, then Elizabeth paddled the canoe out to

the required distance and waited. Edith, Paul and Billy followed in the boat and stopped alongside the line of limit.

Every one was watching eagerly as Billy dove off the end of the boat and swam for shore. Then, as he reached the rocky island and clambered out, a chorus of “Hows” congratulated him.

“Huh! That was nothing! Now, watch me do some *real* stunts in swimming,” laughed he.

“Not to-day, Billy. Go and dress now and leave your fancy swimming for another time,” advised Mrs. Remington.

Billy obeyed but his face expressed his reluctance.

Meantime Fred was sure that he could overturn a canoe in the water and right it again if some one would stand by while he tried the difficult stunt. Captain Ed offered his services.

While Fred was striving to accomplish this deed, some one suggested a “splashing match” and before a place of dry safety could be reached by the grown-ups who had been sitting near the edge of the water, every one was liberally sprinkled by the merry water nymphs. So much noise did they make indeed, that Aunt Edith called for more quiet.

“Oh, but noise is part of the game, you know!” retorted Billy, who was watching from the sunny rocks since he could not take part in the fun.

The match ended when Paul ducked Edith under water. As soon as she could sputter, she wildly denounced him, but Billy and Dudley laughed heartily as they told her to “get even.”

Paul hurriedly got out of Edith’s way for she had very good muscle for a girl and Paul had been made aware of its power several times previously to this day.

Elizabeth was floating serenely when Edith confided to her that she had kept her eyes open when Paul unexpectedly pushed her under water.

“And it felt so strange that I’m going to try it again.”

“That’s right! No diver is any good until he can see where he is going or what he really is after under water. Why not get the others to try, too,” replied Elizabeth.

So they were all trying to dive and keep their eyes open. “The one who keeps his eyes open the longest while under water will be given an extra dish of dessert at lunch time,” cried Billy.

“But it feels so funny to have the water biff your eyes,” commented Paul, who had experimented when the others did.

“Why, I don’t know whether I see anything or not! I tried but couldn’t see the white sand-bag,” said Dudley.

“Listen to the nutlet!” laughed Elizabeth. “Why, there is nothing *but* water to see, ’cause the bag is in the boat. Here, hold this white clam-shell under water about a yard or two away from your nose and then tell me if you can see it!”

Elizabeth handed the clam-shell to Edith who offered to hold it for Dudley or Paul. Paul clamoured for a trial and thus attracted Edith’s attention to him. She had an idea then and there.

The clam-shell was held and Paul dove. The moment he was near enough to her hand, Edith caught hold of his head and held it under water just as he had done to her a short time before.

Forgetting his predicament, Paul tried to scream for help and a flood of water poured into his mouth. Edith soon allowed her victim to come up again, but he choked and coughed so with anger that every one laughed at the case of “tit for tat.”

While this affray was going on, the watchers on the rock saw Fred try in vain to empty the water out of the canoe after righting it, so Mrs. Remington called out:

“Better desist at present—there are plenty of days to try again—Fred!”

Fred did not want to give in but the tide was running down and he was nearly opposite the south end of the island at the time, so Captain Ed helped to empty the canoe and the lad paddled back to the float in a disappointed frame of mind.

When the visitors were ready to leave, Miriam and Trixie were invited to remain and visit Elizabeth for a few days. So they gladly remained stretched out on the rush mats drying their long wet hair in the hot sunshine.

“Say, mother, isn’t it past time for lunch?” called Fred, as Mrs. Remington came from the float-stage after seeing the guests off in their launch.

“Um—that’s what we all want to know,” added Billy.

“Perhaps it is, I’ll go up and see,” replied Mrs. Remington, but the ringing of the bell just then caused a stampede from the rocks.

The ravenous young folks fell upon the pyramids of hot biscuits and clam-chowder as if there would never be another mouthful of food that summer. After three helpings to the soup and many, many slices of bread, besides the biscuits and crackers, Fred warned them all.

“The flag is up!”

“Where?” questioned Miriam, innocently, whereupon the initiated Islanders laughed hilariously.

“I see it!” cried Trixie, as she pointed to an American flag draped over the fireplace of the room.

Again every one laughed, and Miriam thought she knew what it was all about.

“What—tell us?” demanded the boys.

“It’s the same as F. H. B. Family hold back!”

She had guessed wrong so Billy offered to tell the girls. “It means, ‘Save a place for dessert—it’s *something good!*’”

“Well, who ever thought of that!” exclaimed Trixie.

“Oh, we read a story in a magazine so we adapted it for our own use. In the tale the folks had a flag stuck on the caster in the centre of the table. If the flag stood upright it was a sign that dessert was good, but when the flag was down, it showed there was no need to leave room unless one wanted to,” explained Elizabeth.

“How could any one see the flag if it was on the centre caster under the table?” wondered Miriam.

“Ha, ha! Did you think I meant the brass roller on the table leg?” laughed Elizabeth.

“Didn’t you?” returned Trixie.

Mrs. Remington then explained. “Some people call them cruets. They are a silver, or plated affair, with revolving holders for bottles. In the holder are six or seven holes in which glass bottles fit snugly. They are filled with pepper, salt, oil, vinegar, catsup, mustard or horseradish. The bottles are raised a few inches above the table-top and when any one wants a condiment the revolving holder is swung about until the bottle in need comes opposite the one wishing to use it.”

“Goodness! Did every one reach out and get the bottle he or she wanted?” asked Trixie, sceptically.

“I saw a queer little thing like that for a doll’s tea-set but I didn’t know what it was for,” added Edith.

“It is like everything else—things deemed necessary or fashionable to-day pass into the antiques of to-morrow,” remarked Mrs. Remington.

“Say there, mother! don’t shunt us off on a sidetrack of antiques when we are maintaining that vacant spot for dessert,” asserted Fred, vehemently.

“Where is the welcome dish, anyway?” added Billy.

“Patience—Mose will soon appear with it,” said his mother.

Steps were heard shuffling towards the swing door of the pantry then, and every eye watched the entrance of Mose. He carried a deep covered pudding dish and several tongues smacked in anticipation.

The dish was placed accurately in front of his mistress before Mose ceremoniously removed the silver cover.

“Ugh!” came from expectant Islanders and chairs were pushed back from the table without delay.

“What is it?” wondered Miriam.

“Just some old bread-pudding!” scoffed Edith.

“Bread pudding is healthy, I’ve heard,” ventured Trixie to be polite to her hostess.

“So are all nasty things to eat!” retorted Billy.

“We might give Trixie our portions, Billy,” suggested Elizabeth, as she asked to be excused.

“Well, if no one wants this pudding I fear Mose will have to eat it all by himself,” said Mrs. Remington, laughingly.

“Serve you right, Mose, you know how we hate bread-pudding,” added Fred.

Mose stood behind his mistress’ chair grinning but now he replied to Fred’s remark.

“Wha’fo’ yo’ all didn’ have dat flag down!”

Every one laughed but Billy, who had gone out by the pantry. Before the laughter had ceased however, he pushed in past the swinging door and

carried aloft a great blueberry pie.

Fred caught the dish from his brother and balanced it upon his palms in imitation of a Japanese juggler.

“Friends and fellow Islanders! We have routed the miser who guarded this treasure and now we place this life-saving device before you all to help you recover from the recent fatal disappointment. The question now before the house is, ‘To be or not to be!’”

The pie was placed before Mrs. Remington who laughed and looked at Mose for a verdict.

“It is to be, of course!” shouted Billy, hugging his mother to show how much he loved her just then.

“How! How!” yelled the children so that the lady of the house had to cover her ears.

“Ah wishes t’ offer a sugges’ion!” remonstrated Mose.

“Silence while the proprietor of the pie speaks!” called Fred, authoritatively.

“Ef yo’ each eats a bit o’ dat bread-puddin’ Ah says, let each take a slab o’ my blueberry pie!”

“Done! Done!” promised the boys, and every one sat down to swallow large chunks of the detestable pudding.

“While I am cutting this pie I wish some one would explain why it was thought that a good dessert was prepared for this noon,” said Mrs. Remington.

“How does any hungry boy know what is in the pantry?” asked Fred.

“I don’t know, I’m sure,” replied his mother.

“By following his nose, of course! When a feller is famished he naturally hangs around the kitchen. That’s what we did and so we smelled something good. By following the trail we saw the deep-dish pie cooling on the pantry window-sill but we dared not snatch it then ’cause Mose was right there, so we had to come in and take our turn,” confessed Billy.

Mrs. Remington laughed as she cut the pie but one or two slices were the fraction of an inch larger than the others, hence the hot argument that instantly arose to confound her carelessness.

Teeth and lips were well-stained a beautiful blue-black and the downward track of juicy pie had left telltale spots on the front of shirts and frocks before Billy stood up and sighed. “I don’t see why it is that there is always so little of a good thing! Now, look at that bread-pudding—a great tub of a dish, and such a tiny little pie!”

The others laughed and Mrs. Remington added, “Well, as you had your pie this noon, there will be no dessert to-night!”

“Say, let’s offer Mose a testimonial for that pie and who knows but he may be flattered into baking another for dinner,” suggested Fred.

With such a worthy object in view, the young folks drew up a wonderful set of resolutions and presented it in due form to Mose. Teddy, aged four, was chosen as the courier while all of the others marched in line behind the youngest of the family. As the signed vote of thanks was presented to him, Mose laughed.

“Dis is once when yo’ all get lef’! Ha, ha, ha! When yo’ mah say, ‘Mose, dis bread gotta be used’, Ah says, ‘Yes’m, but dis fam’bly won’t eat bread-pudding, nohow!’

“Den she says, ‘Mek it fo’ an extry dish an’ serb it fust, Mose, an’ d’ blue-berry pie kin be t’ tempter t’ make ’em eat d’ puddin’!’

“Ah wuz goin’ t’ do dat when Billy gits ahaid o’ me an’ done bring dat pie in jes’ es ef it wuz so ordered! Ha, ha, ha!”

“Then that pie was for luncheon after all?” cried Billy.

“Shore thing!” grinned Mose.

“And didn’t you make anything for supper?” worried Paul.

“Jes’ peep in dat po’ch cupboard!” ordered Mose.

“Hurrah! That means ice-cream,” shouted Billy, for Mose always placed the ice-packed freezer out on the back stoop where the melting ice could drain off to the ground.

After an hour of rest, Fred called a class in First-Aids.

Ladders were placed against the bungalow roof and the Fireman’s Lift was practised—Dudley being the willing victim who hung limp and helpless in a faint when the brave fireman found him and carried him down from the roof to safety.

Then the Shaefer method of resuscitation of a drowning person was practised upon Edith. Poles were then run through sweaters and an improvised stretcher made for Paul who was supposed to have been badly injured in a battle. Billy and Dudley were the Red Cross men who carried the groaning soldier away and unexpectedly dumped him out upon the grass.

When serious practice had turned into a frolic, Fred called them all to sit down and rest, but such a thing was impossible for healthy active boys. However, they were stretched out upon the flat rock when Paul asked a question.

“Fred, how long do you think it will take me to swim a hundred yards? By the end of the month, do you think?”

“If you quit fooling and ’tend strictly to work you may. But we have not tried to swim much before this, as the water has been too cold. We can remain in longer, however, as the weather grows warmer.”

“If we would warm up after bathing by running and jumping we could swim in ice-water without danger,” declared Billy.

“We might try that—and do the ‘Hop, step, and jump,’ for a *coup* and see how it will warm us up after bathing,” added Fred.

Mrs. Remington overheard the boys planning and she now interrupted. “I’ll tell you boys what you might do! You know that bare rocky plateau on top of the Island where the sun always shines so hot? Well, take some sun-baths there after you come out of the cold water. Take an old cot and a spare mattress and leave it there if you like. Besides, you can always use the canoe cushions. By getting tanned all over you will harden and fortify your bodies so that a little chill of the water will not affect you as it is apt to do now.”

This was considered good advice and the boys carried out the plan and resorted to the rock the very next morning.

“In case any one of you should get the shivers after the bath, run to the bungalow and have Mose give you a cup of hot soup—it will warm you through at once,” called Mrs. Remington, as the boys left the float-stage where the others were talking.

That evening while every one sat about reading until it came time for bed, Billy suddenly entered the living-room dressed as Charlie Chaplin. He had not been missed from the family party so the surprise was all the more genuine. He had on a pair of Fred’s long trousers, a black coat of his father’s, a gigantic pair of old shoes from Mose’s wardrobe, and a cane found in the hall-closet. He had cut a small piece of black fur from the rug and attached it to his upper lip with a piece of spruce gum.

Billy was an excellent mimic and could appear most serious upon occasion, and now he threw every one into spasms of laughter by his mimicry of the famous comedian. Before long, all of the audience wanted to act too, so the bungalow living-room became a scene for a motion picture play where fear, joy, sorrow and crime were registered by villains, hero and heroine.

“Say, wouldn’t it be fun to have a character party,” suggested Elizabeth, when every one had to stop and rest for a time.

“Oh, yes! Let’s do it!” cried a number of eager voices.

“Children, you *must* go to bed! Why, it is fully an hour past the usual time,” reminded Mrs. Remington.

“But we will get together in the morning and plan out some dandy costumes, shall we?” cried Billy, as they all started for bed.

And that was how the idea started which developed later into the Grand Masked Ball.

CHAPTER SIX

THE PICNIC AT SPRUCE ISLAND

“YO ho, ye Sunset Islanders!” called a voice from the doorway of the bungalow, and there stood the Captain from Isola Bella with a note in his hand.

“Oh Benton, you’re not going to take me home?” cried Miriam, watching Mrs. Remington’s face anxiously as she opened the letter.

“No indeed, Miriam—it is an invitation,” said Mrs. Remington. “Listen, my children, and you shall hear of a picnic planned on Spruce Island for tomorrow if the day is fine. Uncle Bill says that the tide will not be quite right—high in the middle of the day and ebb all afternoon, but we can all go down in the launch.”

“Oh, that will be great!” cried Paul.

“I think Uncle Bill’s a brick!” exclaimed Billy.

“If there’s a cap full of wind I’m going to sail down, mother, and add to my mileage for the sailing *coup*,” added Fred, quick to take advantage of such a good opportunity.

“Suppose you can’t sail back?” asked Elizabeth.

“Then we can be towed back—if the worst comes to the worst. Who wants to sail with me?” said Fred.

So many replied that they had to draw lots with slips of paper and Paul and Dudley won the prize.

“Oh, won’t that be fine!” cried Paul, dancing about with the winning slip of paper waving over his head.

“Hurrah, I got a winner, too! You’ll let me help sail her, won’t you, Fred?” begged Dudley.

“Well, I’ll let you learn if you’ll do just as I say,” replied Fred, doubtfully.

“Cross my heart, I will,” said Dudley, solemnly.

“Oh, I don’t care if you do sail, Dud, ’cause Benton’s goin’ to let *me* steer the Zeus,” bragged Billy, nonchalantly.

“Yes, Sonny, I’m going to prepare you for that launch you told me you wanted to buy,” agreed the Captain with whom Billy was a great favourite.

Mrs. Remington smiled at the Captain’s reference to the “phantom launch” of Billy’s and handed Benton a note of acceptance for the picnic.

As the Captain backed to the door of the bungalow, he remarked in farewell, “I must be goin’ across the bay, now, to take an invitation to your uncle and aunt.”

“I s’pose Mrs. Charlton will take me back home with her to-night, so I may as well be packing my suit-case,” grumbled Trixie, dolefully.

“Yes, I suppose so! I believe Mrs. Charlton has planned a motor trip for you,” added Mrs. Remington.

“I wish Trixie could stay with us all summer, mother,” sighed Elizabeth.

“Well, we must have her over again very soon, dear,” replied Mrs. Remington.

“Oh, I wish you would! But I ought to have a better camp outfit—my checked skirt is the only suitable article I really have for the boat or outdoor fun,” said Trixie.

The entire party trooped down to see Captain Benton off and while he embarked the supper bell rang from the bungalow doorway. Then there was a race on the course from the float-stage to the table. As usual, when it was a question of eating, Paul came in first.

That evening, the moonlight was so beautiful that Fred proposed a row around the Island. Everybody accepted without hesitation and the two boats were soon gliding through the water in the silvery track of the moon.

The merry voices of the young singers in the party sounded far over the calm bay and roused Uncle Bill's mastiff. No doubt the dog heard and recognised the voices of his little pals of the Island. The baying of Nelson then brought the plaintive "baa-baas" of the sheep on Islesboro and blended musically with the singing.

"Say, let's call to Nelse!" suggested Billy, about to whistle when Miriam quickly stopped him.

"No, no! Nelson will surely try to swim over to join us, you know!" cried Miriam.

"Did Nelse ever swim as far as this?" asked Paul.

"You bet he did, the old rascal!" laughed Billy.

"It was one day when Mamma and all of us from Isola Bella came to a picnic over here and Nelson was left alone. After he hunted everywhere for some one to share his watch, he decided to follow after us. We had all gone to the south end when we heard a crashing through the bushes back of us. And there stood old Nelse—all in, too, from the long swim in the icy water," explained Miriam.

"Gee whiz! Nelson ought to have a Grand *coup* for that!" laughed Dudley.

"Well, that's why Papa doesn't want him to try it again," added Miriam, seriously.

“Why—because he won a Grand *coup*?” teased Billy.

“Oh, you know what I mean!” retorted Miriam, while the others laughed merrily.

“Doesn’t the tide make the island a lot bigger when it is low?” remarked Paul, looking curiously at the shore line.

“Yes, it adds an acre or two to the area,” replied Fred.

“Do you think the sky looks as if it would be a clear day for the picnic?” now asked Dudley, anxiously, peering at a cloud as large as his hand.

“Sure thing! But I think we ought to get back to camp and go to bed so we can get up bright and early,” advised Fred.

So without further demur the boats were turned toward the float and the Islanders were soon climbing the path to the tents.

Early in the morning, came a clarion call that hastened the toilettes of the occupants of tents and bungalow—“Rouse ye Britons, Rouse ye Slaves!”

Billy sprang out of bed and waved his hand in token of obedience, as he saw his mother stand calling through the megaphone.

“Hurry up now, we’ve got a lot to do before we’re ready for the picnic,” advised Fred, pulling Paul out of his cot.

Breakfast was a hurried meal that morning as every one was busily engaged in getting everything needed to make the picnic at Spruce Island a success. Elizabeth and Fred were packing the big hamper with good things while Billy and Dudley were helping Mose and Mrs. Remington.

The wheel-barrow had been loaded three times and the picnic stuff transported from the commissary department of the bungalow to the float-stage before all was ready and waiting for the boat.

At the last moment Mrs. Remington saw Edith standing looking about for any forgotten item. Suddenly she called to the child.

“Oh, Edith! Don’t forget the nature books! You know Spruce Island is rich in specimens of wild flowers and you Woodcrafters will want to complete your lists of fifty varieties.”

“Oh, I almost forgot that! And I only have twenty more to get for my *coup* for wild flowers,” cried Edith, running indoors.

“Anna, are you quite sure we packed enough sandwiches?” asked Mrs. Remington, turning to the governess as she came from the house.

Anna laughed. “If the heaped-up loads I saw taken by slow freight via the wheel-barrow route a few moments ago are all eatables, I should say we could feed the starving Belgians for a week, at least!”

“Oh, well, Anna, you know how our children *eat* and then there will be the Rosemary folks and all of the Isola Bella people, too!” reminded Mrs. Remington, seriously.

“Even so, won’t they bring hampers?” returned Anna.

“Well, Aunt Miriam is bringing a large freezer of ice-cream and Aunt Edith said she would bake two large cakes, but I haven’t the slightest idea of what else they may bring.”

“Judging from past picnics, I should guarantee that each one of the three families will take enough to last all summer,” remarked Anna, smilingly.

“Maybe, but it also is a fact that not a crumb is ever found to carry back home or throw to the fish!”

At this moment Fred appeared on the scene with a plan.

“Mother, Paul and Dud and I want to sail to the Island in the dory. You see, I want to win my sailing *coup* for one hundred and fifty miles this summer, and this opportunity is a good one.”

“But the tide is against you, Fred,” objected his mother.

“That won’t matter so much as there is a nice stiff breeze from the northwest and the boys have agreed to be good.”

“Well, all right, then,” complied his mother.

By ten-thirty the boys had started and the others were all ready and waiting impatiently for the first peep at the Zeus which was to take them to Spruce Island.

“What a boatful! And still more to come,” laughed Billy, as he watched Captain Benton carefully manipulate the Zeus to bring it alongside the float.

“Why, where’s Aunt Miriam and Uncle Bill?” cried Edith, missing them from the group in the Zeus.

“The ice-cream was not quite finished and so Papa sent to ask the Captain to stop again for them on the way down,” explained Miriam.

Captain Ed had just started the power-dory that was to carry the commissary and Mose to Spruce Island, when Billy, watching, gave vent to a loud sigh.

“What’s troublin’ you, sonny?” asked the Captain.

“Ah gee! I wish I had a launch and you know as well as I where there’s a peach I could get at a bargain!”

“Maybe, if you’re a good boy something will happen about the time of your birthday,” hinted Mrs. Remington.

“Oh, mother! I’d be willing to go without my allowance and add all my Christmas money to it, too, if I could have that launch now!” exclaimed Billy, eagerly.

“Well, never mind now, but try to behave and earn the launch that way,” advised his mother.

Arrived at Isola Bella the mariners found Uncle Bill making a great to-do about moving the heavy ice-cream freezer over on the wharf. Aunt Miriam

and two lady visitors stood giving him superfluous advice as he did things his own way, after all.

After the freezer was safely shipped, a large hamper of goodies followed, and then the ladies were assisted aboard.

“Hurrah! We’re off at last!” cried Uncle Bill, as they rounded the south end of Isola Bella.

“And I can see the Orion with all on board! Blow the whistle, Billy, and salute them,” added Mrs. Remington.

An answering whistle came from Uncle Tom, and soon his launch carrying the second party slipped along after the Zeus on its way to Spruce Island.

“How about a chantey!” shouted Uncle Bill, for he had been very quiet for at least two minutes.

Without a second’s delay, Billy started up and the rest joined in the song.

RIO GRANDE



Listen

“I’m bound away
This very day
Away you Rio
I’m bound away
This very day

And I’m bound for the Rio Grande.
And oh, Rio, away you Rio, I’m bound away
This very day, and I’m bound for the Rio Grande.”

By the time this swinging song was concluded Uncle Tom started one from the Orion and the passengers of the Zeus joined in.

FLYING-FISH SAILOR



Listen

“I’m a flying fish sailor
Bound down from Hong Kong
 Blow, blow, blow, the man down—
I’m a flying-fish sailor
Bound down from Hong Kong
 Give us a chance to blow the man down.”

“Blow the man up to me
Blow the man down
Blow, blow, blow him around.
Blow bullies blow,
Blow the man down
Give us a chance to blow the man down.”

Having arrived at Spruce Island, a brigade was formed to carry boxes, hampers, and wraps from the boats to the picnic spot in the shade of a clump of firs.

The younger element in the party wanted to start at once on an exploration of the island, which contained nearly two hundred acres, thickly

wooded with fir trees and white birch overhanging the rocky bluffs of the shore.

“See here, boys, if you go alone on this quest, you must promise to stick together. We have never been all over the island and there may be danger spots that we know nothing of, you see. With a crowd there is comparative safety, but should one of you straggle away and get into trouble it might be difficult to help,” admonished Uncle Bill.

The very seriousness of the habitually jolly man made an impression on the boys so that Fred promised for all of them. “And we’ll be all right, folks, never fear,” added he.

“I don’t see why we girls can’t go with you,” pouted Trixie.

“That isn’t it, but I really do not approve of the boys going alone, to say nothing of you girls going too!” remonstrated Aunt Miriam.

The boys made quick work of getting away for fear of being called back by one of the troubled mothers while the girls were soon engaged in finding new specimens of flowers for their books.

“If we gather them now we can identify and arrange them after lunch this noon,” suggested Elizabeth.

The boys had covered many acres of the island and were feeling like genuine explorers when Billy suddenly spied a fish-hawk’s nest high up in a tall spruce.

“Great Scott, Bill! *What* a chance to get a snapshot of that osprey’s nest,” called Fred.

“It’s lucky that I brought my kodak, isn’t it?” added Paul.

“The tree looks kind of risky to climb,” ventured Dudley.

“Oh, no, I can climb it easy enough,” boasted Billy.

“Bill’s climbed higher and worse trees than this one,” added Fred.

“Well, seein’ he’s the best climber in the bunch I’ll let him use my kodak if he wants to shinny up and try for a close-up picture,” offered Paul.

“That’ll be great! and I can add another one to my list of wild-bird photographs,” said Billy, delightedly.

“For me too,” said Paul.

“Why, no, it won’t count for you unless you climb up and get it,” remonstrated Dudley.

An argument followed that made Paul sulky but Billy paid little attention to him as he took the kodak and climbed up the giant spruce.

There was a thick tangle of undergrowth all about the tree and the boys had had to break through this before reaching the spruce. So intent were Fred and Dudley in watching Billy go higher and ever higher, that they failed to note Paul’s absence.

Paul, with his impatient and stubborn nature, felt so piqued at the idea of not being able to claim the coup after offering the use of his kodak, started away from the boys in a huff. The boys never dreamed of his anger or envy over the *coup* winning so did not trouble to look over or beyond the jungle of brush. While Paul, be it said to his credit, forgot all about Uncle Bill’s admonition and the promise made not to wander away from the others.

He finally reached a small promontory of land that jutted out into the sea. As he walked out on the upthrust, a white strip of sandy beach was found to be lying snugly at the bottom of the bluff. About a hundred feet across from the place where the boy stood, another large finger of high-land ran out from the shore actually making a secluded little cove of the beach.

“My, what a dandy little place for a swim! I can undress down between these two high rocks and have a dip, then get back into my clothes again before Billy gets through with that nest!” said Paul to himself as he slid down the steep bank to the beach.

Once on the smooth sand the boy looked about. He was well-screened all right, and not a thing could he see beyond the high banks behind him.

“Just like a bath-house. Two rock walls, with some trees right behind and a peachy beach in front! No one’d ever dream of finding sand on this island of rocks and fir-grown boulders,” remarked Paul to himself, as he started to walk to the water’s edge.

“I’ll just see how far out this little sand strip runs—it may stop short just beyond and then drop down suddenly.”

As Paul bent over the sparkling water the better to scan the distance the sand ran out under the waves, he felt himself slowly sinking down to his ankles in the sand.

“Huh! This is funny. Never felt anything like it before,” murmured he, chuckling at the queer sensation of being sucked down.

By the time his legs were in to the shins, he started to wonder seriously, not yet dreaming of danger, however.

Not entirely liking the grip the sand seemed to have taken on his feet, Paul tried to back away but found he could not tear his feet out of its clutch.

“Let go! Let me get out, I say!” growled Paul to the quicksand, as he twisted and struggled to climb out of the mire.

The boy had not enough experience to know what to do in this emergency and being too far away from the other boys to be seen by them, he felt that he must manage to get free of the quagmire that was drawing him in deeper every moment.

By the time he had sunk to the calves he was thoroughly frightened and endeavoured wildly to throw himself out of the engulfing sand. The more he struggled and squirmed the quicker he sank and then, desperate with his danger and horror, he screamed at the top of his lungs.

He gazed frantically about, but the only sign of habitation was a deserted-looking camp some distance away on the bluff.

Again Paul yelled “Help! Help! Help!” and ended in a terrific cry that curdled the blood in Billy’s veins just as he was about to push the button in the kodak.

“What’s that yell, Bill?” called Fred from below.

Frightened Billy looked around carefully and located a human speck down near the water. From the manner in which it was tossing about its arms it seemed to be in dire need of help.

None of the boys were aware of Paul’s desertion but expected to find him fooling with bugs or flowers on the other side of the brush. So, Billy thought some one unknown to them needed help.

“Some one’s having a nasty time over there near the water—I don’t know who or what is wrong, but I can make out that whoever it is wants help. Hustle over and see, Fred!” called Billy.

“Where—which way and direction?” shouted Fred, looking up at Billy.

“Off in that direction—straight through that opening of the firs!” came down from Billy, who had started to descend the moment he took the bearings.

“We’ll run ahead, you follow, Bill!” called Fred, turning to tell Dudley and Paul to come with him.

“Where’s Paul?” cried he, suddenly missing the boy.

“Wh-hy-I don’t know. I was so busy watching Billy I didn’t see him leave us,” replied Dudley, frightened and running after Fred as fast as he could go.

Billy reached the ground and started to tear after the other boys when he heard the familiar whistle generally given as a signal from Uncle Bill when he was in search of any one.

Billy signalled in return and soon Uncle Bill came from the fir-woods and crossed the small clearing that lay between the firs and the spruce where the hawk's nest was located.

"Hurry—come with me and help!" cried Billy, catching hold of his uncle's hand before anything could be said.

On the way he breathlessly explained what he had seen from the tree-top, and where Fred and Dudley had gone.

"Must be a quicksand. If all you boys are O. K. who can it be? I thought no one was on the island besides ourselves?" cried Uncle Bill.

"I saw a sort of a hut near there when I was up in the tree!" added Billy.

"Perhaps it is some one from the hut; but then they ought to know of the danger I should think! Anyway we ought to have a rope to throw," said Uncle Bill now thoroughly anxious, dragging his nephew along to keep up with his running strides.

"I'll run over to the camp and see if I can find a line or rope," said Billy, as they reached the edge of the grove near the bluff.

"Yes, and if any one lives there get them to come and help with a board or plank!"

Billy ran along the edge of the bluff toward the camp he could see some distance away, while Uncle Bill came out to the sheltered strip of beach where he saw Fred and Dudley striving to save Paul's life.

It needed but a glance to make the whole situation clear, and in wild leaps the man reached the frantic group on the sand.

"Keep still, don't move!" shouted Fred to the struggling Paul.

"The more you squirm and fight the deeper you go!" added Dudley, as Uncle Bill ran up behind them.

Fred was lying on his stomach trying to shove an old fence rail out to the boy. As he carefully guided it so that the end of the rail would slide over the sand and possibly be worked under the arm of the victim, he encouraged Paul with advice.

“When this rail comes near you, try to get your arm over it so it can be used as a brace for you. Then, I’ll try to work another out for your other arm.”

“Here, Fred, let me do that job while Dud and you run and get some more rails wherever you found these,” cried the welcome voice of Uncle Bill.

Both boys showed signs of great relief and confidence as they gave place to the man, and started for the rails of an old fence they had found while crossing the clearing near the bluff.

Meantime, Billy reached the camp but found no one there. It appeared to be a deserted fisherman’s hut but some old rope still hung coiled upon a hook driven in the side of the door-post.

When he reached the spot where Uncle Bill was working to help Paul, Billy was shocked to recognise the victim.

Fred and Uncle Bill managed to worm the rails out so that Paul slid his arms up over them and this acted as a resistible brace against the suction of the mire. Then, with practised hand the coil of rope was flung and as it fell it formed a loop over Paul’s head.

“Now, work that noose down over your shoulders, and when both arms are over it give the word so I can pull you out,” ordered Uncle Bill.

Once more on terra firma Paul was congratulated at his narrow escape but the pallor of his face was sufficient punishment then, so that Uncle Bill refrained from scolding him.

“The next thing for us to do is to scrape Paul. We ought to get him over to Mose where he can undress and wrap himself in a shawl until this mire is washed from his clothes,” said Uncle Bill.

“We must keep this a secret from the girls, you know,” warned Fred.

“If they smell a rat we’ll say Paul slipped into a pool of mire, which is the truth,” laughed Dudley.

“I think some one ought to set up a danger sign at that awful spot,” said Paul, still shivering at the thought of it.

“Yes, Paul’s right. We’ll go back afterwards and fix up some sort of warning for others,” approved Fred.

“I’ll tell you how! When we go back for the picture of the fish-hawk’s nest this afternoon, we can sneak down and stick up that Turkey red cushion top from the launch. That will mean danger, you know,” suggested Billy.

“And maybe you can find a can of paint or some other stuff at that shack so I can mark a warning on the boulder of rock alongside of the sand,” added Uncle Bill.

Paul and his rescuers reached Mose’s camp and were fortunate enough to find everybody gone on a flower quest. Mose alone kept solitary vigil of the clam-chowder cooking over a good camp-fire. In a moment, he was eager to help poor Paul in his “mire” need.

“Heah, Chile, tak’ dese two sweaters an’ use ’em fo’ a go’fing costume. Clim’ into th’ sleeves ov one sweater wid yur feet an’ pull de’ odder down obber yo’ haid. Strap bof’ togedder about yo’ middle wid’da rope—lik’ dat, now!” And Mose assisted Paul in dressing as he advised.

When the boy emerged from back of the bushes where he and his valet had retired, the other boys laughed at the sight the sweaters made of Paul.

Mose gathered up the miry clothes and started in to scrape them as clean as possible before washing them.

“Say, Bo, yo’ don’ ever expec’ t’ wear deses again, do yo’?” questioned he.

“Can’t they be washed clean?” wondered Paul, anxiously.

“Ah kin wash ’em but dis clam-mud ain’t neber goin’ t’ let go fer good! One thing sure, dough, it’ll mek’ th’ coat thicker an’ warmer fo’ nex’ winter!” grinned Mose.

“Oh, go ’long, Mose, we all know you’re foolin’!” laughed Billy, leading Paul away from the teasing cook.

CHAPTER SEVEN

FURTHER ADVENTURES AT SPRUCE ISLAND

BEFORE Mose had quite finished washing out the muddy clothes the flower hunters returned. Elizabeth was highly elated because she had found enough new varieties to complete her list of fifty for the Wild-Flower *coup*, while Miriam's and Edith's lists had reached thirty different kinds.

As the girls ran over to the group of boys to tell them about their successful hunt, Trixie stood still and gasped. The others turned to look in the direction that she was staring and a burst of merriment sounded from them all.

"Good gracious, Paul! Where did you find the upsey-downsey suit of clothes—are you masquerading?" cried Elizabeth.

Paul mumbled but looked annoyed and uncomfortable.

"Doesn't he look like one of those double-headed dolls? You hold them one way and they are Mammys, and you turn them up the other way and they are something else," said Trixie.

"What ever put it into your head to dress that way, Paul?" persisted Elizabeth.

"Well, you see, he thought you girls would like clams on the half-shell so he found a spot where he tried digging. But he dug so deep while trying to catch a big fat juicy clam, that he fell into the hole and pulled the hole in after him. We had all we could do to pull him out again, but when he finally did come out, Lo! he pulled the hole out too!" explained the irrepressible Uncle Bill.

“So, that’s why Mose is giving his clothes a Turkish bath,” giggled Billy.

Mrs. Remington and Mrs. Farwell looked hard at Uncle Bill but forbore saying more at that time.

Mose soon completed the task given him and then sounded a tin pan for the call to luncheon. A grand scramble ensued and there was much confusion and advice before every one was comfortably settled on cushions and rugs about a large cloth spread out upon the grass.

The three hostesses had been very busy unpacking and arranging the contents of hampers and boxes but now that the result of their efforts and work was finished the hungry picnics enjoyed the wonderful meal thoroughly and the viands disappeared like magic.

Wide and well worn was the trail made by Mose as he tracked back and forth from famished eaters to the chowder kettle and when Billy called for a fourth bowl of the delicious soup, the distracted chef turned the pot upside down in silence to prove that not a drop remained therein.

Directly after luncheon, Uncle Bill proposed a hike around the island stopping at the tall spruce tree to retake the snap-shot of the hawk’s nest and also to place a signal on the beach of quicksand.

“Ah! Now I know how Paul delved for that clam!” murmured Mrs. Remington, nodding her head wisely.

“Oh, by the way! maybe Billy has requisitioned too much chowder to be in trim to climb that tree!” said Uncle Bill quietly, the moment he recognised the blunder he had made.

“Oh, no, you don’t, Bill!” laughed Mrs. Farwell. “You’re fairly caught this time and we demand knowledge of that clam-digging feat!”

However, Uncle Bill was not to be caught napping again, so he began a long, tiresome story of clam-digging until every one told him to “cut it short!”

Having succeeded in taking a picture of the fish-hawk's nest and rigging up the red banner for a signal to unwary hikers, as well as painting a warning on the front face of the rock in white lead, the entire crowd continued the hike over the island.

After many adventures they came to a small beach at the north end of the island where the winter storms washed ashore all sorts of debris. Paul spied a gleaming white section of a skeleton and he ran excitedly over calling as he went:

“Come on, boys! See what I've found!”

The others followed and soon were examining a number of vertebra of a whale.

“By the Great Horn Spoon! Is a remnant of that old whale here yet!” cried Uncle Bill, in surprise.

“What old whale—do tell us the story!” begged Billy, scenting an exciting adventure of Uncle Bill's youth.

“Well, when I was about your age, my brother and I took a sail one day and landed for lunch at this island. We intended to spend the day fishing for cod and then start home about sunset. Just about the time we were ready for lunch, the wind veered and brought the most dreadful odour to our nostrils.

“We looked at each other, while reaching the same conclusion—something unusual had been washed ashore!

“Say, Bill, folks say ‘follow your nose’—shall we?” asked my brother.

“Sure thing—come on!” said I, and we ran down to this beach and right here we came upon a young whale which yet was ancient of days!

“Even in death the strength of the whale was more than our lusty powers of resistance so we both returned to that lunch minus an appetite. The fire was smothered and we sadly resumed our cod-fishing, but strange to say, it had lost its zest for us and the boat seemed very wobbly. We returned home

quite early that day and took relief in a mad game of tennis. That evening we felt better and could partake of slight nourishment!”

Every one laughed at Uncle Bill’s experience and Dudley made a suggestion. “Let’s take home the vertebra for souvenirs!”

“It won’t have the same effect now as it had years ago, that’s certain,” said Uncle Bill.

So each boy loaded himself with the whitened bones of the whale while the elders slowly retraced their steps. At the clearing where the picnic was held, Mose was found taking advantage of the peace by enjoying a well-earned snooze.

The chef was roused by the noise made by the returning explorers and Billy eagerly showed him the souvenirs.

“Whale bones, Mose—the same one Uncle Bill found when he was a boy.”

“What! Whalebones! Yo’ don’ mean t’ tell me dat dem things is what dey puts in ladies co—yo’ know, dat—dat—well, yo’ all knows what Ah means! Dem articles what d’ ladies wear t’ mek ’em look slim,” delicately hinted Mose.

Every one ha-haed at the manner of Mose’s questioning, and Uncle Bill explained that the whalebone of commerce and corsets came from the rows of screen plates that are so arranged in a whale’s mouth that all of his food is strained out from his sea-water soup.

“Jus’ lak’ es how it woul’ be ef yo’ took a mouf-ful ov chowder en’ shet yer teeth t’ keep in d’ clams whiles yo’ squirt out all d’ water, eh?” asked Mose, eagerly.

“Just so, only more so!” laughed Uncle Bill.

After a light supper on the picnic grounds, haste was made to embark. The tide was ebbing and there was no wind so the dory was filled with the

boxes and baskets and towed behind the launch.

As the mariners came out from the shadow of the overhanging bluffs of Spruce Island the moon, still in its last quarter, shone silvery white in the heavens and the stars sparkled with unusual brightness. The Woodcrafters gazed at the blue dome overhead, and started talking about the constellations.

“Who can show me where to find the Pole Star?” then asked Uncle Bill.

Instantly many voices replied to this question.

“Paul, now’s your chance to point out the four constellations you boasted about when that last tassel was cut from your badge,” teased Uncle Bill.

“I will,” returned Paul. “The Pole Star’s in the Little Bear, and there’s the Dipper, or Big Bear. Way over in the west is Arcturus—I know him by the big star, see? Then, that one up there in the northeast is Cassiopaea—it looks just like a ‘W.’ That makes four!”

“Good for you! Now, who else can name any?” said Uncle Bill.

“I can!” cried Elizabeth. “Directly over our heads you will find Vega, in Lyra. And—oh, Paul, you forgot to mention Orion in your’s!”

“Ha, ha! That’s one on you, Elizabeth, because you can’t see Orion until early morning up here,” laughed Fred.

“Why there are the Pleiades and Orion is near them,” argued Elizabeth.

“But those *aren’t* the Pleiades, although I’ll admit it looks like them,” protested her brother. “That’s Job’s Coffin.”

“Well, I never! I’ve always said they were the Pleiades even though I thought they appeared a bit strange to me,” said the surprised girl.

“What are those stars near Job’s Coffin?” asked Billy.

“That is Aquilla,” answered Mrs. Remington.

“Now let me get these down straight,” came from Billy. “First, that ‘W’ is Cassiopaea. Next to her—what are those four big stars like a square?”

“It is called the Great Square of Pegasus,” replied Mrs. Remington. “Then comes Aquilla and Job’s Coffin, and above us you find Lyra.”

“Look! What is that large star in the northeast—it is low down on the horizon but it is rising fast?” cried Dudley.

Every one turned to gaze at the beautiful twinkling star that seemed to sway in the sky. In fact Billy denied it was a star.

“Any one can see with half an eye that that’s a fire-balloon!” argued he.

However, it proved itself to be a star and finally, Mrs. Remington and Fred identified it as Capella and the atmospheric conditions near the horizon accounted for its gyrations.

“But, mother, it is moving *east*!” cried Elizabeth.

“It is a fire-balloon, ’cause no star travels that way,” added Billy.

Here Uncle Bill offered an explanation of the marvel.

“It’s a star, all right, Billy, and it really is moving east to us because we are so far north that we see it below what is ordinarily the horizon! Watch carefully now, and soon you will see it move west and behave as all other well-trained stars do.”

This proved to be so and before the party quite reached home Capella had risen high in the heavens to join the orderly procession of westward moving stars.

“Do any of you know the Algonquin name for the Big Dipper?” asked Mrs. Remington.

Aunt Miriam demonstrated her knowledge of the zodiac at this point and told the story of Ojeeg-Annung, the Fisher Star.

“Ojeeg-Annung was a mighty hunter—he lived with his wife and little son on the shores of a great lake. They always had plenty to eat because Ojeeg was so skilful in the chase. But at that time it was always winter in the land—the sky people kept the Birds of Summer shut up in cages in the Fields of Heaven.

“The little son complained of the continual cold, especially when his hands were stiff and aching so that he could not use his bow and arrow on the squirrels and rabbits.

“One day when he cried with the cold, a squirrel hopped up and told him, ‘Keep on crying and complaining no matter what your parents offer you for consolation, and at last your father, who is a magician, will promise you anything you want if you will only stop crying. Then ask him to make Summer in the land!’

“The boy followed the squirrel’s advice and it happened as he said it would.

“Ojeeg called all his fellow-chiefs together and they made strong medicine and started off to climb to Heaven.

“Finally they reached the top of a high mountain and from there they could jump into heaven, by breaking through the celestial floor.

“Before the sky-people could stop them, Ojeeg had cut open the cages and freed the Birds of Summer. They flew quickly down through the hole in heaven and so we now have summer and warmth and flowers.

“Poor Ojeeg was overtaken by the sky-men and, although he changed himself into his totem animal, the fisher, he died from an arrow-head in the tip of his tail—the only spot that was vulnerable. As he died, he exclaimed: ‘I am satisfied to die because I have done such good, not only to my son but to all who come hereafter.’

“There he is in the sky as a remembrance. What we call the ‘Dipper’s Handle,’ the Indians call Ojeeg’s long tail with the arrow sticking in the end.”

“What is the fisher like?” questioned Paul.

“It’s like an otter or a sable or a marten,” replied Billy, the hunter.

“This marten story makes six different names I have heard the Dipper go by, and I suppose there really are others,” remarked Elizabeth.

“Six!” exclaimed Paul in surprise. “What are they besides the Bear and the Dipper and this Fisher Ojeeg?”

“Why, there are the Seven Plough Oxen, The Seven Rishis, or Wise Men, and the Persian Heft Aurang or Seven Thrones,” explained Elizabeth, the lover of poetry and romance.

But the stars were soon forgotten after the Woodcrafters landed and wearily sought their cots. A full and happy day in the open made most of them sleepy and glad to stretch out for the night.

CHAPTER EIGHT

THE CRUISE TO CASTINE

“MOTHER, if we’re to have that masked ball that all of you were talking about, it ought to be given this week so’s to have Uncle Bill with us. You see, he starts back to the city next week,” said Fred, one morning soon after the picnic.

“Aunt Miriam and I were discussing that very thing last night and we have decided to hold it in Fudge Attic, at Isola Bella, some night this week.”

“Haven’t you determined upon any special night?” asked Fred.

“As far as we can tell now, it will be Friday.”

Elizabeth had entered the room as they were speaking, and stood holding a note the Captain had brought her from Isola Bella. At her mother’s words she smiled delightedly.

“Oh, that is just fine, ’cause Miriam has invited Trixie and me to visit her for a few days this week.”

She handed her mother the note and waited until the verdict was given. Of course, Elizabeth knew she would be permitted to go but she had no thought of accepting, or planning for the visit without her mother’s knowledge and consent.

“Be sure and take everything you may need for the ball. If your suit-case isn’t large enough to hold what you will need let Anna find you a suit-box for the costume,” advised her mother.

“I’ll sail you over if you like, Elizabeth,” offered Fred. “I’ve only done half of my hundred and fifty miles for the sailing *coup* and I want to get in

as much as I can every day.”

Billy sauntered in at this juncture wondering where his big brother could be.

“What’s up—Eliza going away?” he queried, hearing Fred’s offer and his sister’s smiling acceptance.

Mrs. Remington told him about the invitation and Billy chuckled. “That’s good! Then you won’t be here to see how we are going to be toggled out for the ball, and Trix and Miriam won’t have any one to tell them who we are.”

Turning to his brother after having delivered this speech, Billy added, “Say, can’t you let me take the sail with you?”

“Sure—if you want to come.”

“Boys, why don’t both of you take a cruise and cover a lot of ground at one time—I mean a lot of water in one day!” suggested Mrs. Remington.

“Oh, mother, can we?” cried Billy.

“I’d like to, if you think it’s all right, mother,” added Fred.

“If the weather is good and you make careful plans I see nothing to hinder your trying it,” smiled Mrs. Remington.

“Bully for you, mother dear! Fred, when can we start!” shouted Billy, tossing his cap up to the ceiling.

“We can start to-morrow; Captain Ed says we are in for a good spell of fine weather now,” replied Fred.

So as soon as the two boys returned from escorting their sister to Isola Bella, they began preparing for the cruise. The kindly Captain helped with the outfitting of the little dory, and remarked that if they got an early start in the morning they could have the flood-tide to help them up the bay and then have all of the ebb to come back on.

“I’ll keep a lookout about sunset and if the wind flushes out, I’ll come after you with the launch,” concluded he.

Mose willingly agreed to cook an early breakfast for the two boys and he also tipped a wink to Billy to come to the pantry and take a look in the cake-box.

Billy needed no second invitation and when he beheld the delicious-looking cake reposing there for appreciative cannibals, he sighed and asked, “Oh, Mose! That for us!”

“Ef yo’ don’ say nuffin about it! Ah’m gwine t’ see dat he is tenderly wrapped up an’ shet away in a box fo’ you’-all. But don’ go an’ get Pore Mose in bad at supper t’night when they ain’t no dessert—onny preserves!”

And that evening a number of those seated about the supper-table noted how obediently Billy ate his dish of prunes. Paul grumbled and said he hated prunes and Dudley pushed back his plate full with a wry face. Both boys then looked for some other dessert but looked in vain!

“Prunes are awful good for one, aren’t they, mother? We ought to eat plenty of prunes to be healthy!” said Billy, virtuously.

Paul and Dudley stared at their chum in amazement.

“Humph! Some folks get good all of a sudden!” sniffed Paul.

Mrs. Remington had to control her face behind her napkin, and to change the subject, she said: “Where have you decided to go on your cruise to-morrow?”

“Up to Castine and back again,” replied Billy.

“We expect to start about seven in the morning,” added Fred.

“Oh, *can’t* we go with you?” cried Dudley, coaxingly.

“No indeed!” answered Mrs. Remington, decidedly. “You know nothing about sailing, and the dory is too small for a day’s sail for more than two

people.”

The two youngsters were inclined to dispute this decision but Fred cut short their grumbling by offering a salve in form of an invitation to spend the day on Captain Ed’s farm. The Captain lived on the mainland and made periodical trips across the bay to bring back butter and eggs from his farm. This idea of going with the Captain pleased Paul and Dudley so that they went to bed in an amicable frame of mind.

Early the next morning every one was up to see the boys off on the cruise, and breakfast was eaten in much excitement. It was a perfect day that seemed made to order for the sailors. A light southerly wind was blowing and soon the tide would begin to flow and that would help them along materially.

Paul and Dudley, still yearning for the joys of a cruise watched the dory leave the float-stage and then they ran to the north end of the island just to see the last of the little craft and the two boys they so heartily envied that morning.

But no time was wasted in vain regrets when once the dory was out of sight. The two boys hurried back to the float to wait for Captain Ed who was to carry them away for a glorious day on his farm.

On the way over to the mainland, the Captain said: “I’ve got a young colt that needs a brave broncho buster to ride him.”

“Oh, Captain! let me try and ride it, will you?” cried Paul.

“I can ride better’n Paul, Captain!” urged Dudley.

“No you can’t, neither! Ah now, Captain, *please* let me ride her?”

“Well, she’s young and gentle all right, but full of fire—like most young things. So I don’t see any objection to both of you boys riding her if you’re careful.”

“And Paul, we’ll draw lots for the first ride!”

“The colt is a great pet and she may show a little fear of you two Indians at first, but she’ll get used to you if you give her some sugar,” advised the Captain.

It was a scant mile’s walk from the Cove to the farm but a friendly neighbour’s “jigger” was found going their way, and the three had a lift as far as the cross-roads.

“Did you ever see such a funny axle—it’s got a broken back!” exclaimed Paul, curiously.

“It looks to me more like a crankshaft,” said Dudley.

“Well, a jigger’s a mighty handy thing for haulin’ heavy loads,” explained Captain Ed.

“But it hain’t no pneumatic cushions for sore bones,” chuckled the neighbour.

“No sir-ee! nor no ”C“ spring buggy, neither,” laughed Captain Ed.

Before the boys reached the farm their breakfast was well jounced down so that the home-made cake and milk offered them by the Captain’s wife was most welcome.

“We came to ride your colt,” declared Paul, between bites.

“Oh, no! We came to visit you, Mrs. Blake, but the Captain told us we *might* ride the colt,” hurriedly corrected Dudley, with great diplomacy.

Paul stared and Mrs. Blake laughed understandingly but she immediately invited the boys to come with her to the pasture. She carried a bridle over her arm and when they reached the lot Brownie was coaxed to come over and nibble a lump of sugar from her mistress’ hand. While doing this, the colt kept her eyes on the two strange boys. But it is safe to say that Brownie would not have submitted to the bridle had it not been for the extra sugar the boys gave her.

While Mrs. Blake held the colt by the forelock and bridle, Paul, who had won the prized slip of paper, tried to mount. The boy had taken short rides at home on Billy Remington's pony, but this was an entirely new proposition. After a number of trials and failures to mount, Dudley laughed and cried to him:

"Hey, there! Come over and mount from this stone wall!"

So Mrs. Blake led Brownie over to the wall while Paul scrambled on top and in that way managed to slide over on the colt's silky bare back.

The moment Brownie felt a strange burden on her back she grew unmanageable and tried in every way to dislodge it.

"Grip her sides with your knees, boy!" called Mrs. Blake.

The moment Brownie felt the restraining hand removed from her bridle she started off on a lope for the pasture gate. The boys had left it open as they entered and through it the colt shot and made down the lane, Paul dinging to her with might and main, knowing it was now a case of "stick or flick."

Just as both of them began to feel better acquainted and hopes for enjoyment rose in Paul's breast, the horn of a passing motor tooted on the main road at the end of the lane. The awful blast startled Brownie so that she wheeled and tore back to her home in the pasture.

Oh what a race that was! Over hummocks and swales of fern! then suddenly the colt stopped short by bracing her fore-feet and humping her back. And as suddenly, Paul became an aviator. Luckily, he landed in comparatively soft sod so that the only injury he sustained was a loss of wind.

"I never knew Brownie to act like that before," commented the Captain's wife, as Dudley and she stood watching.

"Oh, Paul isn't experienced like me! I can manage her all right, you will see!" bragged Dudley, fearing lest Mrs. Blake might decide to give Brownie

her freedom.

However, the colt had to be caught before Dudley could ride, and both boys as well as Mrs. Blake grew hot and tired in their endeavours. Finally, Brownie was beguiled by some young tender carrots, and Dudley climbed upon her back while Mrs. Blake fed the colt the delicacy.

“Run and shut that pasture gate, Paul!” shouted Dudley.

Paul did as he was bid and then sat upon the top rail to watch the boastful rider.

At first it seemed as if Brownie, too, was tired and willing to be guided in the way she should go, so Dudley began to have confidence and bravado.

“Look, Paul, this is the way to make them wheel!” called he, digging his heel into the colt’s flank.

Wheel Brownie did, all right! She was off in a jiffy, circling around the pasture, jumping the familiar hummocks in her way, and finally sailing over the low stone wall, then racing lickety-split down the lane.

Dudley had no objections to thumping over the soft sod of the lane as it really was preferable to the boulders in the pasture. But the colt became vexed with the boy’s close clinging and with a tossing of her mane resorted to an equine trick—that of trying to brush off an unwelcome rider.

Try as he would, Dudley could not prevent Brownie from passing under the low-hanging branches near the end of the lane. Believing “discretion to be the better part of valour” the boy slipped off before he was “sawed” off by the neck.

The moment the colt realised her pest was gone she kicked up her heels and snorted with derision.

Paul hugged himself in wild delight when he saw Dudley carefully limping back to the pasture, but their troubles were soon forgotten by

hearing the Captain call for aides in catching some chickens that were needed on Sunset Island.

The milder delights of rural life—chickens, pigs, cows, yea, even sheep, came in for fervid attention after that.

Then, early in the afternoon, well laden with baskets full of fresh vegetables as well as the broilers, eggs, and butter, the three mariners sailed the seas again to Sunset Isle.

About five o'clock there came signs of a gathering storm and the sky grew black in the north. The wind had changed and blew from the northeast in increasing violence. The Captain became anxious but saying nothing to Mrs. Remington, trained the spyglass in the direction from which the two boys and the dory should first be seen.

A few moments' scrutiny showed a tiny speck gleaming white against the darkening waters. Soon, with the naked eye, he was able to discern the little craft about two miles north of the island. Then he went in search of Mrs. Remington.

"Well, the two boys are piling home double quick—they'll be here in a few minutes," said he, with relief.

The mother was secretly relieved also, as she had felt concerned over the delay of the boys and the approaching storm.

"Let's run up and see 'em come around the north end!" shouted Dudley, excitedly.

"Let's all go," said Paul, looking at Mrs. Remington invitingly.

Without parley they started for the nearest point which the boys would make before running into the lee of the island.

By the time the eager Islanders reached the north end the dory was almost there.

“She’s carrying too much sail! They ought to’ve reefed her,” exclaimed the Captain, trying to make himself heard above the roaring of the wind.

“Well, they’re here now,” sighed Mrs. Remington.

While every one on shore strained eyes to watch the dory manœuvre as she approached the narrow passage between the ledges of rock leading to safety in the lee, an extra squall rendered the over-rigged boat unmanageable. Over she went!

Quick as a flash, the two sailors were out on the centreboard keel! She righted, but was full of water. Billy ran down the sail while Fred chucked ballast overboard.

In the meantime, the watchers on shore gasped and every face went white, but Captain Ed, finding the boys would be comparatively safe because of the airtight compartments making the dory unsinkable, ran swiftly to the float-stage and got his launch.

But quick as he was, the two sailors were more than half a mile away, blown by the fury of the wind. He just managed to catch up with them before they were wrecked on the Isleboro shore. During this flight before the storm the boys had not been idle. One bailed madly while the other tried to keep her head on to the storm.

It was a long hard tow for the little launch in the teeth of the gale with the half-filled dory dragging drunkenly behind. When at last, the boats came in the lee of the island, the nerves of those afloat as well as those on shore suddenly relaxed and made every one feel and act foolish from relief.

Fred and Bill were rushed up to the bungalow for a change into dry clothes, while Dudley and Paul heaped wood upon the roaring fireplace in the living-room. Mose got busy with an unusually good hot supper and soon after, every one was hailed to sit down for the belated meal.

As Mose brought in a great platter of broiled chicken with hot waffles he remarked hypocritically:

“Ah don’ know wedder ders any flag up fo’ dessert t’ night, cuz Ah ain’t done gone an’ made none!”

“Oh Mose! What do you call waffles?” laughed Fred.

“Oh, de’s jus’ chicken fixin’s!” grinned the southerner.

“Well just give me a pile of those same ‘fixin’s’ and a jug of maple syrup and you can wave the flag sky-high as far as I’m concerned,” remarked Billy, the connoisseur.

“How, how, how!” echoed from the circle around the table.

That night when dinner had been cleared away, the family grouped itself in front of the drift-wood fire and prepared to hear the tale of the cruise. The storm was howling and raging without but the great tongues of purple and green flame that shot up the chimney from the drift wood suffused a cheery feeling to the Islanders.

“We had a cinch getting up to Castine, with a flood-tide and that nice southerly,” began Fred; “it didn’t flush out until we got inside the harbour.”

“You know that little Nautilus Island, mother?” asked Billy. “Well, we ran in back of that and over to a fine little cove. We took out the fishing lines and in fifteen minutes we had a mess of tom-cod.”

“Say, maybe tom-cod and bacon isn’t the food for the gods! eh what, Bill!” remarked Fred, smacking his lips at the memory of his savoury feast.

“You bet! We landed after catching enough fish and made a good fire to broil them. Then we ate lunch. We wound up on that cake Mose sneaked into our hamper last night.”

Paul and Dudley exchanged looks that said as plainly as words, “Now we know why Billy preferred prunes!”

“You know, mother, we always wanted to explore the Bagaduce River; well, this was a swell chance with the tide still running up, so we up-anchored and started off. We’d have been home long before the storm came

if we hadn't gone so far up the river. But it was worth the trouble, wasn't it, Bill?"

"Yeh! There's the place where old Baron Castine and the Tarratine Indians camped when Maine was first settled," added Billy.

"Then when the wind changed this afternoon, we were up that river eating the last crumbs of cake. It began to look a little squally so we considered we'd better make tracks for home. And we sure did make a track—all froth and foam. It didn't get to be a real storm you know, until about five o'clock, so that's why we hadn't reefed the sail," explained Fred.

"We went along fine for a time. I never knew the dory to go so fast but finally we realised that we needed that reef," Billy continued. "We would have run down the sail and put in the reef out in the open bay but Fred said, 'Oh, half a minute more will see us in the lee of the island.' We would have been all right if that nasty little squall hadn't caught us just half a minute too soon!"

"Boys, you knew you ought to have a reef in the sail, and hereafter, don't wait that half-minute too late to put it in. The cause of accidents and loss of life is that same excuse—'oh, we'll be all right in half a minute!'" warned Mrs. Remington.

"How does it feel to climb out on the centreboard in a gale?" asked Dudley, curiously.

"Didn't stop to diagnose the feeling!" laughed Fred.

"I just guess not!" added Billy.

"I bet you were glad there were air-tanks in your dory, all right!" declared Paul.

"I just bet we were too!" sighed both adventurers.

And Fred added: "We knew we'd be all right if we just got out the ballast, even though she was full of water."

“But all the same, we were glad to see the Captain heave in sight through the spray, and then when we got near the island it kinda felt good to see you all waiting to welcome us,” smiled Billy.

“I never saw anything drift so fast in all my life—even though the wind and tide were working together,” said Dudley.

Advice is most uninteresting to youth and when Mrs. Remington began to advise the reckless sailors, Fred quickly changed the subject.

“Well, Dud—what did you and Paul do at the farm to-day?”

Both boys plunged into the story of the broncho busting each one giving high-coloured account of the other’s inexperience in riding a colt. Then as they arrived at the relation of the quieter sports of feeding the livestock and catching chickens, they looked at each other and finally doubled up in laughter.

“What’s the joke—tell us, too!” wondered Billy.

“How did you like the broilers to-night?” asked Paul.

“Why, they tasted good as usual—why?” wondered Fred.

“Because, we’ve heard that the flavour of a chicken has to do with the way it is killed. How do you like your chickens killed—heads chopped off or necks wrung?” asked Paul.

“All the same to me as long as I get it,” replied Billy.

“Well, how do you s’pose they’d taste if they were suffocated to death?” persisted Dudley, and both Paul and he laughed again.

“You didn’t do that, did you?” cried Edith, horrified.

“Well, two of the tender chickens we had to-night were suffocated by Dud and me, but not intentionally,” admitted Paul.

“You see, it was this way: We had been catching chickens for the Captain and these two got away and hid under the haystack outside the barn.

“The Captain started chopping off heads and I got one chicken as it flounced around without its head, and chased Paul with it. Just when Paul doubled in his tracks, I was swinging the chicken about holding it by one leg. He ran plump into it and then said I lammed him with it! Ha, ha, ha!” chuckled Dudley.

“Well, you did, too, Dud! You were just going to swing it at my head anyway when I turned to dodge you! But I got even!” interrupted Paul.



CAP'N, FRED, AND BILLY “OILED UP.”



OFF FOR BELFAST ON THE MEDRIC.

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island.

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“Paul ran me in the barn and chased me up into the hayloft but I jumped out on this big haystack to get away from him. He followed right after me and both of us slid down the side and landed on top of each other. One wild squawk from the chickens underneath us told how we had landed on top of them. They died so quick they hadn’t time to make a will to dispose of their heads,” laughed Dudley, at the remembrance.

“We carried the two chickens back and told the Captain of their unexpected end, and he said, ‘That’s a new form of capital punishment.’”

While the children talked over the rural sports of the Captain’s farm Mrs. Remington seemed absent-minded. When they had worn the subject threadbare however, she made a remark.

“I’ve been thinking about the masked ball—you should have been planning long before this as to the costumes you intend wearing.”

“How do you know that we haven’t been planning?” asked Fred, smilingly.

“Oh, I’m glad if you have, but I haven’t heard about it,” said she.

“Haven’t you heard a weird tincan sound coming from the direction of the pump-house lately?” queried Fred.

“Why, yes—I believe I have! What is it?” quizzed his mother.

“That’s the secret of my costume. Nobody will ever guess what it is to be so I won’t tell beforehand,” returned Fred.

“I’m going as Red Riding Hood!” exclaimed Edith.

“Dud was going to be a pirate but Billy told him of some other good idea so I’m going to use the pirate’s things,” said Paul.

“Yes, Bill and I are going to be a pair but we need you to help us make the things, Mrs. Remington,” added Dudley.

“What is it?”

“Why, mother, Dud and I want to be bears—a white polar bear for me and a cinnamon bear for Dud, and we need some old blankets for the suits,” explained Billy.

“I wouldn’t want to spoil any good blankets by cutting them up for suits but Anna has some white cotton flannel for the polar bear and I think I know where there is some brown material that will do for the other and you can sew the bear rug on the back of it,” suggested Mrs. Remington.

“And maybe you and Anna can cut out and stitch up the suits—that will be all, you know. Dud and I will do all the rest,” wheedled Billy.

“There isn’t anything else to do after that, is there?” laughed Anna.

“To make two bear skins seems a large order, Billy,” said Mrs. Remington. Then thoughtfully, added, “Maybe we can use the pattern of the

sleeping suits that have feet and mittens attached! And we have the sewing machine that will run up the seams quickly.”

“Of course! It will be dead easy!” said Dudley.

“And be sure you leave enough room when you cut out the stuff, to give us a chance to stuff pillows in front. We’re going to be big fat bears, you see,” added Billy, with concern.

Every one laughed, but Fred had an idea which he mentioned. “Bill, you ought to rig up some strings that connect with the inside so that you can wiggle the ears and stumpy tail.”

“That’s what I will! Won’t it be fun?” laughed Billy.

After that conversation, the time was given to the making of costumes for the masque, Fred still jealously guarding his secret work going on in the pump-house while every one expressed the wildest conjectures as to what he could be making!

The first time the two bears tried on their costumes, Mose was heard singing his favourite revival hymn, “Swing low, sweet chariot, goin’ fo’ t’carry me home,” while he worked in the adjoining room.

Mischief uppermost in his thought, Billy whispered to Dudley: “Say, let’s hide in Mose’s tent to-night and when he goes to bed we’ll growl like bears and jump out on him!”

“Great! But don’t let any one know or they’ll stop us,” replied Dudley.

The tooting of the Orion’s whistle just then, interrupted any further planning and every one rushed out to meet the visitors. Mr. and Mrs. Charlton had a plan to propose to Mrs. Remington, so the eldest went into a secret conference from which the children were excluded, but now and then a word sounded from unwary speakers. Words like “Boston,” “Manage if they will all co-operate” and “See Uncle Bill about it,” made the boys curious.

When the conclave ended, the children besieged Miss Travis to tell them what every one was going to wear to the ball.

“Indeed we won’t tell!” said she, emphatically.

“Not much!” added Uncle Tom.

“Humph! Do you mean you’re going to wear bathing suits, or cannibal costumes?” laughed Billy.

“Oh, a little more material than those take, I hope!” laughed Aunt Edith, while appreciating her nephew’s quick wit.

“Wish we had thought of bathing suits—we could have saved much expense and time,” said Uncle Tom, regretfully.

“I think you ought to tell us what you are going in!” persisted Billy.

“Ask me no questions and I’ll tell you no lies!” retorted Uncle Tom, and there the matter rested.

That night the wild uproar in Mose’s tent testified to the time the two bears attacked him. The rest of the family rushed affrightedly over to rescue the valuable cook, but found him upon the floor of his tent writhing in convulsions of fear with two savage bears thumping on top of him.

A veil must be drawn over that harrowing scene, but Mrs. Remington wondered whether her chef was quaking in a fit of terror or only shaking in laughter—especially as he had seen Anna sewing on the two costumes for the bears.

CHAPTER NINE

THE NIGHT OF THE MASKED BALL

THE night so anxiously anticipated came at last. As there was no moon everything lay in velvety blackness. This was considered opportune as it helped to hide the maskers when the launches landed them on the wharf of Isola Bella.

Fudge Attic presented a bright contrast to the darkness out of doors, for it was gay with lights and coloured bunting and the paraffine waxed floor all ready waiting for impatient feet. Bridget, stationed just off the landing of the stairway, queened it over a huge punch-bowl filled with lemonade, while the laundry had been transformed into a buffet given in charge of Mose.

The music was furnished by the two captains, one with his fiddle and the other with a concertina. As it was impossible for both to play and keep time together, they alternated in the demonstration of their art.

Lancers and quadrilles were the popular dances with the captains, so they tuned up for a grand march to begin with. The maskers, in couples, waited to take part although “every couple was not a pair.”

A Grand Pasha with a diamond sunburst in the front of his turban led a Red Cross nurse around the attic; following came a Knight in (tin) armour with a Gypsy Maiden. Then came a Happy Hooligan and a Girlie Girl; next, Little Red Riding Hood and a Pumpkin Clown and directly at their heels ran the two bears on all fours, sniffing eagerly at the basket carried by their prospective victim.

The Trail of the Lonesome Pine came stately and slowly all by herself—the branches taking up such a spread of room. After her danced the Yellow

Kid with the Spanish Maid who shook a tambourine tinkling with bells. A bewitching Japanese consorted with a well-filled Laundry Bag and the News-of-the-Day came with a Breton peasant carrying a swaddled babe. Last but not least the Pirate of Penzance marched with a Pierrette.

With an excruciating wail from the fiddle, the march ended and a breathless instant ensued when every one tried to pierce the disguise of the others. No one would speak for fear of being identified by “next friends.” The two bears could growl of course, and this they did to their own great satisfaction.

Captain Ed shouted in his most nautical voice, “Take yer pardners for the lancers!”

In feigned tones cavaliers invited Nurse, Bag and Jap to step the light fantastic with them, while Bears clung to a Pine and Red Riding Hood until the sets were all made up.

At the command “Salute pardners!” heads bowed low and the two bears swayed bearfully from side to side. Then at the call “Swing corners!” both bears tried to hug the little Jap girl so closely that she cried out to the Pasha for help.

During this lively dance the Lonesome-Pine Flo-Flo left much of her Trail upon the floor and Mose found it necessary to hurriedly sweep up the branches with a broom.

Before the lancers ended most of the maskers were identified and therefore were known by their Christian names. The Pasha, however, insisted upon the deference due his rank and resented the familiar appellation of “Uncle Bill.”

Suddenly, from the admiring circle drawn up about the Grand Pasha, Miriam’s voice piped forth: “Why, papa! You’ve got on mamma’s sunburst of diamonds!”

“S-sh—you impertinent Jap! Don’t you know that Girlie Girl hasn’t discovered my decoration? Let me bask in its rays while I may,” came from

the Pasha in wary accents.

At that moment the Tin Knight rattled up while the Polar Bear growled out, "Listen to the Ford Car approaching."

As Red Riding Hood turned to watch the Knight in Armour trying to keep his tin-can plates in order, a revelation came to her and she cried, "Oh, now I know what all that hammering in the pump-house was for! But where did you find all the old empty cans, Fred?"

The concertina now squawked out to its full length and caused every one to choose a mate for the dance. Captain Benton bawled, "All ready for a polker," and started the musical atrocity wheezing. At the same time his body swayed and pitched like a ship in a storm, keeping time with every long-drawn out extension of the bellows. As his vivid imagination pictured the old-time dances he used to step so merrily with his best girl, the faster sounded the wails from the concertina and more erratic grew the time, until finally, the dance ended in a wild riot.

Uncle Bill decided this was the time to calm excitement by refreshing the inner man, particularly as the little tots had to go to bed. So every one trooped down to the well-filled laundry table where Mose was kept busy handing out refreshments. Then once more back in the attic, the fun waxed fast and furious until Uncle Tom called for attention!

"I am now about to distribute slips of paper for each one to write down the name of the costume considered the winner. Whoever receives the most votes will be presented with a prize. The one considered having the funniest or oddest costume will also receive a prize."

This announcement was received with loud acclamations of satisfaction and surprise, for it was not known before. During the comparative quiet while all were pondering the merits of the costumes, a loud "Boom! Bang" came like a blast from the back bay.

Every one rushed to the eastern windows of the attic and Captain Ed, being there first, yelled, "Fire! Fire!"

The others gazed wildly from the windows as a long sheet of flame forked up into the darkness of the night.

“Boom! Boom! Bang!” came again and a mighty Fourth of July display glittered back of the dark firs fringing the shore. By this time, the Pasha, grabbing a large fire-extinguisher, tore down the stairs and went headlong down to the beach. The rest of the maskers were not slow to follow so that before the third explosion sounded they all were near enough to see by the reflection of the flare that a blazing launch was stranded on Isola Bella and already, like a torch, one of the fir trees was burning fiercely.

The danger was evident to all for even the youngest Islander knew that if once the firs caught fire, the entire island was doomed; not only the trees and buildings but also the peat-like soil would burn off of the rocks.

The frantic Pasha, minus turban and sunburst and with only one Turkish shawl trailing from his shoulders, plied the chemicals incessantly while the Tin Knight and the dusky Major-Domo of the buffet tore down blazing fragments of neighbouring trees and the erst-while musicians bravely exerted their muscular strength in pushing off the burning launch from the wharf. And they finally succeeded but at the cost of hair and hands. Uncle Tom, Yellow Kid and the Two Bears quickly formed a bucket brigade of all the other maskers, and with their aid the last spark burning on the island was deluged and extinguished.

After the terrific battle and excitement with the fire had calmed down a forlorn group were discovered huddled on the rocks near the wharf. The owner of the doomed launch gazed hopelessly at the burning boat while his wife cried pitifully by his side.

Their story was soon told. The man was returning from Belfast with three barrels of gasoline on board. The gasoline caught fire—how, he could not tell.

Uncle Bill concluded that a back-fire from the engine ignited the fumes from a leaky tank and of course it took but a moment to wrap the entire launch in flame.

The man and his wife had taken to their small boat as soon as the fire burst forth, knowing of the awful danger incurred from the presence of the three barrels of gasoline. Even though they had escaped before the explosions, both of them were burned, the man's hands being severely blistered.

It was long after midnight before the burns and blisters had been given first-aid treatment; then a smudged and frazzled Masquerade Party were free to go to bed.

The water-soaked Yellow Kid escorted a smoke-streaked Pierrette and a skeleton Pine—nothing now but a few threads and sticks left of the green plumes—to the Orion and home. Thankful indeed, were they that the fire had left them the Orion in which to go home.

As for the Sunset Islanders: they were so excited that no thought of sleep was entertained. It was nearly dawn before the last whisper was silenced in their tents. And then, Bill was heard to say, "Let's go over to Isola Bella the first thing in the morning and have a look at the wreck!"

And his mother called, "If you boys don't go to sleep there won't be any morning, because you'll sleep into the late afternoon."

However, boys never fail to wake up early if there is a circus or some other great excitement to be enjoyed, so all of the Island boys were up and ready to start for Uncle Bill's the moment breakfast was over.

Their intent was to view the wreck and take pictures of the charred remains, but once having landed on the wharf they found Uncle Bill with downcast expression—a most unusual thing.

"Boys," said he, taking them into his confidence, "you remember the Pasha's diamond sunburst of last night?"

Yes, they all did.

"Well, somehow, the Pasha in his undignified exit from the ball-room lost his turban. Of course the sunburst was with it. The turban has been found

but no sunburst!”

“Gee! What did Aunt Miriam say?” cried Billy, sympathetically.

“Well—she is annoyed!”

“We’ll help you look for it, Uncle Bill,” instantly volunteered the boys from Sunset Island.

“Start right in now—the sooner the quicker for me!” replied Uncle Bill.

But the most careful and minute search by the boys failed to locate anything like a brooch. Finally, every one on Isola Bella was enlisted in the campaign, but without success. Several old croquet balls, some tennis balls, a lost doll of Betty’s and other valueless miscellany were combed out from the tall ferns but no diamonds.

Then Bill yelled with joy. “I’ve got it! Here is the bunch of sparkles!”

Every one ran swiftly to be in “at the death,” but it turned out to be a bit of broken cut-glass that lay hidden in the dew-covered green moss.

The indefatigable work of the hunters had to be rewarded whether the pin was found or not, so all were invited to sit down to a well-laden table for lunch.

They sat discussing all possible and impossible places where the diamonds might be, but Aunt Miriam refused to be comforted and Uncle Bill seemed quite unnatural in his rôle of penitent.

“Well, Miriam, you may have lost the diamonds but still you are more fortunate than that poor man and his wife who lost their launch last night,” remarked Uncle Bill, surprised at his wife’s unusual persistence in harping on her loss.

“But *I* didn’t lose it—you are the guilty one!” said she.

“If I had that blamed old sunburst in my hand to make you happy again, I’d help stake that poor old duffer to a new launch! I swear I would!”

declared Uncle Bill, recklessly.

Quietly then, Aunt Miriam rose from her chair and came around the table to lean over his shoulder. He thought she was about to pat him consolingly on the head and say, "Never mind, dear."

So he raised his hand to clasp hers in token of her ready sympathy when his fingers closed over something that gave him a sharp jab.

"Ouch—by heck! That pesky pin!"

He held it out and looked hard at the cause of his recent generous offer while every one laughed freely at his predicament.

"Oh, thou false and treacherous woman! Had I back once more the salty tears I shed o'er yon ferns while seeking for this glittering bauble! Moved by your pretended distress we have wasted the golden moments of this glorious day for naught!"

The Islanders laughed again while Aunt Miriam smiled.

"But it was not wasted time nor loss of tears—for both impelled you to act the Good Samaritan," said his wife.

"Boys, how much do you suppose I'll *have* to donate now, to ease off my conscience regarding that launch?" asked Uncle Bill.

Opinions varied. Billy, taking the part of his namesake thought the man deserved little because of his evident carelessness in carrying gasoline in barrels on his launch.

Fred suggested that every one chip in to help, but Fred had a larger allowance than the younger boys, so Paul, Billy and Dudley made no reply to this plan.

Then, as usual, the feminine contingent carried the vote in the interests of charity and Uncle Bill was mulcted a goodly sum.

“But what I want to know is, ‘Where did Aunt Miriam find that sunburst?’” queried Fred.

And amid appreciative smiles, that fair lady told how, amid the excited rush from Fudge Attic the night before, she had found the diamond brooch sparkling on the floor. She had quietly retrieved it but had no thought of playing any joke on the Pasha until she saw his very preoccupied manner and his avoidance of conversation with her. She was not supposed to have missed the jewel and he was postponing the evil time as long as possible.

After lunch, several games of tennis were enjoyed and when it came time to return to Sunset Island Elizabeth said, “I may as well sail back with you, I suppose.”

“Yes, ’cause we’re all going to Belfast in the morning to replenish the commissary department,” answered Fred.

“Who’s going?” demanded Paul, eagerly.

“Everybody who wants to—we are taking the Medric and expect to spend the day.”

“I suppose you’ll see us up there too, then, as we are going to Belfast to shop before Uncle Bill goes away—he expects to leave here next week, you know,” said Aunt Miriam.

“Oh, won’t we have fun in Belfast—all together!” cried Miriam.

Billy seemed to be thinking of a plan formed the moment he heard Uncle Bill would be in Belfast the next day. So now he turned to ask a question.

“Say, Uncle Bill, you know, one time father said I could have the old engine that was taken from the launch he sold two years ago. Do you think you could help me sell that engine in Belfast and get enough for it to help mother think she can afford to add the rest of the price for a launch?”

Uncle Bill’s eyes twinkled. “Well, not a brand new launch exactly, but it will help buy that old one you’ve had your eye on for the past month!”

“How much does the owner want for it, Billy?” asked Fred.

“Sixty dollars—and every one says it’s the biggest bargain at that price!” exclaimed Billy, eagerly.

“That’s a good business idea of yours, Billy—about the old engine. Suppose you take it with you to-morrow and we will see how much we can raise on it,” responded Uncle Bill.

“Thanks, awfully, Uncle Bill!”

When it came to trading the old launch engine the next day Uncle Bill and his namesake proved themselves to be almost as good Yankees at bargaining as the man who bought it. And the fifteen dollars paid Billy looked mighty good to him as it meant that he was so much nearer the goal of his heart’s desire.

The chief reason for the Islanders being so eager to go to Belfast was soon revealed after the arrival of the boats. An earnest pilgrimage started at the ironmonger’s the moment the trade of the engine was consummated, and continuing up the hilly street ended at the ice-cream soda-fountain of the drug store.

The proprietor made his own syrups and cream and the cooling beverages he dispensed were like nectar. The adults of the party appreciated this fully as much as the juveniles.

Much to Teddy’s joy, they all happened to be in Belfast the day which was the one advertised by the druggist offering a balloon to every one who made a ten-cent purchase. Thus it came to pass that the downward trail of the Sunset Islanders was marked by shreds of exploded rubber “Zeppelins.”

Loaded down to the gunwales so that the “lee-scuppers ran with blood” of beets, tomatoes, corn, onions and other fruit (?) the Medric turned her prow to the south and Sunset Isle.

A peaceful calm brooded over the members of the party—the lunch at the Belfast tea-room had been supplemented by many extras in the grocery

store so that no one missed Mose's generous midday fare.

"Say, Billy, got any more of them cocoanut jumbles?" asked Dudley, wistfully, after a silence.

"No—I only got a dozen. Ask Edith for some of her ginger-snaps."

"I've got a bag of peanuts—Virginia Jumbos. Want some?" asked Elizabeth.

"Children, *do* remember your poor weary stomachs! They will be crying for rest if you don't!" sighed Mrs. Remington.

And the ever thoughtful children, wishing to allay their mother's sighs and fears, rather than limit their gustatory joys moved forward where the Captain stood with Fred steering the boat.

"It's a lucky thing for us that this Belfast trip only happens once in a while," remarked Anna, meaningly.

While cracking and chewing the two quarts of hot peanuts offered by Elizabeth, the Islanders bethought them of one of the Captain's stories.

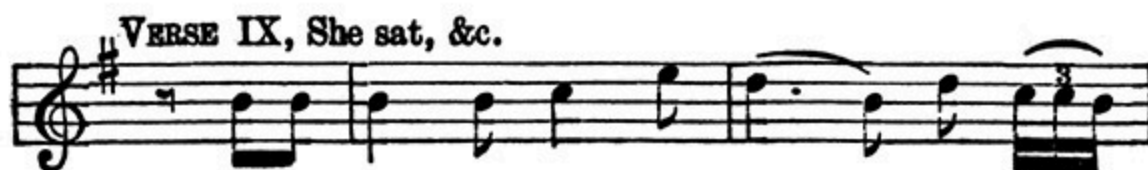
"Say, Captain, how about those pirates that sailed the seas—any up around here in olden times?" hinted Billy.

"We-ll, I've hearn tell of some. They do say that Cap'n Kidd plied his trade in these waters, too. But the worst feller ever known was Manum. Why, he was so wicked there's a song about *him*! And my father said it didn't half do the pirate justice, either!"

"Oh, do let us hear it, Captain!" urged the children.

With deprecatory coughs and some clearings of the throat the Captain began singing in a nasal tenor the ballad of Bold Manum, a curious rhyme with a salty flavour:

BOLD MANUM



Listen

Bold Manum went to sea one day
And it was dreary too,
The dreariest day that ever was seen—
All in the foggy dew.

Oh, we spied a lofty sh-i-ip,
To the leeward of us she lay;
“And it’s up with our main-topsails, lads,
And after her away.”

Oh, we bore right down upon her,
And sheered up ’longside;
And with a speaking tru-um-pet,
“Where are you bound?” he cried.

“Where are you bound,” cried Manum,
“Be sure you answer true,
For I have lost my longitude
Way back a day or two.”

“Oh, we are the ‘Fame of New York,’
To Lisbon we are bound;
Our captain’s name is R. D. Craig,
A native of that town.”

“You lie, you lie,” cried Manum,
“For such a thing can’t be;
Come lower your top-sails on your caps
And fall down under my lee.”

Oh, these bold and thirsty pirates
With their swords right in their hand
They leapt aboard the merchant man
And murdered every man.

Oh, these bold and thirsty pirates,
They ransacked everything,
Until they found a fair damsel

When they found a fair damsel,
Aft in the waist cab-ing.

She sat playing on her ha-a-rp,
Right merrilie did she sing:
“Home, Home sweet ho-o-me,
There’s no place like home.
I followed my true lover
Which caus-ed me to roam.”

Oh, some they cursed, and some they swore
They’d have her for a wife:
When up stepped Bold Manum, saying,
“Oh, I will end all strife!”

Oh, he rushed upon that fair damsel.
Without any fear or dread,
And catching her by her long fair hair,
He slivered off her head!

Captain Ed sang the pirate’s song with such vivid interpretation and dramatic gesticulations that his audience felt a delightful shiver run along their spines. When he finished, a wild applause rewarded his effort.

Then Elizabeth was stirred to emulate the Captain’s donation to music so she offered to sing another old-time sailors’ song called “Strike, Strike the Bell.”

This was a favourite with Fred and Billy so they joined in and soon every one took up the refrain:

STRIKE, STRIKE THE BELL!



Listen

Forward is the lookout man walking on his beat
Up and down the fo'castle with cold hands and feet.
Thinking of his father, and mother as well,
And wishing you would hurry up, and strike, strike the bell!

Refrain:

Strike the bell now, second mate, and send the watch below,
Look away to windward and you'll see it's going to blow.
Look in the glass and you'll find it as well,
And a-wishing you would hurry up and strike, strike the bell!

CHAPTER TEN

FOR THE HONOUR OF THE BLACK BEARS

“WHO wants to sail over to Rosemary and bring back some burlap bags of hay?” called Fred, one rather cloudy morning when every one felt undecided about doing anything on account of the weather.

The three younger boys hastily volunteered and were told to get ready.

“Say, this is a case of sou’westers and oilskins, boys,” called Fred, when he saw them coming from the bungalow with caps and sweaters.

“Why do you need hay—we haven’t a horse or cow to feed?” questioned Dudley.

“Never mind,” replied Billy; “who knows what sort of a wild animal may be prowling around the island pretty soon.” As he spoke with a certain air of knowledge he buttoned a sou’wester strap high under his chin.

“Say—I bet I know!” laughed Paul, eyeing Billy, then Fred carefully.

“What?” demanded Dudley.

“We’re going to stuff a bear for the Mishi-mokwa game, aren’t we, Fred?”

“Right you are! We will, if Elizabeth will help us with the sewing of the burlap,” replied Fred.

“Oh, is that why you picked over that iron junk in Belfast and bought all those sharp-ended rods for spear points?” added Paul.

“When can we make it and have our first game?” asked Billy.

“The sooner we get started the sooner we will have the bear finished, and the rest depends upon that!” replied Fred.

When Uncle Tom heard about the project he willingly donated the burlap bags and hay. Trixie, very curious as she stood in the drizzle in her checked skirt, begged the boys to tell her all about the bear-spearing game.

“You’re going to be invited to the next Council and then you’ll see how to do it,” replied Billy.

“When will that be?” asked Trixie.

“Next Thursday afternoon at three o’clock,” said Fred.

“And then the Honour of the Black Bears will be upheld!” declared Billy.

“Now what do you mean by that,” again asked Trixie.

“Just come to the Council and find out,” was all Billy would say.

But Fred explained. “You see, Billy and I really belong to the Black Bear Tribe when we are home so we are going to challenge all of the members of the Pentagoet Tribe here and the visitors to a Bear Spearing contest. You can join the others if you like and try to beat our score.”

Trixie followed the boys to the shore and waved farewell until they were out of sight in the misty morning. Then she sat on the steps oblivious alike of her damp skirt and the drops of moisture that sparkled on her curls, longing for a camp-life and the simple fun of the Woodcrafters. Finally she realised she was becoming thoroughly wet from the fine rain so she went dolefully back to the house.

At Sunset Island, all hands watched Fred construct the bear. He found he would not need Elizabeth’s help for the sewing as his practice with sailor’s palm and needle came in good even if the stitches were uneven.

What a ludicrous creature it was when completed! A loop of rope for a tail, another for a nose, and a third on the middle of the back. Billy and Paul helped to swing the beast from between two tall birches and Dudley took

the first fling of a spear at it. Dudley had occupied himself in trimming into a wooden spear one of the small standing dead firs that crowded the underbush of the island.

This gave Fred an idea.

“Say, boys, each one of you can make a lot of those kind of spears and we might use them for practice.”

“That’s right! The old bear will last longer than if we used the iron spears on him,” added Billy.

As night came on the fog shut in again and Fred called the boys from their spear-making to look after their tents for the night. That evening the bungalow fire made a cheery spot to gather about, for the dampness out-of-doors was chilly and unfriendly.

“Do you think it will be foggy all day to-morrow?” asked Dudley.

“I don’t think so, but we musn’t kick if it is, as we have had fine weather right along,” replied Fred.

“I know of a fine game to play in foggy weather!” hinted Mrs. Remington.

Instantly, she had every one’s attention—as she knew she would.

“The wood-boxes need a new supply and so many valiant Woodcrafters about here ought to be valiant woodchoppers for a change!” said she.

“Oh piffle! what a game!” sniffed Paul.

The others all laughed at his disgusted look but Fred said, “We’ll do it, mother! Of course it’s a great sacrifice of valuable time, but we would throw it away recklessly for *you*!”

“I am happy to have such generosity shown me, seeing that I am the only one who ever sits before the big fireplace!” laughed Mrs. Remington.

As she seldom had time to sit down with the others when they told stories and played games before the great fire, the children appreciated the sarcasm. And the following morning every available container was filled full of chopped wood.

The morning was foggy so, the wood-boxes attended to, the boys fished off the float-stage for lobster bait. Sculpins and flounders were caught and by this time the mist began lifting. The Captain thought they might row out to the traps to bait them and before the last lobster trap was baited and heaved over the side of the boat, the sun shone out. A little breeze from the west soon scattered the remaining curls of fog and the day turned out to be dazzlingly bright.

For all their patient working the boys found nothing but crabs and starfish in the traps that morning, and they began to fear that the lobster supply around Sunset Island had been exhausted.

“I’ll tell you what we’ve got to do, we’ve got to change the traps and put them over towards the Isleboro side,” said Dudley. “I saw a lot of trap-buoys over that way.”

“Don’t you know those fishermen would gladly set their traps here if it wasn’t for us being on the island?” asked Billy.

And the Captain added: “Bill’s right; and some of these men say they’re goin’ to come and set their traps here anyway.”

“You’d think that all the refuse from fish that we’ve been throwing out from our fish-drying work would have attracted the lobsters long ago, wouldn’t you?” ventured Billy.

“They’re queer critters, all right,” admitted Captain Ed.

“I guess it will be clear for the bear-spearing to-morrow, after all,” Paul said, looking at the blue sky.

“I’ll finish my last iron spear-head to-night and be all ready for it,” added Fred.

Supper over that evening, Fred worked on the spear-head while the other boys tried various ways of tying knots. As the Captain was a master-hand at that craft, he was appealed to and when the boys had been taught to tie some sailor-knots he showed them several trick knots which caused great interest. Then, Mrs. Remington showed them how to do the string trick called "Throwing the Fish Spear."

The following day was clear and sunny and the usual attendance at Council was counted upon by the Islanders. But they were in for a surprise.

When the guests began to arrive, a number of strange launches were seen in the wake of the Orion. It was then learned that neighbouring cottagers of Aunt Edith's had heard of the fun and entertainment provided at a Woodcraft Council and had begged permission to be invited to the next one held on Sunset Island.

A hearty welcome was extended the visitors and the Council opened. When the tally of the last Council was read the guests laughed at the account of the poetry contest. Then came the call for report of scouts.

Billy saluted. "Oh Chief! I have to report that being desirous of obtaining a photograph of a young fish-hawk, or osprey, in a nest on Spruce Island, I climbed the tree carrying Paul's kodak on my back. I found the young osprey dead, hanging dismembered upon a branch below the nest. I could not determine whether this was due to an accident or not. Evidently the bird had been dead some time. I found the tails of seven flounders in and about the nest, also the remnants of other fish."

"I also found a piece of bamboo netting woven into the nest. I managed to climb above and snap a photograph of the nest and dead bird but I regret to say that it was a failure. The film was returned with nothing but blurs on it, so I think I made a mistake in focussing properly."

A discussion ensued over the possible cause of the death of the osprey and the suggestion of accident was decided to be the plausible one.

Uncle Tom made a report on the presence of porcupines in his apple-orchard and asked the help of some brave hunter to help exterminate them.

Billy instantly volunteered and was accepted, providing he came alone. Mr. Charlton knew that Billy was perfectly trustworthy with firearms, but accidents can easily happen when a number of boys are taken along.

“Oh Chief! I have an offer to lay before the parents and guardians here present. I will train the boys in target-shooting and offer a prize to that one who excels at a given time,” now added Uncle Tom.

“How, How!” echoed around the Council Ring at this news.

The vote was unanimous on the part of the younger faction so Fred put it to a motion.

“Oh Chief! I move that a committee be formed of parents to deliberate over this plan,” said Mrs. Remington.

“Second the motion!” added Mrs. Farwell.

On the final vote the motion was carried that the mothers form a committee to report later—not necessarily to the Council but to Uncle Tom or Fred.

The time devoted to the granting of honours now arrived and Elizabeth sprang to her feet.

“Oh Chief! I have a claim to present in behalf of another.”

“Present the claim,” said Wita-tonkan with dignity.

“In behalf of Wita-tonkan of the Black Bear Tribe, I, Pah-hlee-oh of the Apamwamis Tribe, claim low honour for constructing a bear, for the Bear Spearing Game according to the standards in the Book of Woodcraft, edition of 1915,” stated Elizabeth.

“Witnessed by Edward Blake, Dudley West, and William Remington,” concluded she, proudly looking at her brother Fred.

This was indeed a surprise to Fred as he really had forgotten that his recent work on the bear constituted and counted for a *coup*. Nevertheless,

he announced as usual,

“You have heard this claim: it is properly witnessed and moreover will soon be demonstrated at this Council—what is your pleasure?”

The decision was unanimous for granting the *coup* and the visitors’ attention was drawn to the burlap bear swinging between the trees just beyond the Council Ring.

Then the Chief announced: “Friends and members of the Pentagoet Tribe, you may not know that Shingebis and I are old Woodcraft Indians of the Honourable Tribe of Black Bear. To-day we wish to appear as Black Bears in our allegiance and introduce some of the customs of our Tribe. One of these is the challenging for scalps.

“Each Black Bear wears a black scalp-lock when he is in Council. Here is mine,” and Wita-tonkan held aloft a long strand of black horsehair with a loop of thong attached.

“This represents our life! When we challenge for scalps we stake our life. If we lose we have to remain dead until the Tribe votes us alive again.”

Advancing to the Council Fire Wita-tonkan, in the name of Shingebis and himself challenged the Pentagoet Tribe or any visitors present, to a Bear Spearing Contest for scalps!

Paul jumped up and cried, “We accept!”

And a chorus of “Hows!” showed that every one present was brave and daring.

“Oh Chief! How can we pay up if we have no hirsute adornments similar to the Black Bear scalps?” asked Uncle Bill.

“Every one who enters this contest must agree to forfeit a scalp like this or similar. *They can be procured!*” sternly answered Wita-tonkan.

A babel of voices then arose and finally it appeared that Wita-tonkan and Shingebis had twenty opponents arrayed against them in the contest.

“Gee! If the Black Bears win we won’t be able to see them—they will be so covered with scalps,” cried Dudley.

“Oh Chief! that reminds me! What happens should the two Black Bears lose? How can two scalps be divided among so many Pentagoets?” inquired Uncle Tom.

“Why, we each get a lock of hair from their two heads!” laughed Uncle Bill.

“I should say not! We each have one life to lose and we give what we have, one life apiece,” retorted the Chief.

“Then, *who* will get your two scalps?” persisted Uncle Tom.

“No one—the Black Bears will get *yours*!” boasted Fred.

Every one laughed at that but the Chief added seriously: “Our two scalps, *should* we lose, will become the possession of the two Braves opposing, who make the highest scores of individual hits out of the five shots allowed each contestant.”

That was plain and just so they all filed over to the burlap bear.

What a fight that was! The children and inexperienced spearsmen were soon cleared off of the field of action. Paul made a hit but it counted for little as it was not near the red-painted heart of the bear. Dudley scored in the same manner. Elizabeth hit the bear twice but alas! only one spear stuck in so she only scored once. Then they all shouted for a Black Bear. Shingebis stepped forward to try his skill.

The bear was swung erratically but impartially by Captains Ed and Benton. Billy chose his time well and took careful aim. Two of his spears dangled from the bear’s body, one in the very rim of the heart’s circle thus counting ten for his score and the other counting five, making a total of fifteen for his side.

“How! How!” shouted a chorus of voices.

“For the Honour of the Black Bears!” said Billy solemnly.

“Now, watch your Uncle Bill!” cried that worthy, and kerplunk went a spear! It struck the ground below the clumsy beast.

Every one yelled but Uncle Bill had four more trials. In these he netted his side fifteen, which with the three hits of Elizabeth, Paul and Dudley, totalled the Pentagoets eighteen against fifteen of the Black Bears.

Uncle Tom now tried and amid great excitement made a hit near the heart-circle, counting five.

“Hurrah!” shouted Paul, dancing wildly about.

“Twenty-three for our side!” yelled Dudley, throwing a rock out to sea in order to give vent to his pent-up frenzy.

“Beat it, Wita-tonkan—for the Honour of the Black Bears,” urged Billy, anxiously.

“Never fear!” spoke the Island Chief with confidence. “Have I speared the Bear at Wyndy-goul and at Lake Peequo for naught?”

And his boast proved good!

The three hits made by Wita-tonkan raised the Black Bear score, first to sixteen, then to twenty-one and finally to thirty-one.

“Scalp! scalp! Let’s dance the scalp-dance!” screamed Billy shrilly, with overwrought nerves.

“How! How!” came from the others as they participated.

“Now pay up your scalps!” ordered Fred.

“But, this is a serious matter. Here! All you Pentagoets and visitors—don’t you know we’re all dead ones!” cried Uncle Bill in a sepulchral tone.

Thereupon, without further warning, he fell to the ground, dragging Edith, Miriam and Paul down with him in the death-struggle.

The other losers of scalps failed to realise their demise in such a dramatic manner, and contented themselves with laughing heartily at Uncle Bill and his three wriggling understudies.

“Where can we procure scalps?” asked Aunt Edith.

“Why, at any harness store. Get the horsehair dingle-dangles that we use as a substitute for the Black Bear brand,” replied Elizabeth, laughingly.

“I’m going to get a bright red one to show my heart’s blood!” exclaimed Paul.

“Then you’d better get another to use after the tribe votes you alive again,” advised Billy.

“All right, then I’ll get a blue one for that.”

As there were so many dead Indians about, the Council of the living reconvened and voted the dead hunters alive again. Bill was sent out to bring them in, and then the Council closed by singing the Zuni Sunset song.

Every one stood in a semi-circle facing the red glow beyond the western mountains, the light fading perceptibly as they sang.

From the launches that bore away the visitors, the good-byes floated back to the group on shore. And loud and long was the chorus that came from Trixie and the Islanders on the float-stage, for the girl had been invited to remain and visit Elizabeth for a few days, and the young people were all delighted to have her with them.

The weather was very unsettled for the next few days, but that did not interfere with Trixie’s enjoyment. She sailed with Fred, fished with the others, and entered into all of the Island sports with an energy that quite won the admiration of the boys.

“Say, Trix, are you going to wear that checked skirt again to-day? I bet that’s what hoodoos the weather!” said Bill, one morning, seeing that the sun failed to shine.

“Yes, I am!”

“Then, we’ll postpone our walk on Isleboro, for every time you wear that skirt it rains,” continued Fred, teasingly.

“How ridiculous!”

“Nothing of the kind! If you just try another skirt for our sakes, I bet the sun will shine!” asserted Dudley, who saw the look exchanged between Fred and Bill.

“Well, I don’t believe in signs and hoodoos but to please you boys I will wear my short corduroy skirt—and it’s better anyway for walking through the woods,” admitted Trixie.

The boys knew it would be a fine day, and the mist that hid the sun would soon be dispelled, so they chuckled to themselves that Trixie would believe it was her change of skirt.

The walk on Islesboro was for the purpose of completing the tree and flower *coups* of the Pentagoet Tribe and incidentally the sail over to Crow Cove would be enjoyable and add mileage to Fred’s sailing.

“How many miles have you made now, Fred?” asked Paul.

“Just one hundred and one miles.”

“Oh, he’ll do it all right,” said Dudley.

“I intend to,” added Fred, quietly.

“Let’s sail over to the old ‘wreck,’” laughed Billy, in imitation of Maine sailors.

“Maybe there will be enough water under her stern so’s we can sail close under and climb aboard if you want to,” suggested Fred.

This met with approval for every one wanted a good chance to see what a “dead-eye” was and this was an old-timer; though everything removable had long since been taken, the rows of “dead-eyes” stuck up along her sides empty for years of the shrouds they formerly secured.

“What queer names things on boats have,” commented Trixie.

“You will admit that dead-eyes are appropriate in their connection with shrouds,” laughed Elizabeth.

“I never thought of that,” chuckled Billy.

“And why is that rope you are holding called a ‘sheet’?” wondered Trixie.

“Because it is fastened to a corner of a sail,” replied Fred. “Sheet came from the old word meaning something that stuck out, or shot out. Shoot and shot are related words, you know. And as corners stick out a corner of the sail was first called a sheet-line and then the name was applied to the line itself leading from the corner.”

“Well! Where did you find all that out?” said his sister, surprised.

“In the encyclopedia; you see, I too thought the name a queer one so I looked it up.”

“Maybe sheets for a bed were called that because they had corners,” ventured Paul.

“Yes, the book thinks so,” returned Fred. “And the big anchor that was depended upon for safety was called a ‘sheet-anchor’—not because it had corners but because it was shot out into the water. The whole word means a mixup of things but all we need remember is that the sheet here is the line and not the sail.”

“I brought my camera to take a picture of the wreck,” said Paul, as they saw the vessel.

“Wait until I get on her and then take me too, will you, Paul?” asked Billy, eagerly.

“Of course he will, Billy, and we will name it ‘The Two Wrecks,’” laughed Dudley.

When the mariners were once more sailing the seas, Paul remarked, “I wonder if Trix knows the sun is shining!”

“Why, so it is!” cried the girl.

“See there! We told you that checked skirt was the hoodoo,” teased Fred.

“Don’t tell me you believe it would have rained had I worn it?” scoffed Trixie.

“Why not? It brought rain every other day!” laughed Billy.

“Pooh! Elizabeth told me that to-day promised fair, so I know you were only trying to tease me.”

The walk through the woods was enjoyed by all and the boys were delighted to find that they could add enough trees to their lists to make the twenty-five required for a *coup*. With beech, mountain-ash, aspen-poplar, white-cedar, and three kinds of birches and moose-leaf maple to add to the fir, spruce, and pine found on Sunset Island they were able to finish their collection begun with chestnut, catalpa, and various oaks, found in more southerly latitudes.

That evening, as Fred read aloud the list of trees for a *Grand Coup*, Elizabeth, the poetess, turned them into rhyme. Trixie watched her scribble and when through, took it and read it aloud to the circle in the living-room.

THE GRAND COUP FOR TREES

I want to know the trees that grow, they're interesting, you see;
Besides, a woodcraft honour high it may bring now to me.
Don't blame the dog-wood for this verse, though doggerel it be,
Its flowers are much more beautiful than any lines from me.
I'd like to tell you all about the trees both great and small;
'Twould keep me very busy to even name them all!
The pine tree—that fine tree! the elms and the oaks,
Make wood enough and good enough for any sort of folks.
The beech tree, the peach tree together on the strand;
The pretty girls the “peaches” love the “beaches” shining sand.
The palm tree, the balm tree, the bamboo, the teak;
And others from the Orient if we go there to seek.
The orange tree, whose blossoms be much loved on wedding days;
The lemon and the grape-fruit, too, are kin in many ways.
The apple and the apricot, the plum tree and the pear;
The fruits of these are sure to please somebody, anywhere.
The cedar and the hemlock, the fir and pine and spruce,
Are members of one family with wood for any use.
The cotton-wood, the willow for canoes and Indian beds;
The aspen and the poplar that rustles o'er our heads,
The hickory, the walnut, the pecan, now are all
Nut bearers in the autumn to feed us in the fall.
Mulberry trees, wild cherry trees; the mango and the date;
The last you see must be the tree that keeps some men out late.
The sycamores—yes by the scores they line the river's brim.
We know these trees afar, with ease, by mottled bark and limb.
Persimmon and the chinquapin sound good and nice and sweet;
We one and all late in the fall enjoy their fruits to eat.
The china berry is a very charming, flowering tree.
It grows down south, in spite of drought—up north it cannot be.
The pendant locust blooms look good; the tree is fine for shade;
For posts that last 'tis better wood than any other made.
The butternut, the chip-munks' friend, the wood is soft and dark;
We know it by its frond-like leaves as well as by its bark.
The maple is a staple tree, its syrup very sweet

CHAPTER ELEVEN

WITA-TONKAN LEFT IN CHARGE

AT breakfast, Sunday morning, Mrs. Remington announced a startling piece of news.

“Friends, children, and Sagamore-in-the-making! I have to surprise you! Aunt Edith and I are going to Boston on a visit. While I am away you girls are to stay with Aunt Flo-Flo at Rosemary. Anna and Teddy are going to Isola Bella, and you boys are to remain with Fred in charge of the Island. How do you like the plan?”

A mixed chorus arose: “Oh, don’t go!” and “Fine! fine!” “We’ll be good!” and “How long will you stay?”

Mrs. Remington laughed but waited to hear from Fred. He rose and keeping an eagle eye on his future vassals, proclaimed: “Order shall be kept, or I, Wita-tonkan, will perish in the attempt! Wough! a Black Bear has spoken!”

“When you are in charge, you can really earn your title of ‘Island Chief,’ Fred,” remarked Elizabeth.

“When are we going to Mrs. Charlton’s?” asked Trixie.

“I suppose you girls can wait and see me off. You can pack your suitcases for a week or ten days and the Captain can set you ashore at the Rosemary landing after leaving me at the steamer wharf. We are going by the Boston boat you know—it is much cooler.”

What a bustle there was during the two days that ensued.

On Monday, Aunt Flo-Flo and Mrs. Charlton came in the Orion to visit the Islanders.

“I thought it best to come over and take an inventory of my ready-made family,” laughed Aunt Flo-Flo.

“Oh, we’ll be good as saints if you’ll only take us on enough motor-trips to last a month!” exclaimed Elizabeth.

“Maybe the boys would like to sail over for a day’s trip, too,” suggested Aunt Edith, but the boys had disappeared from the porch. Fred had given them the high sign for a pow-wow to be held in his tee-pee immediately!

That evening the girls begged to be told what was the cause of the serious and animated pow-wow. Portentous looks were all the answer returned while Mrs. Remington remained in the room.

“Say, who wants to walk to the south end of the island and watch the tide come in in the moonlight?” asked Fred, when it was found that his mother expected to remain in the room.

Every one declared they wanted to see such a sight, and soon the room was vacated and quiet—Mrs. Remington being occupied with her written orders for Mose during her absence.

Once down upon the little beach, Fred announced that he and the others planned to do lots of things that his mother wanted done. Such as blasting out a big rock in the middle of Treasure Cove, raising a big new flag-pole, and making a pebble walk around the little log-cabin which was Mrs. Remington’s sanctuary when she was driven to retirement from the “madding crowd.”

“She will love that!” exclaimed Elizabeth.

“Oh we intend doing lots of other things, too,” bragged Billy.

“We’re going to cook our own meals over a camp-fire!” declared Dudley.

“That’s to save Mose the work while you girls are away!” added Paul.

“Listen to him! Why, you boys eat twice as much as all of the Islanders together!” scorned Edith.

“Besides, I don’t believe you younger boys can cook a thing!” came from Elizabeth, doubtfully.

“I wouldn’t want to eat the stuff you cook!” said Trixie.

“Fred and Bill know a lot about camp-cooking and they are going to show Paul and me,” admitted Dudley.

The idea of having the boys do something to surprise and please Mrs. Remington upon her return, made Trixie and her girls wish to do something for Mrs. Charlton. So a conference was held in Elizabeth’s room to which Anna was invited.

“What *do* you s’pose Aunt Edith would like most?” asked Elizabeth after all were seated.

“I know!” cried practical little Edith.

“What?”

“Her flower beds weeded and all that wild grass dug out of the paths.”

“Oh!” was the disappointed reception of the commonplace proposition.

“I can wear old gloves, you know,” ventured Trixie.

Her hearers laughed as Trixie’s nails still showed the result of the earnest efforts of a city polish, of which she was quite proud.

“Well, we may consider Edith’s plan as a side-work,” grudged Elizabeth, when no other inspiration seemed on tap.

Mrs. Remington was not permitted to forget her promise to take everybody on the Medric for a last farewell to her at the Camp Grounds where the Boston boat stopped for passengers. Whether it was the farewell,

the sail, or the fun on the mainland that was the inducement, she wisely refrained from questioning.

“What if it rains!” wondered Edith.

“Oh, we can wear clothes that won’t be damaged by a drop of rain,” said Elizabeth.

“Trixie can wear her checked skirt if it’s rain you want,” plagued Billy.

“Now then, I’ll wear it just for spite!” retorted Trixie. “I’ll prove to you by the sunshine that the checks are not a rain jinx!”

Tuesday dawned clear and sunny, therefore proving Trixie’s statement to be true. The merry party set out directly after lunch as Mrs. Remington remarked that the Boston boat was very early at odd times—especially so, if one happened to be a little late.

The Medric’s engine helped her “buck” the tide while Bill remarked, “We sure have got a favourable puff!”

It was almost low water when they reached the wharf and the Medric had to be anchored off the landing while her passengers were set ashore in the tender.

The moment feet were on *terra firma*, the owners started for the post office and general store where candy and cake were sold; but, on the way a tin-typer’s caravan was found resting by the side of the main road from the wharf, and the diversion was invaded and well patronised that day.

The meagre delights of the Camp Ground were soon exhausted and time hung heavily upon the hands of the active Islanders. Then Mrs. Remington announced that the Boston steamer would be an hour late that day.

“Oh, why did we leave our happy home?” wailed Billy.

“Think of all the fun we are missing!” added Paul.

“There are certain joys in a lingering farewell but I say that some of them are drawn out much too long!” remarked Fred.

“How! how!” laughed the other boys, and Mrs. Remington joined even at the expense of her own feelings.

“The question still remains before us—what to do with this extra hour the gods bestowed?” mourned Elizabeth, who had had visions of Rosemary in the sunset glow.

“I’ll run over and ask that jitney man who is watching us as if we were outlaws,” said Fred, starting off across the road.

The man was very communicative for he had nothing else to do at the time.

“Thar’s a merry-go-round back over that hill—it was runnin’ all mornin’ an’ I guess it’s thar still.”

“Just the thing!” replied Fred, thanking him.

The suggestion met with instant acceptance and every one started for the hill designated. But a disappointment awaited them. The merry-go-round was deserted with the sole exception of a small tow-headed boy.

However Fred was equal to the emergency. “Come one, come all, these steeds shall run around this track ’til set of sun,” shouted he, beckoning wildly.

But Mrs. Remington would not allow him to tamper with the engine or carousel, so she questioned the small boy who turned out to be the proprietor’s son.

“Now, you run and find your Daddy and tell him we want two dollars’ worth of rides!” promised Mrs. Remington.

At the munificent offer the bare-footed urchin showed a swift and dusty pair of heels to the would-be riders, and soon returned with both father and grandfather—the latter being the patriarch of the money-till.

“Isn’t this fun! I’ve always wanted to ride on a merry-go-round!” cried Trixie.

“Maybe you won’t think it fun after a ride!” said Paul.

“You just watch me and see!” boasted Trixie, smiling.

“I’m going to climb on the animals while we’re waiting for the man to start up the engine,” proposed Billy.

“Me for the lion!” shouted Dudley, as he mounted the king of beasts.

“Paul, let’s ride the white horses side by side and pretend we’re running a race,” suggested Trixie.

“Bet’che a cookie I’ll beat!” laughed Paul.

“You wouldn’t beat me if these were real horses! I can ride anything—even a colt!” teased Trixie.

“Oh, well, that colt of the Captain’s was green and full of fire—the Captain says so!” said Paul, defensively.

The carousel began to turn slowly by this time and with many a wheeze and groan, it gathered momentum. Every one laughed at its slowness at first but the urging on of their steeds must have infected the merry-go-round for it soon whirled at a surprising speed.

Mrs. Remington sat near the old white-bearded ticket chopper, watching the different expressions on the children’s faces as the carousel went round.

When the first slow circle was made Trixie had laughed merrily and cried, “Oh, this is a real joy-ride!”

When it went somewhat faster, she remained silent, and as she spun around on the horse, passing Mrs. Remington at rapid intervals, her face looked grey and her eyes seemed fixed.

“Oh! we surely are going too fast!” gasped she, finally.

“Oh, no! We’ll go faster than this—just hold on!” cheered Paul.

“Oh, I’m sure I’m slipping off—oh, oh!” wailed Trixie.

“You’re all right—just stick on!” laughed Paul.

“O-oh—Paul—I’m getting so dizzy! I’ll fall!”

“I’ll steady you; here, grab hold of the horse with your knees and hang on to the iron pole in front!” advised Paul.

“There goes my hat—and oh! the old thing has shaken out all my side-combs!” came from Trixie, weakly.

“Never mind that—just hold on!”

“I ca-an-t hold ano-oth-er m-m-min-ute!”

“Keep a stiff upper lip, now, Trix! We’re slowing down!” encouraged Paul, throwing an arm about the girl as she swayed uncertainly.

And indeed, the awful whirl did slacken and in a few more moments, with one last “yawp” the hurdy-gurdy gave up the spirit—of music.

Then a very pale and shaky Trixie was lifted from the race-horse and helped over to a seat beside Mrs. Remington.

“Oh, wasn’t it *awful*!” gasped she, shuddering.

“Awful! Why, it was great!” cried Dudley.

“I should say so! Look, I got the brass ring Trixie! Want it for another try?” asked Billy, generously.

But Trixie thought “discretion to be the better part of valor.” She knew from actual experience what a merry-go-round meant so she sat contentedly by and watched the others whirl.

When even Billy had been sated with the dervish delight Mrs. Remington led her escorts back to the wharf where they found Aunt Edith and Aunt Flo-Flo had arrived from Rosemary by land.

When it was suggested that the girls start back with Aunt Flo-Flo at once, there was a chorus of protests.

“We’re going to stay as long as anybody—and say good-bye,” retorted Elizabeth, fearing she would miss some fun.

The two chiefly concerned in saying farewells thought this persistence worthy of a greater if not a better object. But they consented to the delay of the return party and in its own good time the “City of Rockland” bore down upon the landing. Then the young folks had the gratification of positively *knowing* by evidence of their own sight, that their guardians were well out of the way for a time.

“Oh, *gee!* we won’t do a *thing* while we’re boss!” sighed Billy, with a great sense of the time before him.

“Some fun—I should say!” ejaculated Paul, while Dudley whistled a medley of many tunes and fox-trots and tangos.

“But the Island Chief rules! Remember!” threatened Fred.

While on the way to Rosemary, the Islanders discussed the fact that fine weather broke the hoo-doo of Trixie’s rain jinx.

“But it hoo-dooed her in another way—my! but she was green on that carousel!” laughed Billy.

“I never thought Trix could look so sick!” added Dudley.

“I wasn’t sick a bit! I was only dizzy—only my head!” defended Trixie, valiantly.

The boys laughed teasingly and Elizabeth looked off at the horizon while groping for her poetic medium.

Finally, she turned to Trixie. “It’s a shame to wreck a perfectly good poem for I love Tennyson dearly, but the aptness tempts me beyond measure, so here goes!”

THE JINX THAT PURSUED TRIXIE

(With apologies to Tennyson)

Like souls that balance joy and pain,
With smiles and cries for help again,
Fair maiden Trixie flies with rein
Upon her good steed's wooden mane.
The tin-pan music full of cheer,
Her friends' loud laughter came between,
And far in ticket-box unseen
The Grey-beard gathered in the green
From Wita-tonkan there.

At times the organ piped its song,
What time 'twas loud, her seemed it long;
Sometimes her courser wheeled along,
Hushed all her cries of bitter wrong:
By laughing friends, with fuller sound,
In curves the wooden racers ran;
Her drooping head to bob began
Upon the Merry-go-round.

As in the boyhood of the year
Sir Launcelot and Queen Guinevere
Rode thro' the converts—Pauly dear,
And Trixie galloped—she in fear,
She seemed apart from her steed's spring!
A gown of fated check she wore,
Buckled with silver clasps before,
A light straw hat embroidered o'er
With woolen bird a-wing.

Now this way leaned she, now she let
Her fear the better of her get,
And more and more unsteadier yet,
Her nervous grasp Paul's shoulder met!

And fiercer now she grasped the mane
Than she whose elfin courser springs
By night to eerie warblings;
While all the while that music rings,
And dins into her brain.

As she fled fast thro' sun and shade,
The happy winds upon her played,
Loosing the ringlets from the braid;
She looked so helpless as she swayed,
Her hat one side a-tip,
Pauly had all that he could do
To keep himself from falling too;
He needed all the strength he knew,
To save her should she slip!

The classic thus converted by Elizabeth was hailed with loud acclaim by the boys, but Trixie said never a word! How the poetess made her “separate peace” was never told but Trixie was as friendly as ever the next time the two appeared together.

Wednesday morning at the earliest permissible tide the Captain and the boys were busy drilling into the ledge of Treasure Cove. The boys were deeply interested when they realised that before another tide flowed over that ledge a blast could be set off. In the meantime, they went fishing and soon had a fine mess of cunners for their camp-lunch.

Knowing the extent of the boys' appetites, Mose's tender heart ached in dread of empty stomachs and a raid on his pantry when he was not at hand to defend the fort! So he brought a large pan full of biscuits and “fixin's on th' side” to the cooks. The “fixin's” comprising a hearty meal by themselves.

“Oh, Mose, you needn't to have taken this trouble—we're just going to live a simple life while mother's away,” said Billy.

“Yes, you see, Mose, we're now serving our toasted bread and baked potatoes. Sit down and have some with us?” urged Paul.

Mose eyed the charred bread and half-cooked potatoes and winked at the Captain. “Ah don’ b’lieve Ah will pa’take ov dis munifercence to-day! But, t’ank yo’ all d’ same!”

The Captain felt very grateful for Mose for his additions to the menu, so he added, “Oh, do sit down and be friendly, Mose.”

“Yes, Mose, I’m just cookin’ the cunners! They’re fine!” added Fred.

“Well, seein’ ez Ah fetched a bit from m’ own domain, Ah don’t min’ ef Ah tas’ some cunners!” sighed Mose, who was fond of this fish.

As Fred served him a delicious slab of the broiled fish Mose remarked, “Does tas’ kinder good t’ eat some odder chef’s cookin’. No t’anks, Billy, Ah don’ guess Ah’ll have any pertates.”

The boys each took a potato and did their best to enjoy them but it was not to be! The potatoes were more than half raw.

“Lemme tell you-all,” said Mose, after the potatoes had been replaced on the fire, “taters take a heap o’ cookin’. Speshully when dey’s big and not cut up.”

“Bring them here, boys, and I’ll show you what to do with them,” offered Fred, taking the frying pan and dropping a chunk of butter in it.

Then the boys watched and soon learned how to fry good potatoes—an art many cooks lack.

“Now for the blast!” cried the Captain, when the dishes and pans had been cleaned with sand and water.

“You boys watch Captain and me fix the fuse and then when we yell you must run way up on the porch of mother’s retreat and stand there,” ordered Fred.

The three boys were greatly surprised to see Captain Ed cut the dynamite with his knife as if it were a cheese.

“It looks just like a roll of yellow plasticene!” said Dudley.

“It won’t act like one!” laughed Billy.

“You know last year, Captain and Fred blasted out the boulders for our Council Place and we had to cover the rocks with logs and things to keep them from flying through the air and smashing the windows,” explained Billy, for Paul’s and Dudley’s benefit.

“Oh, did you blast for that Ring?” wondered Paul.

“I should think we did! We have to blast for everything! There isn’t a level spot on the whole island. Did you think the pebbles grew so level and smooth on that Council Place?” laughed Fred.

“I thought it had to be filled in where any hollows happened to be but I didn’t know you had to blow off the bumps!” said Paul, in defence.

That made the Captain laugh, and he now turned and said: “Run to cover now, boys! I’m goin’ to light th’ fuse!”

So the boys scrambled up the pathway while Fred and the Captain lit the fuse and then ran to hide behind a big spruce. But Paul, curious to note the effect of that harmless looking cheese, lingered behind the other boys, thus hoping to get a closer view of the explosion.

Just as the terrific blast rumbled, Fred sighted the tardy boy. He dashed out, grabbed him roughly, yanked him back to safety, and then pitched into him.

“Don’t—you’re hurtin’ me, Fred!” whimpered Paul, with a better realisation of his danger as the rocks began raining down upon the spot where he had just stood.

“You ought to be hurt—good and plenty, too! Just so you’ll never do such a fool thing again! I’m Chief of this Island, I’ll have you to know, and you’ve *got to obey orders!*”

Billy and Dudley ran to see what had caused the quarrel and the Captain, who had seen the rescue, came over to tell Paul a story as a warning in the future.

“You boys know the light-house just down off Spruce Island? Well, last year, ol’ Captain Ball was blastin’ out some rocks in the road near his barn. He got keerless like at the last and stood too near—right out in the open. And by heck! a chunk of rock as big as my two fists come plumb down on top of his head and killed him then and thar! Not a minit t’ think of what he wanted done ’bout things!”

After an impressive silence the Captain added with a certain feeling of satisfaction: “But he had a grand funeral! The finest ever given in these parts. One of them Dark Harbour millionaires lent the widder his big private yacht to carry the remains to Metinicus, where the Cap’n hailed from.

“Seein’ she hadn’t got to pay any costs for shippin’, Mrs. Ball put all that money in a casket and it was so fine that it seemed like a shame to put all them silver handles and satin puffs in the ground.

“Widder Ball invited *everybody* to make the trip with the Cap’n an’ most every one accepted the invitation, too. Thar would have been room on that yacht fer a few more—it was that big.

“Yes, sir! That was one grand funeral—what with red plush curtains and willow arm-chairs everywhere! And a dining-room fixed up with painted dishes and sparklin’ glass! I sometimes wish how old Cap’n Ball oughter know about that trip—he would have felt better where he is, I’m sure!”

The boys had listened to the sudden ending of Captain Ball’s career without due respect for dynamite and Captain Ed, finding Paul had not been thoroughly frightened by his tale, drove it well home.

“But *you* wouldn’t have a good time like Captain Ball! You’d be sent home in a box and no yacht and crowd of folks to sail to your funeral! So, just keep behind a tree after this!”

Paul suddenly realised how lonely he must feel if he was instantly killed by a rock and freighted all the way from Maine to New Jersey, and he felt contrite and humble for a full hour after the incident closed.

The rest of the afternoon was given to preparing an old spar for the flag-pole. It was about thirty feet in length so that all the boys worked at the same time in sand-papering and polishing the wood.

“Next time I go over to the Cove I’ll have the blacksmith make a collar to go around the mast-head, and then we’ll have it all ready for the raisin’ bee before your mother comes back.”

“We want everything done and waiting so all we have to do when she comes is to hoist the flag,” added Billy.

The following day Uncle Tom came over and announced that he was ready to start the rifle-range and teach the boys how to handle a gun.

“Did they say we could?” asked Paul, eagerly, his desire to obey in certain ways, tintured by the tale about Captain Ball.

“Yes, the committee reported favorably providing that I would keep watch of you all and never let you get reckless!”

So, the boys painted a large target on a packing case and set it up against a rock where a clear range could be had. Uncle Tom chose a spot where no danger to passing boatmen could be incurred.

The spy-glass was trained upon the target and each boy was allowed five shots each turn. The use of the glass obviated the many tiresome trips to and from the target to count the score for every boy.

Only between the turns did the Captain go to the board and put a dab of paint on the marks made by each boy. During these intervals no one was allowed to load or handle a gun.

Captain Ed made a splendid score with Fred’s Marlin 38–55 but Paul and Dudley took a long time to get the proper range and sight. Their bullets cut

into the ledges right and left so that the Captain laughed heartily.

“When we need more blastin’ done there’s no use wastin’ money for dynamite—we’ll jus’ ask you two boys to aim at Treasure Cove and your fire will blow off the top of the ledges!”

The others tittered but were too much engaged to care much whether the Captain joshed them or not. Then, Fred, who stood at the spy-glass called, “A hit for Paul!”

That spurred Dudley to better work so when it came his turn to try he took great pains to aim carefully and was rewarded by seeing the splinters fly from the packing-case.

Evening came all too soon for the joy of firing real rifles was intoxicating to the boys. They begged Uncle Tom to be sure and come over every day, as early in the morning as he could get away.

“Oh, but I’m scheduled to take the girls out on some of these days,” he protested. “However, I’ll try to get in some regular practising hours with you boys.”

The rifle-range was almost forgotten the next morning when Captain Ed brought in the mail. An answer from Mr. Remington to Billy’s plea for the launch, authorised him to “Go ahead and get it if the Captain says it is all right!”

As that necessitated an immediate exodus from the island, an eager pilgrimage started for the little landing near Saturday Cove, where lay the coveted craft at her moorings.

To the disinterested eye she seemed old and shabby, to say nothing of dirt. To Billy, however, she was a vision of beauty and a promise of joy. The ex-owner took the lad for a trial spin so that he could learn the tricks of the little engine.

Billy disdained the tow offered by Captain Ed and insisted upon returning under his own power. Not for nothing had he watched and helped

for weeks with the Captain's engines, hoping for the day when he should be captain of his own launch.

That same night, as they lounged about Fred's teepee, the Chief made a suggestion.

"Now that Cap'n Bill has a launch suppose we make an aqua-plane? We might start it to-morrow."

The idea was met with delighted "Hows!" and in the morning all started on the carpenter's job.

The plane completed, the boys felt such a pride in the work that they longed for some one to admire it. Besides, they had to have an audience when they aqua-planed. So it came about, that all of the girls and Aunt Flo-Flo were invited to a bathing party with aqua-planing on the side.

The boys drank greedily of the admiration freely poured out by the girls as they stood about the plane. Finally, the girls were invited to try it.

"Isn't it awfully hard to manage?" asked Trixie.

"Not much harder than that wooden horse on the merry-go-round," teased Paul.

"Even if you should fall off you can swim, you know," added Billy.

"I'll let Elizabeth try it first," generously allowed Trixie.

Elizabeth was a splendid swimmer and nothing on or in water could daunt her, so Billy was soon towing her along after his launch.

"Gee! That's pretty good, Lizzie—for a girl, I mean!" conceded Billy, as he admired the way she stood upright and managed the plane.

"You needn't have added that last—'for a girl'; just remember please, that I learned to swim at a much younger age than you ever did!" retorted Elizabeth, ruffled at the hated nick-name.

Then, when every one had tried the aqua-plane Aunt Flo-Flo had something to say. “Won’t you boys come over to Rosemary and hold a Council for some friends of mine?”

What with rifle shooting, aqua-planing, and other intense delights, the boys were not as enthusiastic as usual.

“We’re going to have piles of ice-cream and delicious cakes—to say nothing of other good things,” hinted Elizabeth, her superior knowledge of boys standing her in good stead.

“We-ll—seeing that you all want a Council so much, maybe we can manage,” said Billy, looking at the other boys.

“All right—when?” hastily accepted Aunt Flo-Flo.

“I s’pose Mose will freeze some cream for us as usual on Sunday and Thursday so we’d better say Tuesday, as that gives us ice-cream on an off day,” interjected Paul, before any one could decide.

“All right! Then we can go marketing to Belfast on Monday, and spend Tuesday at Rosemary,” said Fred.

The Tuesday for the Council was a lovely day and Paul took a snap-shot of Aunt Flo-Flo and her visitors. The Nature *coups* were claimed by Elizabeth and the three younger boys. Then Trixie formally presented a red scalp to the Black Bears and Elizabeth followed suit. Paul and Dudley also paid their forfeited locks so that Fred and Bill had a number of brilliant trophies hanging from their belts.

Finally, the much-longed-for ice-cream was brought and the pyramids piled up on the boys’ plates received sincere applause and attention.

Among the cakes passed around were certain cookies that the boys preferred to any others. So good were they, that Billy remarked, “My! But these are the best ever!”

“Who do you think baked them?” asked Trixie, eagerly.

“Not you, anyway!” laughed he.

“Well, Smarty, *we* did! Elizabeth and I made the batter and Edith cut them out and put them in the pans.”

“Hoh! That’s nothing! *We* cook whole meals at our camp!” exclaimed Paul.

“Yes siree! Say, boys, how about that breakfast yesterday, eh?” boasted Dudley.

“Umph! You ought to have tasted *that*! Billy went over to Islesboro in his launch and shot five red squirrels. We skinned and broiled them for breakfast and maybe they weren’t good!” said Fred, abetting the younger boys.

“What else did you have?” queried Elizabeth.

“Fred baked some pancakes and we ate, and ate, and ate!” asserted Paul, looking at his companions.

“I never saw any one eat so much as they did, except at our clam-bakes,” said Fred.

“Well, maybe you *baked* the pan-cakes but Mose was there to advise and start that breakfast going!” asserted Trixie.

“Who told you so?” cried a number of voices.

“We just went over to get something Elizabeth wanted from the Island and you were all gone to Adamses for milk. Mose told us about the squirrels and the funny mistakes you boys made while experimenting on them. And he told us of the towers of pancakes you boys made way with, too.”

“Do you know, we haven’t had our annual clam-bake yet?” hastily declared Billy.

“That’s so! As soon as mother comes home we must try and get it started,” added Fred.

“Oh, Trix, we have the most wonderful time at these bakes!” exclaimed Billy, rolling his eyes and patting his stomach.

So, in talking and planning for the clam-bake, the thin ice of camp-cooking was forgotten and the character of the boys for being first-class chefs was not completely ruined.

CHAPTER TWELVE

THE PIRATES OF SCILLY LEDGE

“SAY, Fred, did you see the Boston steamer go past this morning?” asked Billy, wonderingly, one day.

“Come to think of it, I didn’t!”

“Neither did I,” said Dudley.

“Nor I,” added Paul.

“It gets to be such a habit when the boats go past—up in the morning and down at night—that their absence is quite noticeable,” said Fred.

But the boys forgot about the failure of the big white steamer to put in her appearance as usual. That afternoon, they were out with the Captain when a fisherman from Saturday Cove hailed them.

“Hey! Cap’n! Th’ Ol’ Katahdin’s gone ashore on Scilly Ledge, this mornin’!”

“You don’t tell!” cried the astonished Captain.

“That’s why we didn’t see her go by!” said Billy.

“Can they get her off?” Fred shouted after the informer.

“Nah—they tells me she’s a total wrack!”

The boys looked at each other while the same desire sprang up in each heart—to visit that wreck!

“Can’t we go down and see her, Captain?” asked Billy.

“Well, it’s purty far out to sea—off Monhegan; and, besides, the ground swell’s bad there,” hesitated Captain Ed.

“Captain, if Aunt Miriam will lend us the Zeus and Benton goes along, don’t you s’pose it will be all right!” urged Fred.

The Captain had hard work hiding his own desire to go, being stirred by inherited beach-combing tendencies. Hence, he agreed to the exciting plan.

Without the loss of any time, the boys sailed over to Isola Bella and in a pleading manner broached the subject to their aunt. They must not seem too eager or the trip too exciting or she would refuse her consent.

Rumour had travelled swiftly so that Captain Benton had heard and also was stirred by the spirits of his ancestors to visit that wreck! Hence, he thought it was perfectly safe and a most delightful excursion for the boys to take!

Early the next morning, therefore, the launch set out for old Scilly Ledge. Down past Camden, around Owl’s Head, through the narrow Mussel Ridges Channel, past White Head and out to open sea, steered the Captain of the Zeus!

Well for the boys that the big launch was the seaworthy craft that she was. Before they caught sight of the doomed steamer the ground swell had gotten in its deadly work. Three seasick lads lay limply on the cushions feeling that the Zeus was going down never to climb again, as she dropped into the hollows between the swells.

Soon, however, as she rose on the crest of each great wave, the stirring sight of hundreds of craft converging with the Zeus to a common centre, revived the drooping spirits of the boys and the “green” sensations gradually disappeared.

“She must be abandoned, all right!” remarked Captain Ed.

“‘Tain’t curiosity what brings all them craft here,” hinted Captain Benton.

The boys pricked up their ears. What did the Captains mean?

“I always knew them Metinicus an’ Isle of Holt fellers were pirates at heart!” sneered Captain Ed.

“Well, you see, it ain’t stealin’—not exactly, you know!” argued Benton.

“Oh sure not! Flotsam and jetsam’s anybuddy’s pickin’s, and she’s all ensured anyhow,” conceded Captain Ed.

“You don’t mean to say that all these folks are here to grab something from that steamer?” cried Fred, aghast.

“That’s just it!” replied the Captain.

“Oo-oh! if that isn’t stealing in the eye of the law, why can’t we pick up something too—just a souvenir, you know!” ventured Billy, breathlessly.

By this time, they were drawing closer to the wreck. Careened over, rolling and crunching in the heavy swells, the Katahdin was too dangerous for close quarters, and in fact, that was the only thing that kept the circling boats at a distance from her.

The greed of the watchers was stimulated by the stray bits of wreckage that were seen swashing around, and so contagious is the desire to get something for nothing, especially when the law smiles leniently upon the pirate, that the boys and Captains in the Zeus otherwise peaceable law-abiding Americans, now felt the maddening frenzy to secure a prize, too.

Suddenly, a fiercer gust of wind and a seventh wave struck the hapless boat at the same time raising her up only to crash her down amidships on the back-bone of Old Scilly. With a rending and splitting heard above the roar of the breakers, the steamer broke in two and began to vomit forth her cargo.

After that pandemonium reigned. The boys could never tell just when they, too, turned into lawless pirates!

In the wild scramble for the floating cases from the hold of the steamer, many a launch and boat had the bows stove in. Free fights ensued and the butts of oars were used with telling effect on the heads of others. Of course, the Zeus did not engage in this warfare, but she soon was piled high with a miscellaneous freight.

As for the prizes contained in that cargo, it wasn't a time to pick and choose, but a case of "grab and get" before it sank from sight.

A crate floated near the boys and piercing squeals from the inside drew the attention of the pirates of the Zeus to it.

"It's a pig!" cried Dudley.

"Oh, let's rescue it before it drowns," called Paul.

When the captains and Fred Anally succeeded in hauling the heavy crate inboard, poor piggy's squeals had ceased.

"Let's use 'first aid' on it!" exclaimed Billy, eagerly.

"He's a fine-looking shoat, all right," commented Benton.

"Let's wrench off the slats on top and get him out He'll take up less room uncased," suggested Captain Ed.

"We can try 'first aid' on him, then," giggled Paul.

As the crate was opened and piggy removed, Billy said: "I bet he was a prize pig for the Belfast Fair."

"Here, Captain, let us look at the address on the crate and see where he was going!" exclaimed Fred.

But no ink mark was left on the case and the tag that had been tacked to the wood was soaked off by the water. So the rescuing party were none the

wiser after the examination.

“Well, roast pig ain’t to be sneezed at, anyway,” said Benton.

But just then, piggy revived and slipped from Benton’s hold. He started a circus in the launch with all hands trying to catch him, and more than once, the boys very nearly fell into the water in their mad scramble to grab him. Finally, the unruly passenger was cornered and “hog-tied.”

“We’ll give him to Uncle Tom, because none of us Islanders can use him,” suggested Fred.

And so piggy was destined to find a temporary resting place on the farm at Rosemary.

It had taken three hours to sail down to Old Scilly Ledge and it was long past lunch-time before the excited pirates thought of anything so commonplace as eating!

A large broken box of fancy biscuits reminded them that they could feel hungry now that the first excitement was over, and the sandwiches Mose had packed in the lunch soon disappeared. The erstwhile seasick boys, being hollow clean down to their toes, caused the lunch to melt away like ice in a hot sun. Then followed the slightly soggy and salted crackers.

With sighs of regrets, the two captains then suggested that they turn for the homeward trip,

“Oh, just one more haul!” cried Billy, spearing for a floating case near at hand.

“Where can you find room to stack any more?” asked Benton.

“Oh, this is a case of biscuits—fancy mixed, too!” exclaimed Billy, having guided the prize to the side of the launch.

Without demur, the case of crackers was brought inboard and then Fred called out: “There’s a little box floating away from us—‘precious goods come in small packages,’ you know, so we ought to get that!”

“Another feller’s after it—quick—hurry up!” cried Paul.

The pirates on the Zeus won the race and the small half-submerged box was carefully lifted aboard.

“Now, I insist that we start home!” declared Captain Ed.

“Even as it is we won’t get there until after dark!” added Benton.

“Never mind, we’ve done a big day’s work!” chuckled Fred.

“I should say so! Gee! pigs, crackers, and whatnot!” added Billy, gloatingly.

“Ed, I bet those vultures won’t leave a stick on that boat—why, every little shack down the bay will have one of them red-plush chairs from the saloon, and every one on Metinicus will be sleepin’ on good mattresses—after they’re dried out,” grumbled Benton.

On the way home the boys investigated their treasure trove. The small box that had caused such a lively race was found to contain a gross of Ingersol watches. But most of them were utterly spoiled from the salt-water bath. The better ones, packed individually in small close-fitting cases, proved to be in fairly good condition.

Oh, what joy to the hearts of these mariners! To hear the ticking of a watch on every passenger of the Zeus—a watch that might be consulted as often as one liked without regard to the others!

“Here’s the last one of the good lot; what shall we do with it?” asked Dudley.

“Tie it around the porker’s neck!” laughed Paul.

“Oh, no! Let’s take it home to Mose; he will be tickled to pieces with it,” exclaimed Billy.

So the little box was tucked in Billy’s pocket to be given to the appreciative cook. Then the boys turned over another case.

“Here boys!—don’t open up anything else, or the clutter will choke the engine!” begged Benton.

They laughed at that but promised to wait for landing before investigating any further.

That night, the Islanders passed a delirious time amidst the contents of the cases picked up from the Katahdin.

The first case opened was found to be packed with woodenware—bread boards, chopping-bowls, potato mashers, and such.

“Great Scott! Here’s enough wood to build a house!” said Paul.

“I’ll tell you what! These oval and round bread-boards’ll make dandy totems for every one!” cried Billy.

“That’s what they will; and the mashers will do for the tom-toms when we hold Council,” added Dudley.

“Now don’t be silly—you know there wouldn’t be any drum head left in the tom-tom if you boys beat time with one of those wooden potato-mashers,” said Fred, trying to pry off a slat.

“Where’re you going?” asked Paul of Billy, who had piled an armful high with wooden dishes.

“Give ’em to Mose—he needed some new kitchenware!”

At that, Paul and Dudley each caught up a wooden bowl and a wooden masher and marched after Billy, beating time for his steps.

“Hey, Mose! Here’s your answer to prayer! I heard you, last week, saying that you hoped the good Lord would send you some kitchen dishes mighty quick!” laughed Billy.

“Ah no—’deed no, chile! Mose neber prayed no wicked pray’r lak dat—mebbe dat wreck coul’ be laid t’ de doah ov such a pray’r! And Mose sure ain’t guilty of *dat*! But, what Ah did say was ‘Ah wisht de dear Lord woul’

take pity on poor Mose an' sen' him some dishes mighty quick! Dere's a heap ov diffrunce," explained the devout cook.

"Well, forget the prayer that caused the wreck, and come in to see what else we got," teased Dudley, at last.

Mose was only too pleased to be invited to assist at the prize packages but he looked askance at the debris that covered the floor of the bungalow.

"Why didnen' yo' all wait f' mornin' to unpack dis mussy stuff out on d' groun'?"

"Wait! My goodness, we could hardly wait to get through supper!" exclaimed Billy.

While they were talking the Captain brought in another case which he had wheeled up from the launch. This case must have been consigned to a hardware merchant or some poultry man as it was filled with wire nests for chickens.

"This sure is a lottery," laughed Fred.

"Yes, and we lost out on this draw!" chuckled Captain Ed.

"Well, these can't be used anyway, 'cause we never keep chickens on the Island," said Billy, regretfully.

"You might take them over to your Uncle Tom," ventured Paul.

"He won't need more than three or four—and look at all of these," replied Fred.

"How many do you s'pose there are," wondered Dudley, and Billy began to unwire one bundle. As he took out one after another of the closely packed wire frames the boys counted until they found there were twenty-five in a pack.

"Say, for pity's sake don't unwire any more—there's twenty bundles of them in all," laughed the Captain.

“That’s five hundred wire baskets! Gee! We’d be swamped all right!” added Billy.

“We’ll give all the farmers on the mainland and Islesboro some,” said Paul.

“We might make a good trade on them for eggs and butter!” remarked the business man of the crowd.

“Ha, ha! Mose allus said Bill woul’ be a milyunair some day,” laughed the cook.

“I tell you what we might do with some of ’em!” now suggested the Captain, thoughtfully. “Last summer, I had some old ones that I threw out and my wife filled them with moss and loam, and then planted some sorts of ferns in ’em. When they were wired and hung up on the porch, they looked mighty fine, I can tell you!”

“Great! That’s just what we’ll do for a surprise. We’ll hang them all around the bungalow for mother!” cried Billy.

“And make a lot for Aunt Miriam for lending us the Zeus,” added Fred.

“We can go to Sprague’s Cove and dig up some of those swell ferns—and there are whole carpets of thick moss there,” said Billy, eagerly.

“Then we’ve found a use for the nests!” sighed Paul, who feared to find any stock on hand valueless.

The next case was filled with stationers’ assorted goods. Alas! the briny had done its worst here. The pens, knife-blades and wire paper-holders were already rusting and besides that a peculiar glutinous slime covered the articles in the case. It was this same sour odour that, coming from the inside of the case had first attracted the boys’ attention to the box when the Captain brought it in.

“Wire baskets! Gee, do we need any more?” asked Dudley, sarcastically.

“What’s all this gooey slime!” wondered Paul, disgusted with the mess he got all over his hands as he tried to pull out a package.

As the boys delved deeper into the case and brought out boxes and stationery all patterned by red and blue and black ink which had soaked through from broken bottles, they found the horrid smelly jelly diluted by salt water, to have mixed in with everything else.

“Ah! the mystery’s solved!” cried Fred, lifting a broken carton of paste-powder from the case.

“Agh! It’s got ready-made in the ocean and spread itself wherever it was not wanted!” said Paul, with disgust.

“Lemme take care ob dat goo-case!” offered Mose. “Ah kin clean ’em all out in d’ mawnin’ an’ mebbe fin’ a heap of paper so’s Paul an’ Dudley kin write home every week, reg’lar!”

“All right—let Mose do it!” laughed Billy.

“But Ah’m tellin’ yo’ right heah—ef Ah see a nice pen-knife wid a white pearl han’le Ah sure will tek it fo’ pay!”

“Anything you find, Mose! Go as far as you like!” promised Fred.

Mose left the cutlery in kerosene over night thereby cleaning off the rust and polishing up the items. The paper and other passably good articles he cleaned off fairly well and kept them on hand for the children to use.

The last of the cases contained dire disappointment. The groceries therein were discovered to be utterly ruined—salt, sugar, cereals, coffee and other foodstuffs.

“Now I’m glad we stopped and got that last case of crackers,” declared Dudley.

“So’m I!” added Paul, hiding a wide yawn behind a case.

“Is this all now!” demanded Billy.

“All for to-night, I guess,” said Fred.

“Gee! but I’m glad! I’m dog-tired!” sighed Billy.

“We all are—let’s get to bed!” cried Paul.

The next day, the Isola Bella and Rosemary contingent came early to hear all about the piratical raid on the seas about Scilly Ledge; and the boys relived again their thrilling adventures in relating them to their interested audience.

The story told, Mose appeared with lemonade and crackers.

“Oh, just the thing! Ladies, won’t you partake of our Pirate’s Prize brand of biscuits? Sultanias filled with ocean currents and genuine Saltines fresh from the Katahdin!” joked Fred, bowing.

Of course the ladies laughed and while they all munched the crackers the boys spoke of the hanging baskets they expected to have ready soon.

“Oh, and by the way, boys, Uncle Tom told me to be sure and thank you for the pig although he was quite overwhelmed at first. Fancy, having a nice fat pig fished out of the ocean for you!” exclaimed Aunt Edith.

“He’s going to keep it, isn’t he?” anxiously asked Paul.

“Oh, certainly—for a time, anyway. We have called it Katahdin, for it proved its undisputed right to the name by making such free use of the last syllable in the name!”

This amused the boys tremendously and they felt relieved to find that Uncle Tom had gladly accepted the foundling.

“Speaking of fern baskets—where are you going for the ferns?” asked Elizabeth.

“We thought of going to Sprague’s Cove for them,” replied Fred.

“Oh, do take us with you then,” cried Miriam.

“Yes, Fred, do! Then I can go off on a little hunting trip by myself?” said Billy, eagerly.

“As long as you don’t shoot anywhere near us, it will suit me,” warned Fred.

“Oh, I’ll keep a mile or more away—anyway, you know I am not Paul or Dudley, who hit a mark at right-angles to their target!” teased Billy.

So the girls were permitted to go on the cruise and help dig up some of the beautiful ferns and wonderful moss found at Sprague’s Cove. A keg full of leaf mould was also taken for the nourishment of the roots of the ferns.

Meantime, Billy planned to land at Adams’ Beach and hunt for rabbits and red squirrels, but before he quite reached the shore he saw a black dog-like head glide through the water. It dove! But it reappeared again and Billy stopped the engine of his launch.

Quietly he waited, for he knew the curiosity of the seal would draw it nearer and perhaps, in range of his rifle. He took great care not to show the gun and thus stood waiting.

His knowledge of the habits of the Harbour seal proved to be correct for the smooth dark head popped up quite near the bow of the launch.

He fired but the seal sank, leaving a pool of blood on the surface of the water.

Billy knew that he had lost his prey unless it was lying in shallow enough water for him to retrieve it: for a dead seal sinks like lead.

He slowly motored over to the place where the red tinge was now mingling with the water, and sounded carefully with an oar.

“Oh, joy! I guess I can get him!” cried Billy to himself as the oar touched bottom at about six feet depth.

“It’s high water now, too, and that’s lucky for me!” he soliloquised.



SCRAPING THE SEALSKIN.



BILLY AND HIS PORCUPINES.

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island.

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When the water had cleared, Billy plainly saw the dead seal lying on a ledge. He pondered the situation well, then decided to wait and watch the seal, for he feared that with the wash of the ebb-tide he would never find it again if he left the place. When the returning “moss-backs” came in sight with their launch he would hail them to come and help him.

Finally, the chugging of the engine was heard and Billy hailed the Captain and Fred.

“I’ve got a seal—come and help me get him!” yelled Billy, contradictorily.

With the Captain and Fred aiding, Billy used the oar to push a slip-noose under and around the seal’s tail and hauled it up to the surface. With considerable labour it was pulled on board but its bleeding head was left hanging over the side of the launch.

Once at the Island the seal was hauled up on the rocks and Billy started in to skin it. Uncle Tom came for the girls before this work had been completed and they waved hands at the busy boy, shouting as they left the float-stage:

“Good riddance to the seal! We’re not sorry to leave that awful smell. Why, the whole Island is permeated with it!”

“‘Tis rather sickenin’, isn’t it?” grinned Billy, standing up to stretch his lame back. “It’s just as well mother isn’t here now!”

The next few days were devoted by Billy and Fred to the curing and tanning of the seal-skin. It was no easy job, either! The scraping alone occupied many hours but nothing seemed like too much trouble for such a trophy!

“Billy, did you know there’s a bounty on the Harbour seals?” asked Captain Ed, one morning. “If you just take the chin whiskers to the Post Office at Sabbath Day Harbour they’ll give you a dollar for them.”

“Me for that dollar!” declared Billy. So that afternoon Captain Ed handed Billy a written statement for evidence that the boy caught the seal.

The next day the boys made another trip to Islesboro and much to the young Nimrod’s satisfaction the dollar was forthcoming without delay.

“There won’t be any seals left a few years from now,” remarked the elderly postmaster to Billy.

“Wall, they come near to ruin’ the salmon-fisheries and somethin’ had to be done about ’em,” added a sailor-man.

“Yes, sir!” said a fisherman who lounged near the door. “I’ve seen a salmon-weir just hung full of salmon-heads—all that them seals left the fishermen!”

“But I always kind’a liked the seals and it’s a pity they has to be killed off,” said the postmaster sympathetically.

A scornful glance from the fisherman and a sniff from the sailor were the only answers vouchsafed the remark.

Fred and Billy finished the work on the seal that day, and the next morning the Captain said he had the collar ready for the flag-pole.

The boys helped him with the work and when all was ready the snowy staff was successfully raised. Now, every one was eager to see the flag wave from the top but they had agreed to wait for their mother’s home-coming. To divert their attention, the Captain made a suggestion.

“Who’s goin’ to help me whip the ends of the new cable for the Medric, sailor-fashion?”

So they worked gaily at this for a time, but what boy can handle a fine piece of rope and resist the excitement of having a swing?

“Captain, lend us your new rope for a while?” asked Billy.

“What for?”

“I have a plan for a dandy swing and besides, it will take the ‘lay’ out of your cable,” replied Billy, diplomatically.

The Captain chuckled and consented—indeed, he offered to help the boys secure the ends but they knew they could manage.

The swing proved to be all Billy had hoped for it. In fact, so thrilling was the experiences of that swing, that the Captain regretted his co-operation for he felt there lurked too much risk to life and limb while it was being used. Hence, he claimed the right to take it the following day for the Medric. But how the boys did enjoy it while it lasted!

Billy demurred vehemently as Captain Ed said he had to use the cable so the Captain craftily hinted: “You ain’t been over to Rosemary after them porcupines, yet? I s’pose your Uncle Tom’s orchard is near about spoiled by now!”

“Gee! That’s so! I ought to go after them at once!”

“I have to go over to the Cove for supplies—Mose is forever wantin’ a yeast-cake, it seems! You might go with me and stay all night at your Uncle Tom’s and come back to-morrow with a fine quill-pig, eh?” continued the subtle Captain.

Mose stood by watching the boys swing and he heard the conversation. He grinned for he knew the Captain’s tactics well. But he took a certain pride in the looks of his Islanders.

“Chile, yo’ sure mus’ change dem old duds ef yo’ goin’ to mek a visit! Ah ain’t goin’ t’ low you’ Maw’s son t’ look lak a sure-’nough tramp! Yo’ ha’r needs trimmin’, too!”

“Oh pshaw, Mose, what difference does it make? It will be night and I’m going huntin’ so no one will see me!” argued Billy.

“Hush yo’ complain’ now, Bill! Come in an’ min’ yo gardeen!” laughed Mose, encouragingly.

“Go on, Billy, you know he’s right! Rosemary is not a camp and who knows who’ll be visiting there? You’d disgrace us and your relations if you were seen in the duds that came out of the ‘Ark’!” declared Fred.

Billy realised he was in the minority on this vote so he submitted to Mose’s barbering but with much grumbling.

“Such a lot of fussing for a hunting trip!” he observed, but the hair-cutter paid no attention to the complaint just then as he had his mind full of other plans.

“Whiles Ah’ve got m’ ban’ in th’ barber business all yo’ boys come along t’ dis ha’r-dressin’ parloh—lates’ style cuts!”

“Ouch! that was my ear. Darn your latest style cuts!” cried Billy impatiently.

“Wuz dat yo’ eah, Chile? Shore ’nuff-dey seems to grow jus’ lak yo’ ha’r! Ah disremembered dey wuz so big, an’ dat ho’come Ah teched ’em wif d’ shears!”

A laugh followed this joke on Billy and that young man departed to dress in a ruffled frame of mind.

The next morning about nine o’clock Paul discovered the Captain and Billy coming toward the Island in the chugging boat. He called to the other boys and they all ran down to Treasure Cove to meet the two sailors.

On the launch stood Billy grinning his widest and holding aloft a porcupine. As he came within hearing he shouted: “Oh, it’s a cinch to catch porcupines! Never got anything so dead easy! Uncle Tom shot one, too,” grandly.

After coming ashore, the Captain handed Fred a letter which bore the Boston post-mark and began “How Kolah Wita-tonkan.”

The others stood at hand to hear any possible news from Mrs. Remington, and Fred hastily perused the pages.

“Well! I’ll be bluffed! Mother writes that she met Mrs. Baker and Mrs. Hubert in Boston and they are all going to take a motor trip from their camp up through Maine.”

“Are they coming here?” queried Billy, eagerly.

“Later, maybe. Mother says she invited them all to come and spend a day with us on the Island, and they seemed quite taken with the idea.”

“Does she say whether any of the girls or boys will be with them on the trip?” asked Dudley.

“Maybe my sister Hilda will be with them!” added Paul.

“I don’t know, because mother merely says they were attending a suffrage convention in Boston—you know what ardent members both Mrs. Baker and Mrs. Hubert are? And they had a nice long talk, but nothing more is said in this letter,” said Fred.

“I wish the doctor would come—he’s awfully good fun!” said Billy.

“We won’t know until mother gets home, then she’ll tell us all about it.”

“Then we could have that swell clam-bake, eh?” said Paul.

“Do you know, we’ve got ten big lobsters in the car now! I’ll bet we will have a lot more by the time mother gets home,” exclaimed Billy.

This hope spurred the boys to even greater efforts to bait the traps enticingly, and “tend out” for results.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

THIEVES IN THE NIGHT

BILLY had a habit of waking about dawn and stepping out of his tent to look around and gauge the weather for the day. So, it happened about three o'clock one morning, that he indulged in his usual nocturnal survey.

The bay was calm in that still dark hour before dawn. Bill was about to retire after making his prognostications when the muffled chugging of a motor-launch and the sound of a boat bumping against something in the back bay off the float-stage, instantly rendered him alert.

He knew the Islanders were wrapped in slumber so he investigated, creeping down under cover of the firs to a vantage point near the shore.

It was too dark to see anything, but the muffled sounds convinced Billy that somebody was “monkeying” with their precious lobsters.

Quietly he stole back and woke the Captain and the boys. With many cautions for silence, they slipped into trousers and sweaters, thrust feet into sneakers, and rushed to surprise the marauders—Billy not forgetting his rifle.

The unavoidable sounds made by the Islanders in leaving the float-stage were warning enough, so before they were well off in Billy's launch the strange craft was flying toward the south.

“It's up with our main-topsails, lads, and after her away,” sang Billy in his glory as he gave the engine more gas.

They could not seem to lessen the distance between the escaping thieves and their own boat, however, even though the pursuers, knowing the local

waters well, were able to take some short cuts.

“Well, their launch is a lee-tle speedier than mine,” wofully admitted Billy.

“But they’re not gaining much, Bill! Let’s keep it up to the finish!” urged Fred.

Down through Gilkey’s Harbour, out past Job’s Island, and into East Penobscot Bay, the thieves led the chase.

“Say, Cap’n, can’t I fire a shot across their bows?” begged Billy.

“Might as well, son,” replied the Captain.

But the thieves paid no attention to this nautical command to stop.

“They must be headin’ fer Pulpit Harbour, on North Haven,” declared the Captain, taking his bearings.

Billy simply couldn’t stand the thought of their getting away. “Oh, Captain, just let me take one shot at their boat!”

The Captain hesitated too long, for silence gives consent. So Billy, quick to take advantage of it, aimed for the engine of the fleeing launch.

“Gee whiz! you hit it!” yelled Paul, excitedly.

“You winged her all right!” admitted Captain Ed, with a grin of satisfaction now that the deed was done.

After that they drew up on the crippled boat and were close behind when she dashed in behind the big rock that marks the entrance to this blind harbour on North Haven.

Then the thieves beached their launch and took to the woods. When the Sunset Islanders landed and examined the deserted launch, they found she was nearly out of gasoline as well as having had one of her spark plugs shot away.

“Guess she just had to put in here—she couldn’t go much further,” said Fred.

“I don’t believe they’re any Pulpit Rock fellers—I know all the folks ’round here ’cause my wife’s a North Haven woman, you know,” remarked the Captain.

“Oh, joy! Here’s our lobsters!” shouted Dudley, with great relief.

“And what’s this?” cried Paul, holding up the cushions and steamer-rugs from Uncle Billy’s launch.

“Well, I swan!” breathed the Captain amazed. “Lobsters is one thing, but when it comes to taking *chattels*—that’s another!”

“What’re we going to do now, Cap’n?” asked Billy.

“I’m awful hungry!” hinted Paul.

“Guess it must be most noon,” ventured Dudley.

The Captain and Fred laughed and assured the boys that it couldn’t be more than six or seven o’clock. The sun was shining gloriously and being up so early made the boys think it was ages since the hurry-call for the chase.

“We’ll have breakfast at my father-in-law’s,” was the Captain’s welcome announcement, indicating a white house that showed above the trees on the point.

“Let’s take out our spark-plug as well as the one left in the other launch,” advised Fred, acting upon his suggestion.

Captain Jotham, Captain Ed’s father-in-law, was a jolly old man with a fringe of white whiskers framing his apple-red face, while his upper lip was carefully shaven.

“Well, well! hain’t seen ye since a month o’ Sundays!” was his hearty welcome to his son-in-law. “Come in—come in and set!”

Then the old Captain's motherly wife appeared and soon after, the hungry mariners were "stokin' up" on coffee and doughnuts, with two kinds of pie cut in generous triangles.

The boys exchanged looks of intense delight—the dream of their lives come true! They had heard about New Englanders eating pie and doughnuts for breakfast, but they had deemed it a legend for they had never had an opportunity to test the truth. Now, they found they were quite equal to the fact, although Mrs. Remington would have been horrified at her boys eating such a morning meal!

When the story of the get-away and pursuit of the thieves was finished, Captain Jotham planned with Captain Ed how to capture the marauders.

"Anyway, Ed, I'm the *Constabule*, you know!"

"Sure 'nough! And you'll be doin' your duty to nab them rascals," assented Captain Ed.

So, armed with an old Winchester, Constable Jotham Heald left the house followed by the rest of the party—Billy also armed with his trusty rifle. Hearing the exciting story, one neighbour after another joined the posse in the quest.

"Say, Jotham!" bawled an old salt just back from Rockland, "Bet'cher them fellers air the same es is wanted fer other things than lobsters!"

"That's right, Jotham! I heared tell thar war a launch stolen down Camden way—thar's a reward out fer news of the thieves and the launch—shoulden' wonder but what this is it!" added another hearty fisherman, as they passed the thieves' craft.

The hope of reward added to the zest of the pursuit and before they left the shore every active or able member of the settlement had joined the posse and had spent that reward!

Meantime, the thieves had reached a remote part of the wooded shore and fearing capture had hidden in a natural cave. Here, they collected a heap of

stones to use for ammunition and provided heavy clubs in case of attack.

They had not anticipated such an army, however, but had intended “rushing” the boys, figuring that the single rifle of the offensives could be rendered useless by the sudden surprise.

The trail grew clearer to the “home defenders” as they neared the granite cave; even Paul could see that cobble-stones had recently been removed from the ground.

The two fugitives, hearing a babel of many voices, peered from the gloom of the cave. When they saw the crowd headed by a constable (as was distinctly shown by the badge of office shining resplendent from his flowered suspenders) with a gun, they looked at each other in fear.

“In the name of the law, surrender!” bawled Captain Jotham, aiming his Winchester at the dark opening of the cave.

With the actual cowardliness of the unarmed criminal, the two men sneaked out holding up their trembling hands in token of submission.

“Where’s them bracelets, Ed?” shouted the constable.

And the two men were handcuffed while the crowd looked on in intense satisfaction. It was the first time the boys had ever seen handcuffs used and it had a most subduing effect on their plastic minds.

It was high noon when the posse dispersed before the Heald homestead, and hunger added to fatigue had so quieted the Islanders that they presented quite a contrast to the eager rush and hullabaloo of the morning.

Captain Jotham’s wife, accustomed as she was to hearty appetites, had provided amply for the demand. Hot biscuits, jam, honey, preserves, and more pie fraternised on the checkered red-and-white table cloth, while smothered haddock and boiled potatoes provided pyramids of delicious if humble provender. And full justice was done that meal by the Representatives of the Law!

The topic of conversation centred about the reward and Captain Jotham promised to take charge of the division so that the Islanders would receive their exact share.

“But don’t set your hopes too high, boys—you won’t be millionaires on that reward—if we get it!” said the constable.

“Why, the whole launch ain’t wuth more’n a hundred, or even less!” added Captain Ed.

That morning, Mose had been awakened by the noise of Billy’s launch as the boys started in pursuit of the thieves. By the time he was half-dressed, however, and down by the float only a chugging of the two engines could be heard by the nonplussed cook.

The morning passed without sight or sound of the Islanders so Mose became worried. He tramped back and forth from Treasure Cove to the float-stage and then down to the South End, dragging the spy-glass with him.

He *almost* forgot to eat so deserted and worried was he. Then, late in the afternoon, when it seemed to him that he was doomed to remain a Second Robinson Crusoe and Man Friday combined in one, he heard a faint echo over the water, and anxiously glued his eye to the spy-glass. There were familiar forms approaching in Billy’s launch!

Mose was so relieved to find them all safe at home that the unusually wide grin on his generous mouth almost met at the back of his round head and elicited a warning from the Captain:

“Take care, Mose, the top of your head will come off!”

The whole thrilling tale of the adventure was told Mose while they all sat about the supper-table, and many were the interruptions in the telling as one or another boy remembered a detail of that chase and capture.

While waiting for dessert, the boys nodded and dozed, and finally, Fred yawned and got up from the table.

“Say, Mose, I’m so tired my jaws won’t move! Keep my dish of pudding for breakfast.”

When the other boys followed Fred’s action, Mose could hardly believe his eyes and ears—not wait for their favourite pudding!

The next morning Anna appeared with her charge, Teddy. “I got a letter from your mother yesterday that she’ll be home soon, so I thought I’d better come over and help Mose clear away the too-apparent traces of your ‘bachelor-hall.’”

Although the boys would not admit it, they were glad to see little Teddy and Anna again, and Fred picked up his brother and carried him off for the time the governess was occupied in helping Mose.

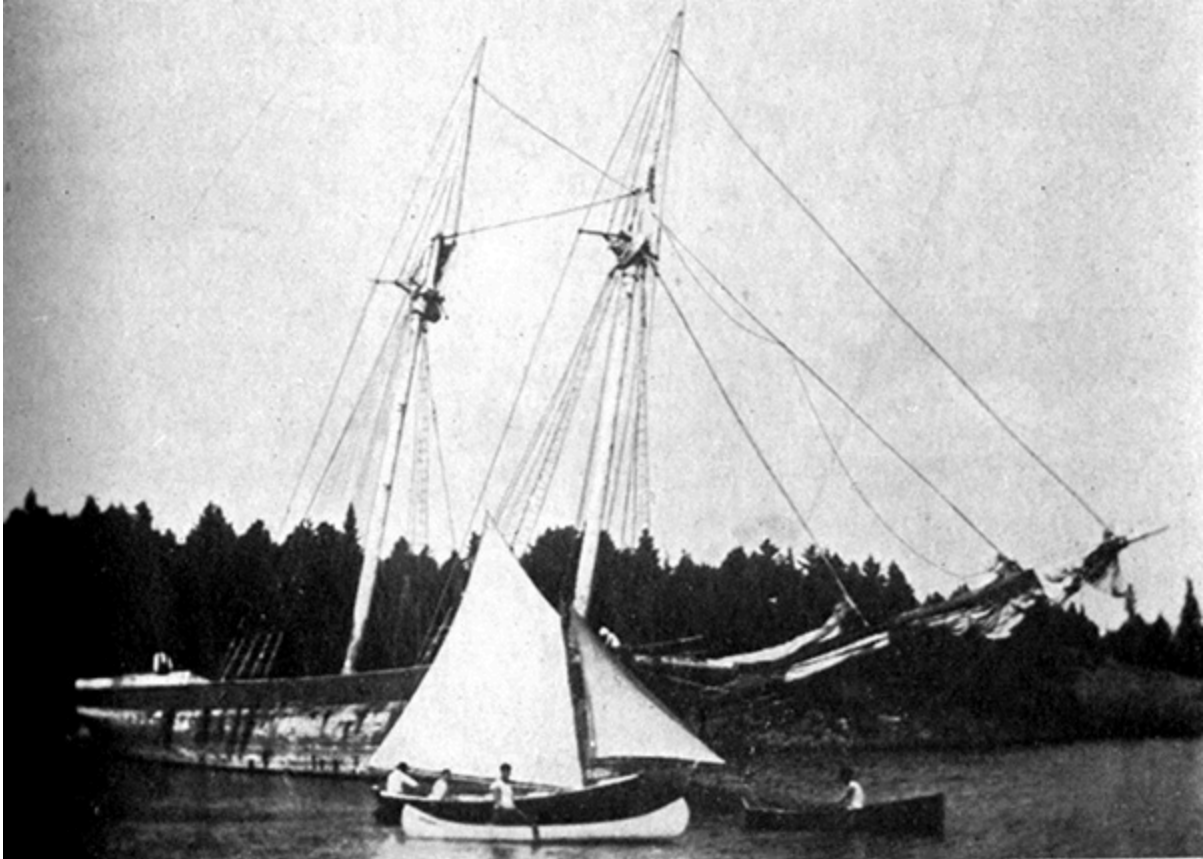
As they worked, Mose remarked: “‘Deed Ah t’ink it’s high time d’ Missus is comin’ home. Ah tek notice dat none ob dese ’ructions ob bein’ pirates er shootin’ thieves happen when she’s heah!”

“I agree with you there, Mose, but I think we’re lucky to have any Islanders sound and alive to meet her at the homecoming,” added Anna, with a sigh.

The day the Lady of the Island was expected, the boys started for Rosemary to meet her there. Everything had been left in readiness at the foot of the flag-pole so that Mose could hoist the flag when the signal came from the returning launch. At that signal, the young Islanders were to sing “My Country ’tis of Thee” and “Our America,” while the flag was hoisted and waved from its position on the big rock of Treasure Cove.



MOVIES—"THE PIRATES OF SUNSET."



THE OLD WRECK IN CROW COVE.

Woodcraft Boys at Sunset Island.

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Everything went off as planned, and Mrs. Remington was greatly pleased at the demonstration of patriotism shown by the young folks.

“I don’t know how it happened that your father and I never had the broken flag-staff replaced this summer, but so much takes place every time he is with us, that it naturally was left for a time when there was nothing else to do and that never happens!” explained Mrs. Remington, in apology for the neglect. Then added:

“Now, however, we have a far better staff than the old one and I want to thank you for the forethought and labour.”

“You must thank Captain Ed, too—he helped a lot!” said truthful and loyal Billy.

“Indeed I do, and he knows it! And for all his care of you,” said his mother, taking Captain Ed’s hand in hers.

At the earnest words of appreciation the Captain’s memory reviewed recent events—piracy and posse were hardly to be considered as acts of care-taking, and the conscientious Captain’s sense of justice rebuked him in accepting the gratitude.

“Oh, well,” thought he to himself, “‘all’s well that ends well’ and no one got in trouble!”

Elizabeth and Edith had accompanied their mother home and were glad to be back on their dear old island, although they had enjoyed their visit immensely.

The morning following Mrs. Remington’s return, Elizabeth said, “Mother, we want our annual clam-bake and it can’t be postponed much longer ’cause Trixie is going back home!”

“Well, Uncle Tom is coming over to-day to give the boys another lesson in target-shooting and we will give him the invitation to carry to the Cove people, and we can tell the Isola Bella family about it when we go there to dinner to-night!”

“Gee! I’m glad we got those lobsters of ours back again!” murmured Billy.

During the next few days every one worked hard to have this clam-bake surpass those of former years. Clams were dug, fish were caught, the Captain’s broilers were requisitioned, while Rosemary and Isola Bella promised to supply the ice-cream and cakes.

The day before the fête Elizabeth was brooding deeply while assisting her mother with candy-making. Suddenly, she said, “Oh, dear! I do wish father could be with us to-morrow!”

Her mother smiled and said, “Well, wish hard enough and see what happens! We used to say ‘If wishes were horses all beggars might ride,’ but *you* might change that to say ‘If wishes are motors our father will arrive!’”

Elizabeth eyed her mother suspiciously and saw a look that caused her to clap her hands.

“Oh, *mother!* goody-good! I know he is coming!”

And away flew Elizabeth to spread the wonderful news to all on the Island.

“Say, that’s the best yet!” cried the boys.

“There’s no one can broil lobsters like father!” declared Billy.

“And we want him to award that prize he offered for the biggest one,” added Dudley.

“That’s right. He said ‘in a month’s catch,’ and the time is up,” admitted Fred.

Eleven A.M. of the great feast-day found Mr. Remington at Rosemary, the little plan of the extra week-end visit having been found possible of fulfilment.

Fred and Billy met their father in the new launch. On the trip to Sunset Island, Billy proudly displayed its speed and his efficiency in managing the motor.

Fred regaled his father with a very full account of the pirates and the chase of the thieves to Pulpit Harbour. As the elder of the trio listened to the story he chuckled and thought to himself, “Chips of the Old Block.”

But, very seriously he remarked, “Boys, what did your mother say to all this?”

“Oh, father! We haven’t told her all we told *you!*” gasped they.

And by the time Mrs. Remington did hear most of the details of the exploits, the flight of time had shed its halo about the daring and possible dangers her boys had incurred.

That noon, the sun shone down upon a fleet of visiting craft loaded with eager and hungry clam-bakers. Not only were the Rosemary and Isola Bella families fully represented but many guests also accompanied them.

Mr. Remington broiled lobsters, Captain Ed steamed clams, the boys dished fish-chowder and Mose broiled young chickens until it seemed the world would be feasted that day. But all disappeared as if by magic and still the clam-bakers found out-of-way corners where cake and ice-cream could be stored!

At last, at peace with all earthly things, the visitors sat down to enjoy the entertainment about to be furnished by the Woodcrafters.

“Our first number on the programme will be A Moving Picture Drama of ‘The Katahdin Pirates,’” announced Fred.

And a realistic scene took place in which one of the male visitors was dragged out and became a helpless victim of piracy as practised by Sunset Islanders. The production was one of Fred’s first attempts at play-writing, and received due applause as such.

Little Red Riding Hood was then acted but the wolf looked suspiciously like the cinnamon bear of the masked ball on Isola Bella. The wood-chopper played his part so enthusiastically that it brought an encore, and so Edith was once more swallowed in the steamer-rugs of her grandmother’s bed, and once more disgorged.

After this, Mr. Remington very seriously announced that the prize offered by him for the largest and heaviest lobster came near to being twins. The only point that saved this awful monstrosity was the fact that a claw on one was larger than those of the other! Thus, Paul was recompensed for his encounter with a lobster’s claw during the first “catch” of the season.

Paul was so delighted with winning the first prize that he went about showing each guest the claws of the fine lobster he had caught—and promising Trixie a print of the photograph he had taken of it the day before.

Dancing in the Council Ring helped digestion and the victrola Uncle Tom brought over that day furnished music.

Among other farewells that evening, Trixie's were especially prolonged as she was to leave Rosemary on the morrow.

During his unexpected visit of three days, Mr. Remington took an active interest in the target practice and the boys received many important and wise advices.

With target-practice, fishing, canoeing, and other sports, the days flew by, while weekly councils in the Ring marked the attainment of Woodcraft Honours.

The outdoor life had tanned and hardened Paul and Dudley so that they were a credit to the Island. Moreover, the boys were now of real service in camp life, having learned to row, be of help in sailing, expert in swimming, knowing something of first aid, and being able to cook a simple camp meal.

Then came a letter in the morning mail one day and upon reading it Mrs. Remington announced: "Mrs. Baker says the trip is all arranged. The girls of Wickeecheokee Band and the boys of the Grey Fox Band are crazy to come with Dr. Baker and Mr. Hubert when they motor to Maine. So she has changed her plans of coming with the doctor."

"Oh, that's too bad! I know she would have enjoyed a visit with you, mother," said Elizabeth.

"What will they do, then?" asked Billy eagerly, trying to hide his pleasure at hearing that Fiji and Bob Baker would accompany the doctor instead of Mrs. Baker.

"Why, Mr. Hubert will take the big touring car and take Janet, Zan Baker, Nita Brampton, Elena Marsh and Paul's sister Hilda—the original five who

started Wickeecheokee Band of Wako Tribe, while Dr. Baker will use his new seven-passenger car to carry Fiji and Bob Baker, Jack Hubert, Harold Everett and the luggage.”

“Why, Jane and Jack Hubert are with their mother at Woodchuck Camp in the Adirondacks!” exclaimed Elizabeth.

“Yes, but Mrs. Baker and Miss Miller are going from the city to the Hubert Camp and visit there while Jane and Jack take the two places in the cars to come on here with the other Woodcrafters,” explained Mrs. Remington.

Wild expressions of delight came from every boy and girl present and then Billy quieted them with a practical remark.

“Say, those Bands won’t let us put anything over on them in a Grand Council, I bet!”

“That’s right! We ought to put on steam and show the Grey Foxes what we have done this summer!” cried Dudley.

“Fiji Baker told my sister that they meant to ‘saw wood’ on the farm this summer, so’s they could show ‘some’ work at the Grand Council in New York in the fall,” added Paul.

“What’s more, they must have known of this visit some time ago, and been hitting it up to show off when they get here,” suggested Fred.

“Say, boys, wouldn’t it be great fun to hold one mighty Council with the Pentagoet Tribe as host together with the girls of The Big Lodge of Wako Tribe, and their Little Lodge where Paul, Edith and Teddy first started in Woodcraft Work?” volunteered Elizabeth.

“Don’t forget the Grey Foxes, too!” added Dudley.

“Oh, yes, let’s! I want to show Hilda how I have improved this summer,” urged Paul.

The others smiled encouragingly at the boy in whom there surely had been miracles wrought since he joined Woodcraft. In place of the whining and discontented ways he had acquired a happy optimism; the shirking of duties was now a forgotten habit, the irregular eating, oversleeping, prevarications and other undesirable qualities were now gone for good. And good normal ideas and character-forming exercises took their place.

“Mrs. Baker said, that the doctor has been so over-worked that he needs a change, so Mr. Hubert planned this outing to entice him. They will motor from the Adirondacks in easy stages and then spend the third week-end of August in Camden, so that we can have them over to visit the Island for a day at least!” said Mrs. Remington, looking again at the letter from Mrs. Baker.

“If we hold that last Grand Council when the visiting Tribes are here why not let that occasion be used to crown Fred a Sagamore? He has just won his twenty-fourth feather with the sailing *coup*,” suggested Elizabeth, eagerly.

“That is a splendid idea, Lizzie!” cried Billy, using that tabooed nickname for his sister.

“We can have some grand water sports as well as other fun,” instantly quoth Fred, to cover the too evident pleasure he felt at the proposition.

“We can have a ‘Spearing the Sturgeon,’ a canoe tag, and a tub-tilting contest as well as a Talk Fest and other fun!” said Dudley, anxious to add his quota.

“Say, don’t you boys go and forget we girls are in on this Council!” warned Elizabeth, with a menacing look.

“Of course!” responded Paul, magnanimously.

“And we’re going to claim Honours for different things, too! I’m going to finish my Hostess and Shingebis Degrees as well as my Handicraft *coups*,” continued Elizabeth.

“I guess those girls of Wako Tribe will have some stunts to show, too,” added Edith.

“I think I will plan a programme that will give each Woodcrafter time and opportunity to show what he or she has done this summer,” suggested Mrs. Remington.

“Yes, mother, do that!” came a chorus of voices, so the Lady of the Island produced an elaborate programme that later was entered in the Tally Book as one of the Grand Councils—and the best ever held on the Island.

From that day until the time the expected tourists were to arrive, many hours were given to finishing up the lists for claiming *coups* and Honours.

Birds, flowers, insects and fish were catalogued and learned by every one until the required number for each *coup* or honour were secured.

Athletics and Camp Crafts were displayed to the necessary witnesses until Fred declared that he would demand the pay for the office for Recording Secretary if the writing kept up much longer.

But all mundane things have an end and so has the waiting for an important event.

Uncle Bill and Mr. Remington met at last on their ‘insular plane’ just before the arrival of the guests at Camden. They proved to be of great assistance when it came to arranging the rules and regulations of the water-sports planned.

Then the day the touring cars arrived at Rosemary, every Islander was up and ready to jump into the launch immediately after breakfast. They intended to act as escort for Uncle Tom’s power-boat which would convey the visitors.

The Council Ring had been elaborately decorated with totems painted on the round and oval bread-boards salvaged from the wrecked Katahdin, and flags waved in the breeze—the glorious Stars and Stripes evident above all.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

THE TWENTY-FOURTH FEATHER

EARLY in the morning of the festive day, Mose came to Mrs. Remington with a question expressed in his troubled eyes.

“We ain’t got dishes enough, nohow, fer de big crowd yo’ all is expectin’,” said he.

“Why, Mose! What about all those shooks of wooden plates salvaged from the wreck—and the other wooden things?” said she.

“Oh, Ah didn’ know yo’ all woul’ want t’ use dem fo’ Noo Yoak comp’ny,” apologised Mose, who wanted to put “the best foot foremost” with expected strangers.

“You know, it isn’t the dishes they’ll notice, Mose, but what’s on them!” declared Mrs. Remington wisely.

“Ah s’pose so!” conceded the half-convinced cook.

The Great Convocation having safely arrived on Sunset Island, the morning was devoted to all sorts of athletics and water-sport contests.

The Grey Fox boys acquitted themselves admirably for such young beginners in Woodcraft, and they seized the chance in the presence of so many witnesses to win *coups* for “chinning the bar,” “hop, step, and jump” and other games.

The canoe-tag was a laughable affair—naturally, the contestants wore bathing suits. Uncle Tom and Uncle Bill loaned their canoes to the visitors for the day.

“Tell you what, boys, this makes me feel young again!” exclaimed Uncle Bill, as he laughed at certain tricks.

“Why, Uncle Bill! You’re not old,” defended Billy.

“No indeed, he is just as young as any of us!” said Fred.

“About as young as Teddy, for instance,” laughed Mrs. Remington.

“Yes, as young and as foolish,” added Aunt Miriam.

And Uncle Bill quickly diverted every one’s attention to a beautiful schooner ploughing through the waves of the bay.

That day the luncheon was a picnic affair, for all of the Rosemary and Isola Bella relatives brought huge hampers of food. Immediately after the lunch a cleanup brigade got rid of the debris before the final preparations were made for the Grand Council.

Then, the boys’ and girls’ tents were filled with excited Woodcrafters adding the finishing touches to their ceremonial costumes. For, whatever else was lacking in the suitcases of the Wako Girls and Grey Fox Boys, it was not the tiniest or bulkiest item of their Woodcraft Council Robes! No indeed!

Three o’clock found a goodly company completely circling the Council Place. Besides relatives and families of the captains present other visitors had arrived after luncheon.

Wita-tonkan opened the Council and called upon Fiji, the Chief of the Grey Foxes, to make the ceremonial rubbing-stick fire, also appointing Zan Baker, Founder of Wickeecheokee Band, Tally Keeper of the Council, thus conforming to the conditions of courtesy and co-operation.

When the Chief of the Council called for reports of Scouts, a surprise was afforded the Pentagoets.

Captain Ed rose, saluted, was recognised, and began in an official Woodcraft manner:

“Oh Chief! I have to report that Constabule Jotham Heald sent word that \$15 reward awaits at the Camden Police Station for you boys’ share of the money paid by the owner of the recovered launch.”

After the excited applause had subsided, Billy sprang up, saluted, and inquired earnestly, “Oh Chief! I would like to ask the Captain if we aren’t going to get anything for helping capture those thieves?”

Every one in the Council laughed at Billy’s mercenary tendencies.

“Oh Chief! I will answer the young Brave’s question!” cried Uncle Bill, now jumping up. “We all admire and value the astuteness of this young detective’s work and I fear that my namesake has had his hopes buoyed high from having read of the exorbitant rewards obtained by city “tecs”; however, let me assure him that most of those sums are press stories and the ‘long green’ is seldom seen by the hard-plugging officers whose families have to live according to the ‘low-cost menus’ furnished by some philanthropic magazines—on two and a half cents a day!”

Billy’s face had gradually been changing its expression of eagerness to disappointment, so the Captain explained:

“The talk of a reward for the thieves was mostly just talk! In fact, the launch-owner added an extra five to the five dollars reward for catching the rascals. But we were quite a posse, you know, so it only amounted to thirty-seven cents a piece, when divided.”

Fumbling through his pockets, the conscientious Captain finally brought forth a yellow cotton bag once filled with “cut plug” but now elevated to the position of a bank.

“The constabule” had made an exact division of spoils grading down to some odd pennies, and this was counted out upon the desk of the Tally Keeper.

The boys were slightly disappointed at the sudden collapse of the financial investments they had dreamed about, but they were good losers and insisted that Captain Ed share the reward with them.

When order was once more restored, Uncle Tom made his report on target practice. Amid prolonged applause, the first prize was a pocket-rifle and was awarded to Billy. The second prize was a sheath-knife which went to Dudley.

Under the heading of “unfinished business” Wita-tonkan called upon the Pentagoets and visitors present at the Black Bear Day, to deliver the rest of the scalps still due the victors in that contest.

Uncle Bill rose and said: “Oh Chief, I permitted my hair to grow all of the time I was away from here. Now, behold, the result!”

As he spoke, he held aloft a magnificent pendant brush of long shining hair which he had had made to order. This truly royal trophy was then solemnly hung on the Black Bear totem-pole back of the Chief’s chair.

In turn, the rest of the scalps were hung beneath it, Uncle Tom and some of the visitors having provided variegated locks: crimson, yellow, green, purple, and blue tassels of horsehair.

“How! How!” sounded amid laughter in the Council Ring.

“Any Honours to be claimed?” questioned the Chief.

Fiji and Bob stood up and presented the signed papers for a canning *coup* each. They had joined a Government Canning Club and at Wickeechokee Farm that summer had canned twelve quarts each of strawberries, cherries and raspberries, making the three dozen necessary for a *coup*.

“When will you give a demonstration of your club-work? I’d like to be one of the judges and chief taster,” asked Uncle Bill.

This gave the Woodcrafters an idea for a Thanksgiving exhibition which they really carried out the ensuing winter.

Then, Dudley, Paul, Billy and Fred claimed the *coup* for catching and salting fish, each having more than the twenty-five to their account.

Wita-tonkan having awarded these *coups* a question was raised as to the fitting person to award the Honour to him.

“A Chief must receive Honours from another Chief,” announced Zan, the Tally Keeper.

“Will the Grey Fox Chief award this Honour to the Chief of the Pentagoet Tribe?” added she, turning to her brother.

Fiji acquitted himself with dignity, although it was the first time that he had been called upon to act in this capacity.

Various Nature and Handcraft *coups* were claimed by both girls and boys, and Elizabeth, representing her home tribe of the Apawamis, was awarded the Degrees of Hostess and Sister Craft.

Edith, Dudley and Paul, each claimed a *coup* for knowing twenty-five fish; the two boys announcing that, before they left the island that summer, they hoped to have their Grand *Coups* for sleeping out of doors sixty successive nights.



SHINGEBIS IN COSTUME.

Woodcraft Boys on Sunset Island.

Page

“If I hadn’t had to go to Rosemary and sleep in Aunt Edith’s house when mother went to Boston, I could have won that Grand *coup*, too!” grumbled Edith.

Some one wondered why Wita-tonkan wore only his plain head-band at this important Council and it was now explained.

Billy arose and said, “I, Shingebis, of the Black Bear Tribe, in behalf of Wita-tonkan of the Black Bear Tribe, claim *coup* for sailing without expert help, one hundred and fifty miles in a season. Witnessed by Captain Ed Blake, Moses Jackson, and Elizabeth Remington.”

A pause was broken by Shingebis, who gazed solemnly at the circle of attentive faces and said impressively: “This is Wita-tonkan’s twenty-fourth *coup* and entitles him to the Sagamore ship!”

Fiji, slightly overwhelmed at the duties devolving upon him, was again called forward to do service to a Brother Chief.

Zan and Elizabeth handed the Grey Fox Chief the Sagamore’s war-bonnet and the twenty-fourth symbol. Fiji reverently inserted the feather, then, holding aloft the coveted plumes he called upon Elizabeth to read aloud to the Council, the exploits symbolised by this Sagamore’s Crown.

With a feeling of great pride in her brother’s achievement, Pah-hlee-oh, the Moon-maid, read as follows:

1. The Swimming *Coup*
2. The Grand *Coup* for sleeping sixty successive nights out of doors
3. The Rubbing-Stick *Coup*
4. The Match-Fire *Coup*
5. The Grand *Coup* for butterflies
6. The Grand *Coup* for fish
7. The Flower *Coup*

8. The Grand *Coup* for trees
9. The Hop-Step-and-Jump *Coup*
10. Chinning the Bar *Coup*
11. The Herald *Coup*
12. The Peace-Messenger *Coup*
13. Grand *Coup* for Making Willow Bed
14. *Coup* for Weaving Rush mat
15. Grand *Coup* for knots
16. Star-Gazing *Coup*
17. Axe-Man *Coup*
18. The Cooking *Coup*
19. The Catch and Salting Fish *Coup*
20. Grand *Coup* for Walking Five Miles in
Sixty-three Minutes and Forty-one
Seconds
21. Grand *Coup* for Moths
22. Grand *Coup* for Putting Up Dumb-bell
23. *Coup* for Making Bear for Council
Game
24. The Sailing *Coup*.

As the long salvo of "Hows!" died away over the water, Fiji ceremoniously placed the Crown upon the new-made Sagamore.

Every Woodcraft boy and girl present then in turn saluted the Sagamore Wita-tonkan, which salute was his due every time he entered any Council thereafter.

In a few words of intense feeling, Wita-tonkan thanked the Chief of the Grey Foxes and the Council, then took again his place in the Chair.

The full programme was given that day. The Wako Tribe rendering the Corn Dance in a finished and graceful manner. Fiji and Bob stood off Billy and Paul in contests of tub-tilting and then the Pentagoet Tribe gave a good account of themselves in singing and movies.

Just before the close of that Grand Council Uncle Bill, Uncle Tom, and Mr. Remington made a momentous announcement.

“We have persuaded Dr. Baker and Mr. Hubert, acting as chauffeurs for these Woodcraft visitors, to pronounce the two automobiles out of condition for an immediate departure. Therefore, they have agreed to extend the visit,” said Uncle Bill.

“Yes, the Grey Foxes are going to be the guests of the Sunset Islanders, while the Wakos will visit Isola Bella,” continued Mr. Remington.

“And the doctor and Mr. Hubert are to remain with me at Rosemary where we three can chaperone the unruly cars,” added Uncle Tom.

But long before the third announcement was finished a babel started in the Council Ring and could only be subdued by the Sagamore jumping up and shouting wildly:

“Three cheers and a tiger!”

The order was obeyed with a vim that deafened all those present, and echoed as far over to Isola Bella so that Bridget came out of her domain and stood with hands upon her ample hips, remarking to herself: “Some more av thim Injun fussin’s Oi s’pose.”

Oh, the joys of the next few days! Fishing, sailing—for the visitors preferred sailing to any other sport—and exploring the islands; a visit to the old wreck in Crow Cove, an impromptu clam-bake, and dances in Fudge Attic of evenings where Uncle Bill made good his boast to the members of Wako Tribe—that he was strong for the ladies!

On the morning of the last day, however, Dr. Baker and Mr. Hubert silenced all petitions for a longer visit. So, the launches were boarded and

the visiting Woodcrafters and all of the Islanders were soon carried over to Rosemary where the well-chaperoned cars had been waiting.

“Say, Fiji, while the folks are admiring Uncle Tom’s garden s’posing we show you boys the farm,” asked Fred.

“And we’ll show you the little pig we saved from the Katahdin wreck,” cried Billy.

This idea was acted upon and soon the boys and girls were laughing at the antics of the pig, now in an excellent condition owing to the generosity of the Rosemary refectory.

As they all stood near the pen, Fiji began whistling a medley beginning with Yankee Doodle, when, to the amazement of the children, piggy instantly reared up on his hind legs and danced about, keeping very good time with the whistling.

“Well, did you ever!” gasped Zan, turning to look at the others.

The boys and girls of the Island were as surprised as she, however, and stood speechless, looking at the object of their unbelief.

“Say, that’s no fool of a pig! I’m going to try him again!” exclaimed Fiji.

Katahdin had dropped to all fours when the musician had stopped whistling and now came snuffling close to the fence for an accustomed apple.

“I’ll run to the orchard for some apples!” cried Billy, while Fiji started to whistle again.

Piggy again danced around and around causing the audience to shriek with laughter.

“I bet you anything that’s a trick pig!” cried Fred.

“And it was crated for the County Fair—yes sir!” added Paul.

“Let me try some other stunts,” suggested Fiji, climbing over the fence.

Bob handed his brother a stick of wood while the other children waited breathlessly to see the results of the experiment.

Fiji ordered in a commanding voice “Down, Piggy, down!”

Immediately, the pig lay down upon the ground.

“Dead dog, Dead!” now called the excited boy, forgetting for the moment that he was not training Wickee, his collie dog.

But Katahdin cared naught for the error of names, and meekly turned over on his back with all four short legs sticking stiffly upward.

A scream of laughter greeted this performance and an apple was fed the eager pig.

“Fiji, see if he can play soldier like Wick does?” now said Bob. So, the stick Fiji held was carefully placed in the crotch of the upright pig’s foreleg. The pig was so tame that it showed absolutely no fear of the children but stood obediently waiting for a command.

Whistling Yankee Doodle again, Fiji shouted “March!”

Katahdin ambled clumsily along carrying the stick for a gun, and the children shouted wildly in their frenzy of delight. They felt that they had saved the seventh wonder of the earth!

“Halt!” called Fiji, and the porcine performer obeyed.

“Present arms!” but the pig must have been accustomed to a different act for it instantly grounded arms.

Uncles, aunts, and other adults were now hailed to come and witness the great surprise. So piggy was once more put through his “steps” to the wonderment of the grown-ups.

“I believe this is a valuable pig, children, and perhaps his master was on the Katahdin also, and now is mourning the loss of his pet,” said Mrs. Remington.

“Suppose we write the Eastern Steamship Company to ascertain who the owner is, or just why this pig was shipped on the Katahdin,” suggested Uncle Tom.

“Of course, the address was on the crate but was soaked off that day on Scilly Ledge,” said Paul, regretfully.

“I think Uncle Tom’s plan the best—will you write at once, please?” said Billy.

“This very day!” vowed Uncle Tom.

“Oh, do let us hear from you, will you, Mr. Charlton? and tell us what you find out about Katahdin?” cried Zan, eagerly, as they walked towards the waiting automobiles.

“Indeed, I will! The Sunset Islanders saved piggy’s life from a watery grave, but the Grey Foxes saved him from the butcher’s blade!” exclaimed Uncle Tom.

Then, amid shrill whistles, waving of caps and hats, and other forms of farewell, the two cars started away carrying a pleased party of visitors out of sight.

A week passed without a reply to Uncle Tom’s letter and every one began worrying lest they would have to go back home without having found Katahdin’s rightful owner.

Then came a bulky letter from the company. It contained letters written to a man in the Rockland hospital and his replies. They all pertained to the pig. After reading them, Uncle Tom smiled and started for Sunset Island with the information.

“Well, Islanders! What to do about that pig?” asked he.

“Goodness me! Haven’t you had *any* word, yet?” worried Paul.

“I’ve been thinking that I’d better hand him over to the Captain, if we have to go without finding another owner,” said Uncle Tom, pretending not to hear Paul’s question.

This caused a disquieting silence although the boys were very fond of Captain Ed; still each one had secretly hoped to take the pig home himself, if no other home had been found.

Uncle Tom laughed heartily for he read their thoughts correctly, and felt that he had taken an unfair advantage of them. So, he took the bundle of letters from his pocket and motioned the children to be seated.

The letters proved that the owner of the trick pig was the only passenger injured when the Katahdin was wrecked, and if he had not tried to save the life of his beloved pet—his only source of livelihood, he would have been spared some broken ribs. But, upon hearing the frightened squeals coming from the pig that was kept in a crate, the poor man endeavoured to drag the box on deck and thus was struck by a falling spar.

The crew carried him to the lifeboat but he wanted to go back for his pig! They held him fast, however, and sent him to the hospital for attention. In his delirium he called and called for his pig, ordering it to perform or calling it by endearing names when an act was well done.

The nurses noted this and reported to the doctor and the kindly doctor in turn reported to the authorities. Then, after hope had almost gone, came the letter from Uncle Tom. To say the poor man felt joy and relief at hearing that his pet was alive and so well cared for, was putting it mildly. The letter he sent Uncle Tom was simply overflowing with gratitude.

Before the Islanders left Maine to return to their city home, Uncle Tom came for them to hurry back with him to Rosemary and meet the owner of Katahdin.

Here, the pale but happy man shook hands with the children and thanked them repeatedly for what they had unconsciously done for him.

“You see, when I first went on that boat, I wanted Pico—that’s his right name—in my state-room with me but the steamship company wouldn’t allow it, so they put him in a crate and put the poor thing down in the room with the freight! Ah, me! How Pico must have suffered from fright that time when the ship hit those rocks! And after, when he was in the sea!”

The young pirates could have testified to the fear the poor pig felt as shown by his wildness and squeals that day on the Zeus, but it would not have helped the still weakened man to hear that story so nothing was told him about the rescue.

The Islanders stood watching the happy owner strap the new crate on the back of the buckboard he had hired, and when he drove away, turning now and then to wave to the children, they sighed.

“Say, do you know what?” exclaimed Billy, suddenly.

“No, what?” demanded the others.

“Of all the adventures we’ve had at Sunset Island this summer, I’m not so sure but that saving Pico for this lonely man isn’t the deed to be recorded in our Tally as being of the most value and importance!”

And every one seconded Billy’s heartfelt motion.

The last days on Sunset Island came all too soon and after such a wonderful summer of freedom and pleasures, the spectre of school-lessons looming up with the limitations of city-life, created a zeal to crowd in all possible sport.

As they all sailed for the last time over the bay to the Camp-Ground landing where they expected to take the steamer, the three younger boys thought with regret that they might have accomplished more than they really had, but Wita-tonkan felt the glow of satisfaction that he had realised one of his ambitions of life—that of being crowned the Sagamore of Sunset Island.

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Punctuation has been standardised. Spelling and hyphenation have been retained as they appear in the original publication except as follows:

- Page 15
unweildy fish would surely *changed to*
[unwieldy](#) fish would surely
- Page 118
as a resistable brace against *changed to*
as a [resistible](#) brace against
- Page 146
lamned him with it *changed to*
[lammed](#) him with it
- Page 147
wild squak from the chickens *changed to*
wild [squawk](#) from the chickens
- Page 155
I I know what all that hammering *changed to*
[I](#) know what all that hammering
- Page 155
more eratic grew the time *changed to*
more [erratic](#) grew the time
- Page 186
I know you were only only trying *changed to*
I know you were [only](#) trying
- Page 255
from having read of the exhorbitant *changed to*
from having read of the [exorbitant](#)

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